

Two Georgia Lakefront Lots

A 61-point comparative due-diligence review, with measured terrain analysis, regulatory research and construction-cost modelling.

PROPERTY A 12396 Edgewater Dr #23, Hampton, GA 30228

Waterpointe subdivision, Unit 3 Lot 23 · **1.330 acres**, vacant · fronts **J.W. Smith Reservoir**
Parcel **05050A A003** · Zoning **RS-180** · **Unincorporated Clayton County** OFFICIAL
33.416191°N, 84.369848°W · Census Tract 13063040636

PROPERTY B 1147 & 1153 Watersedge Cove, Lots 130 & 131, Tignall, GA 30668

Stillwater Coves subdivision · **2.14 acres** (two 1.07-ac lots), vacant · near **Clarks Hill / J. Strom Thurmond Lake**
APN **10A 130** · MLS **98224174** · Asking **\$55,000** (both lots) · **Lincoln County** OFFICIAL
33.941877°N, 82.564164°W · Census Tract 13181970100

Both addresses are in a different county than the mailing address implies

Property A is **not** in Henry County and the lake is **not** a Henry County Water Authority reservoir; Property B is **not** in Wilkes County. Both corrections were verified independently against the US Census Bureau geocoder and the counties' own GIS. They change the zoning, septic, permitting, tax and short-term-rental rules that apply. See **\$0**.

What was measured, not assumed

- **Terrain** from USGS 3DEP **1-metre lidar** DEMs — contours, true-scale cross-sections, 3-D surfaces, slope over every 50-ft run
- **Property A boundary** from the Clayton County Tax Assessor's live parcel service (5 corners, measured to ±1%)
- **Flood zone** from the FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer at the exact coordinates
- **Soils** from USDA NRCS SSURGO — full horizon profiles and engineering interpretations
- **Aerial imagery** from USGS NAIP (public domain)

Evidence grading used throughout

OFFICIAL	Government, utility or recorded primary source
GIS-DERIVED	Measured by us from authoritative spatial data — not a survey
LISTING	MLS / agent / marketing claim — unverified by default
ESTIMATE	Our modelled figure; arithmetic shown
PROFESSIONAL	Requires a licensed surveyor, engineer, soil scientist or agency ruling
NOT FOUND	Could not be confirmed — stated rather than guessed

Threshold corrections — read before anything else

Three premises in the brief are factually wrong. Each one changes downstream answers.

Premise	Property A — assumed	Property A — verified
County	Henry County	Clayton County (FIPS 13063), unincorporated
Reservoir owner	Henry County Water Authority	Clayton County Water Authority (CCWA)
City jurisdiction	Possibly City of Hampton	None — no city has jurisdiction

Premise	Property B — assumed	Property B — verified
County	Wilkes County	Lincoln County (FIPS 13181)
Lots in the sale	Lot 130 only	Lots 130 and 131 (1153 = Lot 131)

How the county corrections were established

Property	Evidence	Source
A	Census Bureau geocoder, coordinate query at 33.416191, -84.369848 returns Counties: Clayton County and no Incorporated Place at all (= unincorporated). County Subdivision Jonesboro CCD .	OFFICIAL geocoding.geo.census.gov
	The parcel is present in Clayton County's own tax assessor parcel service with PARCELID 05050A A003 , ZONE RS180 , UNIT 3 , LOT 23 , NEIGHBORHOODDESC WATERPOINTE . A Henry County parcel could not appear there.	OFFICIAL gis.claytoncountyga.gov
	CCWA's own fishing page states " <i>J.W. Smith Reservoir is a 250 acre CCWA-owned lake.</i> " HCWA's reservoir page lists its complete five-reservoir network — Tussahaw, Upper Towaliga, Lower Towaliga, Long Branch, Indian Creek/Gardner — and J.W. Smith is not among them .	OFFICIAL ccwa.us / hcwa.com
	The Waterpointe HOA's own bylaws place the subdivision in " <i>Land Lots 50, 51, 78 & 79 of the 5th District of Clayton County, Georgia</i> " and record that in 1992 " <i>jurisdictional authority was transferred to Clayton County.</i> "	OFFICIAL waterpointehoa.com
B	Census Bureau geocoder at 33.941877, -82.564164 returns Counties: Lincoln County , County Subdivision Lincolnton CCD , Tract 9701.	OFFICIAL geocoding.geo.census.gov
	The recorded Declaration of Covenants for Stillwater Coves was filed in Lincoln County Superior Court, 15 June 2006 (Deed Book 165, pp. 246–293). The developer's own site says "historic Lincoln County."	OFFICIAL stillwatercovesgeorgia.com
	Tax APN on the MLS record reads 10A 130 , Lincoln County; schools assigned are Lincoln County Elementary / Middle / High.	LISTING

Why the confusion is understandable

Property A's mailing address is genuinely "Hampton, GA 30228" and Hampton is a Henry County city — but the lot sits in the **Clayton County "panhandle,"** a southern salient of Clayton County that reaches down toward Hampton. This is also why the subdivision is reached from **Panhandle Road**. Property B's "Tignall, GA 30668" is a **Wilkes County post office serving a Lincoln County parcel**. In both cases the USPS address and the governing jurisdiction differ.

An incidental confirmation: a FEMA FIRM panel query at Property A's coordinates returns panels for *both* 13063C (Clayton) and 13151C (Henry) — the lot is close enough to the county line that both county map panels cover the point. The **Clayton** panel (13063C0165F) is the governing one.

What changes as a result

Topic	Governed by (A)	Governed by (B)
Zoning & building permits	Clayton County Community & Economic Development, (770) 477-3569	Lincoln County (zoning administered; ordinance text not obtainable online)
Reservoir / shoreline rules	Clayton County Water Authority (CCWA)	US Army Corps of Engineers, Savannah District

Topic	Governed by (A)	Governed by (B)
Septic permitting	Clayton County Health District, (678) 610-7469	GA DPH East Central Health District — Lincoln County
Schools	Clayton County Public Schools	Lincoln County Schools
Short-term rental rules	Clayton County Ord. 2019-22 (owner-occupied only)	Lincoln County; no STR ban found in covenants
Hotel/motel tax	8% Clayton County	Lincoln County rate not confirmed
Property tax	Clayton County Tax Commissioner	Lincoln County Tax Commissioner

One correction in the brief's favour

The brief asked about **EPA radon zone** assuming Henry County. That answer is unaffected: **Clayton and Henry are both Radon Zone 2**. It is one of the few items where the county error was harmless. Lincoln County is **Zone 3** (lowest).

OFFICIAL

The findings that decide these two lots

Everything below is expanded, sourced and quantified in the body of the report.

1 Property A is not a recreational lake lot. It is a view lot on a closed drinking-water reservoir.

J.W. Smith Reservoir is a **raw drinking-water supply** owned by CCWA. CCWA's published rules: boats capped at **20 ft, electric motors or paddles only** — *"gas motor usage is prohibited under any circumstances"; "access to the reservoir shall be made only at the entrance gate"; "wading, swimming, or bathing is prohibited."* Open **Sat-Wed only, 1 Mar – 31 Oct**, on a paid permit. **No private dock programme exists**. And the lot **does not touch the water** — CCWA owns the bed, the shoreline and a measured **~33-ft strip** between the rear lot line and the waterline. OFFICIAL GIS-DERIVED

At least one MLS listing in this subdivision advertises "private access to lake." CCWA's Rule 5 contradicts it.

2 Property B is marketed as "DOCKABLE." That claim is unsubstantiated and the price says so.

The MLS remarks assert both lots are dockable, but the structured MLS waterfront field reads **"Lake Privileges"** — not a dock or dock permit. Sibling listings in the *same subdivision* enumerate the dockable lots as **125, 128 and 140** (and 24, 26, 35, 103); **130 and 131 appear in none of them**. On the same street, lots marketed as dockable ask **\$136,000–\$143,250 each**; the subject pair asks **\$55,000 for two acres** — roughly a 5× per-acre discount. Price history: **\$149,000 (Mar 2024) > \$49,900 (Apr 2025) > \$55,000 (Jun 2026), -63%**. LISTING

USACE is explicit that **only a ranger's on-site field inspection determines dockability**, that it is **first-come first-served**, and that permits *"will not be issued for commercial or speculative purposes in order to enhance the selling potential of adjacent private property."* OFFICIAL

3 We measured Property B's low point at 26 ft above full pool, and the nearest full-pool water at ~199 ft away.

Working from the 1-metre lidar DEM: within the reconstructed 2.14-acre footprint the **lowest ground is 356.0 ft** against a **330.0 ft full pool**. The nearest ground at or below 330 ft lies **~199 ft beyond the lot**, across land that is federal fee property (the USACE purchase boundary was set at **elevation 346 ft**). So there is a real band of Corps land between the lot and the water, and the final descent to the shore is the **steepest ground in the whole transect — 27.4% over 50 ft (15.3%)**. GIS-DERIVED BOUNDARY REQUIRES A LICENSED SURVEY

4 Property A's slope is materially steeper than the listing describes.

One listing calls it a *"perfect gentle rolling lot."* LISTING The lidar says otherwise: **81.7 ft of relief** across the lot, an in-lot average grade of **18.4% (10.4°)**, and a maximum of **25.6% (14.3°) over a 50-ft run** immediately below the road. That is a **moderate-to-steep** building site requiring engineered grading, almost certainly retaining structures, and a stepped or daylight-basement foundation. GIS-DERIVED

Property B is the opposite: in-lot average **3.7% (2.1°)**, max **7.3% over 50 ft** — genuinely **gently sloping**, exactly as its listing claims. **On buildability of the pad itself, Property B wins clearly.**

5 A zoning provision exists that was written for Property A's reservoir by name.

Clayton County Zoning Sec. 4.5(D), "J.W. Smith Reservoir" requires lots abutting the reservoir to be $\geq 50,000$ SF with ≥ 400 ft depth, imposes a **permanent 150-ft protection buffer** in which *no septic tank, absorption field, related structure or substantial structure* may sit, and states *"sanitary sewer to be installed unless EPD indicates such sewer should not be installed."* OFFICIAL

The lot **passes** both numeric tests (**57,954 SF, ~416 ft deep**, measured). The buffer consumes roughly **36% of the lot depth**, leaving about **237 ft of usable depth** — a real but manageable constraint. **Whether sewer or septic governs is unresolved and is the single most consequential open question on Property A.**

6 Both soils are rated "Very limited" for septic — for different reasons, and Property B's is worse.

USDA NRCS rates the septic-absorption suitability of **both** sites **"Very limited" (1.00)**. OFFICIAL

- **A — Gwinnett sandy clay loam (GwE2)**, 10–25% slopes: limited by **slope (1.00)**, depth to **paralithic bedrock at 50 in (0.77)** and slow percolation (0.50). Hydrologic group B, low shrink-swell (LEP 1.5%).
- **B — Zion silt loam (ZnE)**, 10–25% slopes: limited by **indurated lithic bedrock at only 30 in (1.00)** *and* slope (1.00). Hydrologic group C, saturated conductivity as low as **2 µm/s**, and **LEP 7.5% — high shrink-swell**. Surface erodibility K = 0.43.

Zion's 30-inch hard rock is the single most dangerous soil fact in this report. Georgia requires 24 in of clean vertical separation below a drainfield trench; with rock at 30 in the margin is almost nil. A conventional 5-bedroom drainfield may not be permittable in Zion soil at all. REQUIRES A SOIL-CLASSIFIER EVALUATION AND PERC TEST

7 Flood risk is genuinely low at both — the only unambiguously clean finding.

FEMA's National Flood Hazard Layer returns **Zone X — "Area of Minimal Flood Hazard"** at both coordinates, SFHA = False, **no Base Flood Elevation** published, no floodway. Panels 13063C0165F (eff. 7 Jun 2017) and 13181C0050B (eff. 17 Apr 2020). Neither lot is in a Special Flood Hazard Area, so **no federal flood-insurance mandate and no minimum finished-floor elevation flows from FEMA**. OFFICIAL

Both counties are also **Piedmont crystalline bedrock — no karst, no sinkhole risk**.

> The two things that most separate these properties

PROPERTY A WINS ON

- **Schools 1.8 miles away** — Michelle Obama STEM Elementary and Eddie White Middle are both at 11808 Panhandle Rd; Lovejoy High 3.8 mi. Property B: all three schools **18.1 mi / ~41 min** each way, for 13 years.
- **Emergency department ~22 min** (Piedmont Fayette); four EDs within 35 min; Level I trauma ~45 min. Property B: nearest ED **~45 min** at a small rural hospital; Level I trauma **~98 min**; nearest urgent care **~49 min, in South Carolina**.
- **Hartsfield-Jackson 21 mi / ~43 min**, ~220 nonstop destinations, with a MARTA rail link. Property B: ATL is **135 mi / ~3h15m**.
- **Hindu Temple of Atlanta 17.7 mi / ~32 min**, in the same county; 3 Indian restaurants within 30 min; ~15,000–30,000 Asian Indian residents within an hour. Property B's nearest Hindu temple is **81.7 mi / ~2h23m, in another state**; no gurdwara within 100 mi.
- **Groceries 2.9 mi, Walmart 4.3 mi, hardware 4.9 mi**. Property B is 3×–10× further on every category; no grocery, pharmacy, bank or fuel within 14 miles.
- Affluent immediate area: **tract median household income \$119,872** vs county \$59,806.

PROPERTY B WINS ON

- **A genuinely usable lake**. Clarks Hill / Thurmond is **71,100 acres with ~1,200 miles of shoreline, no horsepower or motor restrictions**, open year-round, with marinas and public ramps. This is the real difference: A's water body is legally closed to meaningful recreation; B's is one of the largest reservoirs in the eastern United States.
- **A gentle, easily buildable pad** — 3.7% average grade across the lot, vs 18.4% at A.
- **Small schools**: student-teacher ratios 13.6–15.5 vs 16.9–21.7; a high school of 367 students vs Lovejoy's 2,136.
- **Twice the land** (2.14 ac vs 1.33 ac) for **less than half the price** (\$55,000 vs a \$125,000 asking / \$85,000 last sale).
- **Quiet**. Atlanta Motor Speedway is **7.5 mi / ~17 min** from Property A — inside the audible envelope of NASCAR Cup weekends, with race-day traffic on the same two-lane roads the lot depends on.
- Lower radon potential (Zone 3 vs Zone 2) and no reservoir-buffer overlay.

> Construction cost for a 5-bedroom home — the headline answer

Scenario	A — 3,500 SF heated, 5 BR	B — 3,100 SF heated, 5 BR
Low	\$575,800 (\$164/SF)	\$621,000 (\$200/SF)
Likely	\$833,600 (\$238/SF)	\$940,600 (\$303/SF)
Practical high (~80th pct)	~\$1,060,000 (\$303/SF)	~\$1,223,000 (\$394/SF)
Best local finished comparable	\$565,000	\$422,000

Scenario	A — 3,500 SF heated, 5 BR	B — 3,100 SF heated, 5 BR
Build cost as % of comp	148%	223%
Paper loss before paying for land	~ \$269,000	~ \$519,000

The counter-intuitive result, and it is robust

The smaller house on the cheaper land costs about \$107,000 more to build — \$65/SF more. Drivers in order of size: fixed site costs spread over less floor area (\$43/SF of site cost at B vs \$31/SF at A); a **~\$59,000 rural mobilisation premium**; longer driveway, water line and power run plus a propane system A does not need; covenant-mandated premium materials (standing-seam metal roof, ~900 SF of deep porch); and higher overhead, profit and contingency justified by a thin bidder pool and a **15-month covenant deadline to complete construction.** ESTIMATE

In Waterpointe, \$541,000–\$565,000 already buys a finished large home against \$833,600 to build one — a saving of roughly \$280,000 for substantially the same product. If the objective is a large house at or near its cost, buying beats building at both locations, and by a wide margin at B.

The decision in one paragraph

These are not two versions of the same thing. Property A is a steep, well-serviced, well-schooled metro-fringe lot with excellent access to hospitals, an airport and a South Asian community — whose "lakefront" is a legal fiction for recreational purposes. Property B is a gentle, cheap, remote lot on a magnificent real lake — whose waterfront status, dock rights and septic capacity are all unproven, and whose distance from schools and emergency medicine is permanent and unfixable. **If anyone in the household is school-age, elderly, medically vulnerable, flies often, or wants South Asian community access, Property A is in a different category.** Property B makes sense only for a buyer whose central purpose is lake recreation and solitude — **and only after USACE confirms in writing, for Lots 130 and 131 specifically, that a dock is possible.** Until that letter exists, Property B should be valued as a *lake-view* lot, not a *lakefront* one.

Property identification & mapping

Identity, listing record, recorded plat reference, and parcel geometry measured from official GIS.

1 Property identification

Field	Property A — Waterpointe	Property B — Stillwater Coves
Exact address	12396 Edgewater Dr #23, Hampton, GA 30228	1147 & 1153 Watersedge Cove, Tignall, GA 30668
Lot / block / unit	Unit 3, Lot 23 OFFICIAL	Lots 130 and 131 (two separate recorded lots) OFFICIAL
Subdivision / community	Waterpointe	Stillwater Coves
County, state	Clayton County , Georgia — unincorporated	Lincoln County , Georgia
Parcel / APN	05050A A003	10A 130 (Lot 130); Lot 131 APN not retrieved NOT FOUND
Acreage	1.3304 ac = 57,954 sq ft (measured from the official polygon; county GIS reports 57,943 sq ft — agreement to 0.02%) GIS-DERIVED	2.14 ac total — 1.07 ac each per MLS LISTING ; 2.149 ac measured over the reconstructed footprint GIS-DERIVED
Lot dimensions	Road frontage 130.3 ft · sides 418.3 / 415.5 ft · rear (lake side) 148.1 ft · perimeter 1,112.2 ft GIS-DERIVED	Reconstructed ~99 ft × ~471 ft per lot. MLS gives " Frontage Length 198.0 ft " and " Lot Size Dimensions 1.07 Ac " LISTING PLAT REQUIRED
Recorded plat	Plat Book 27, Page 24 OFFICIAL	Not retrieved — Lincoln County qPublic returns HTTP 403 and the county parcel feature service requires a token NOT FOUND
Current deed	Deed Book 12617, Page 0653 (2021) OFFICIAL	Covenants at Deed Book 165, pp. 246–293 ; lot deed not retrieved
Owner of record	MCKNIGHT DESMOND — mailing 3136 Elmwood Ct, Atlanta, GA 30349 OFFICIAL	Not retrieved. Seller-posted HOA classified names Shari Schiller , 732-674-2403 LISTING
Last recorded sale	31 Aug 2021 — \$85,000 OFFICIAL	Not retrieved NOT FOUND
Assessment	Appraised \$60,000 / assessed \$24,000 ; land use "Residential vacant"; CUVA flag YES; commission district 3 OFFICIAL	Not retrieved NOT FOUND
Zoning	RS-180 Single-Family Residential OFFICIAL	R-1 per the MLS field; ordinance text unobtainable LISTING
Coordinates (centroid)	33.416126°N, 84.369809°W (county _inside point)	33.941877°N, 82.564164°W
Water body	J.W. Smith Reservoir — 250 ac, CCWA-owned drinking-water supply, impounding Shoal Creek , dam completed 1984 , 42.5 ft high, "High hazard" class (NID GA03893) OFFICIAL	J. Strom Thurmond Lake (Clarks Hill) — 71,100 ac, ~1,200 mi shoreline, USACE Savannah District, full pool 330 ft msl OFFICIAL

A naming quirk on Property A worth carrying into the title search

In the National Hydrography Dataset and Clayton County's basemap the reservoir is mapped as **two polygons** split by the North Bridge Road crossing: the northern lobe carries the GNIS name "**Club Lake**" (GNIS ID 00312768, 134.5 ac) — **this is the lobe the subject lot fronts** — and an unnamed southern lobe of 114.4 ac. 134.5 + 114.4 = 248.9 ac, matching CCWA's stated 250 acres. **If a survey, deed or title commitment refers to "Club Lake," it means J.W. Smith Reservoir.** OFFICIAL

Legal description

Property A — the assessor's legal is "**Unit 3, Lot 23, Waterpointe**," referencing **Plat Book 27, Page 24**, Clayton County, in Land Lots 50, 51, 78 & 79 of the 5th District. The full metes-and-bounds legal description must be taken from the recorded plat and the current deed (DB 12617 / PG 0653).

OFFICIAL FULL LEGAL REQUIRES THE RECORDED INSTRUMENTS

Property B — **Lots 130 and 131, Stillwater Coves**, Lincoln County. The governing Declaration of Covenants was recorded 15 June 2006 at Deed Book

2 Listing information and photographs

On photographs — what we could and could not retrieve

Zillow, Redfin detail pages and realtor.com all actively block automated retrieval (HTTP 403 / 429 / bot interstitials). For **Property B** we recovered the **three MLS photographs that exist** on the listing record. For **Property A** no listing photograph could be retrieved from any source. NOT FOUND

In their place — and in our view a better evidentiary basis for due diligence — this report uses **USGS NAIP aerial orthoimagery**, which is **public domain**, geometrically accurate, and lets the parcel boundary, the road, the tree cover and the shoreline be measured rather than merely viewed. It appears throughout Parts A and B.

Listing field	Property A	Property B
Status	Marketed as vacant land; currently-active status not confirmed	Active, MLS last updated 7 Oct 2026
Asking price	\$125,000 reported by one aggregator; \$98,000 by another — the two conflict LISTING	\$55,000 for both lots together (\$25,701/ac)
MLS number	Not retrieved	98224174 (Hive MLS); prior IDs 540522, 526694, 98223284
Listing agent / brokerage	Marketing attributed to "The Chance Sells Team" in an archived listing	Clay Turner, Turner Realty, 706-359-3930. A realtor.com snippet instead shows "Meybohm Real Estate – Evans" — confirm who holds the listing
Price history	Last recorded sale \$85,000 (Aug 2021) against a \$60,000 appraisal	\$149,000 (16 Mar 2024) › removed › \$49,900 (15 Apr 2025) › \$55,000 (12 Jun 2026) = -63%
HOA fee quoted	\$13–\$39/month per aggregator; bylaws indicate \$240/yr built, \$100/yr unbuilt	\$650 annually (\$54.17/mo)
Marketing description	"1.33 acre lake front lot... nicely wooded, perfect gentle rolling lot" — our lidar measurement contradicts "gentle" (see §7)	Two adjacent 1.07-ac waterfront lots, "Both are DOCKABLE", "direct waterfront access", gently sloping, paved roads, underground utilities, protective covenants
Waterfront field (structured)	—	"Lake Privileges" — notably not "dock permit" or "dock in place"
Days on market	Not retrieved	148 days on Redfin; 64 views, 2 favourites
Listing URL	redfin.com/GA/Hampton/12396-Edgewater-Dr-30228/home/25184182 realtor.com/realestateandhomes-detail/12396-Edgewater-Dr_Hampton_GA_30228_M65547-02384	redfin.com/GA/Tignall/1147-Waters-Edge-Cv-30668/home/136965615 realtor.com/realestateandhomes-detail/1147-Lot-130_Tignall_GA_30668_M98358-85247

A material find — the owner's own advertisement on the HOA website

The Stillwater Coves HOA classifieds page carries a seller-posted advert dated 19 Feb 2025: "Lot 130 and 131 – dockable – \$65K each, \$110K for both, owner financing optional." OFFICIAL — HOA WEBSITE

This establishes three things: (a) 1153 = Lot 131, confirming the second lot; (b) owner financing may be available; and (c) a price contradiction — the owner advertised \$110,000 for the pair in Feb 2025 while the MLS carried \$49,900 in Apr 2025. Ask the agent to reconcile.

A second advert on the same page is directly relevant to dock risk: "Lot 174 and 176 ... is Dockable. I have a dock permit but Corps of Engineers requires a new one in your name." That is a correct statement of USACE policy — and it shows that sellers who actually hold permits say so. The subject listing makes no such claim.

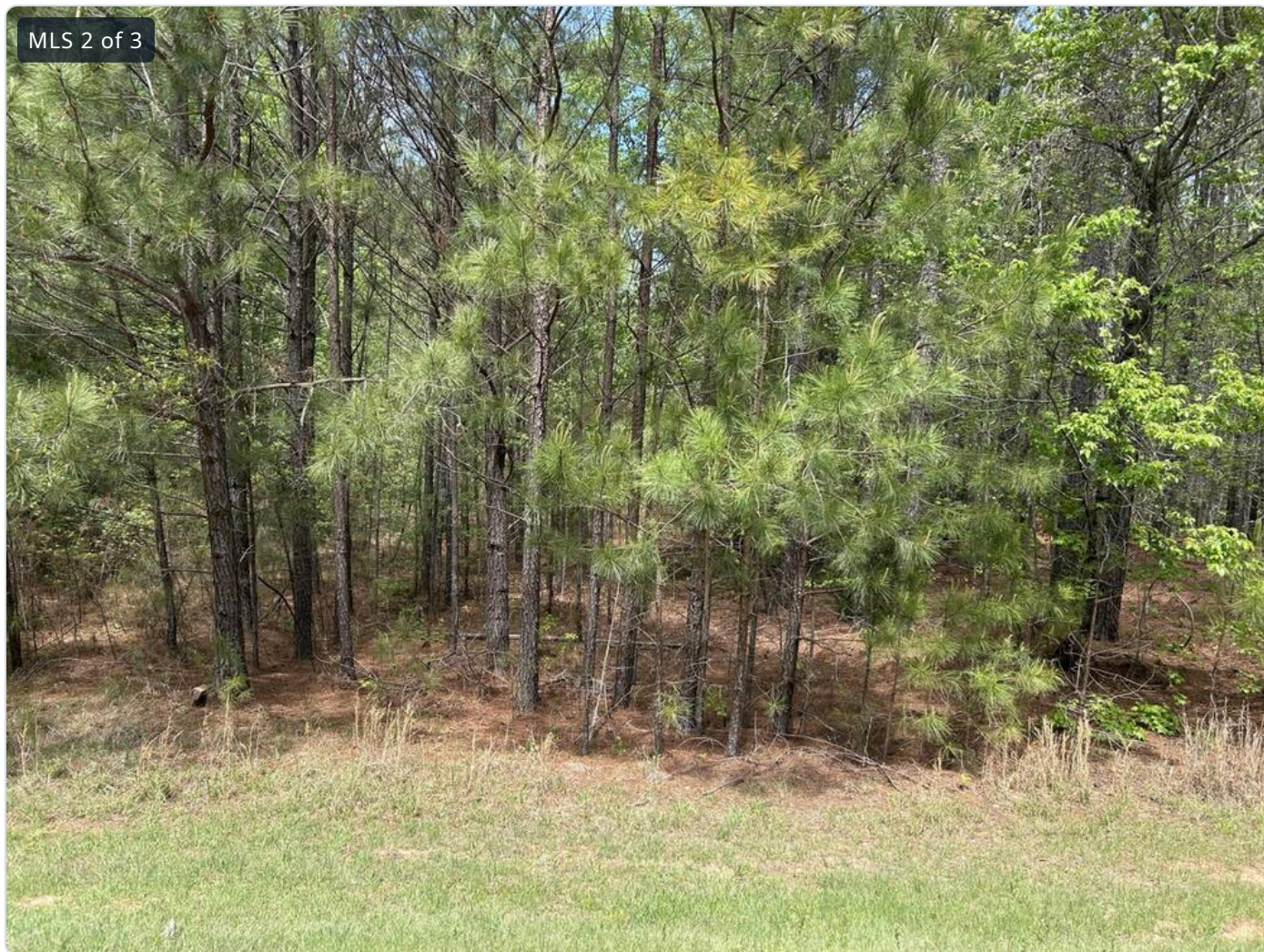
Property B — the MLS photographs LISTING

Only three photographs exist on the MLS record — sparse for a lakefront listing, and itself a mild signal. Reproduced here for due-diligence purposes; copyright remains with the listing broker / Hive MLS.



Lot frontage and interior — mature hardwood cover, gently sloping ground

MLS 2 of 3



Interior of the lots looking through the tree cover



Surrounding neighbourhood character, Watersedge Cove

Figure A-1. The three MLS photographs for 1147 & 1153 Watersedge Cove (Lots 130 & 131), Stillwater Coves. Source: Hive MLS #98224174 via Redfin CDN. Note the mature hardwood cover, the gentle grade, and that **no photograph shows open water, a shoreline or a dock** — consistent with our measurement that the nearest full-pool water lies roughly 199 ft beyond the lot boundary.

Comparable asking prices in Stillwater Coves LISTING

Address	Lot	Asking	Note
1117 Watersedge Cv	125	\$136,000	marketed dockable lakefront
1135 Watersedge Cv	128	\$143,250	marketed dockable lakefront
1147 & 1153 Watersedge Cv	130 & 131	\$55,000 (both)	subject — ~5× per-acre discount to the above
1165 Watersedge Cv	—	~\$422,000	new-construction home, "on a dockable lot"
1284 Striper Cv	—	\$145,500	
1250 Striper Cv	—	\$94,500	0.82 ac, "dock potential (subject to Corps approval)"
1476 Rock Point Cv	—	\$130,000	
1549 Treasure Cv	—	\$76,000	
1313 / 1309 Shimmering Water Cv	—	\$50,000 ea	
1416 Rock Point Cv	—	\$35,000	
1296 Edge Ln	—	\$32,890	1.70 ac interior wooded
1336–1348 Magnolia Ct	—	\$18,600–\$28,560	interior lots

Read on the comps: lots on the same street that brokers specifically enumerate as dockable ask **\$136k–\$143k per acre-sized lot**. The subject pair asks **\$55,000 for two acres**. The subject's per-acre price sits with the *interior* lots, not the waterfront ones. That is the market pricing these lots as non-dockable, whatever the remarks say. **No verified sold comparables for Stillwater Coves could be obtained** — pull actual Lincoln County deed transfers from the Clerk of Superior Court for real comps. NOT FOUND

3 Official recorded plat & boundary

A Plat reference obtained

The recorded plat is **Plat Book 27, Page 24**, Clayton County **OFFICIAL**. The **plat image itself was not retrievable** — Clayton County's deed/plat imaging portal is not openly accessible and qPublic is behind Cloudflare. **Order a certified copy from the Clayton County Clerk of Superior Court.**

In its place we obtained the **digitised parcel polygon from the Tax Assessor's live GIS** — which is derived from that plat — together with all 43 neighbouring parcels, the road centrelines, the building footprints and the reservoir polygons. Figure A-2 is drawn from those official geometries and functions as a plat-equivalent for diligence purposes. **GIS-DERIVED**

B Plat not obtained — and it matters more here

No recorded plat, plat book reference or digitised boundary could be obtained for Lots 130/131. Lincoln County's qPublic site returns **HTTP 403** to automated requests and the county's ArcGIS parcel service (**Parcel_Regions_w_WinGAP_CivicPlus_view** , owner **lincolnpw**) **requires an authentication token** despite the item being flagged public. **NOT FOUND**

The plat date is not a formality here. USACE Thurmond SMP ¶16.a provides that in county-certified subdivisions platted **on or after 1 May 2018, only community docks will be authorised**. The 2006 covenants suggest the subdivision predates that — but **the plat (or any replat) for the Watersedge Cove phase must be dated from the Lincoln County plat book before relying on any individual-dock possibility.**



Figure A-2 — Property A: plat-equivalent boundary map, true scale. Drawn from the Clayton County Tax Assessor parcel service, basemap road centrelines, building footprints and NHD-derived waterbody polygons, all retrieved 7 Oct 2026. GIS-DERIVED The subject parcel is 05050A A003 (Unit 3, Lot 23). Note that the **road frontage (130.3 ft) is narrower than the rear lake-side line (148.1 ft)** — the lot widens toward the water. The hatched band is the **150-ft reservoir protection buffer of Zoning Sec. 4.5(D)(3)**, drawn from the rear lot line (the conservative reading — see §12). **Parcel lines in county GIS are expressly disclaimed by Clayton County as not a true representation of boundaries; a boundary survey is required for permitting.**

SURVEY REQUIRED

Property A — measured boundary, corner by corner GIS-DERIVED

Line	From › To	Length (ft)	Length (m)	Bearing	Character
L1	C1 › C2	148.1	45.1	252.83°	Rear line — faces the reservoir
L2	C2 › C3	418.3	127.5	342.30°	West side line
L3	C3 › C4	116.7	35.6	74.38°	Road frontage, Edgewater Dr
L4	C4 › C5	13.6	4.1	73.80°	Road frontage (second segment)
L5	C5 › C1	415.5	126.6	159.84°	East side line
Perimeter		1,112.2	339.0	County GIS reports 1,112.1 ft — agreement to 0.1 ft	
Area		57,954 sq ft = 1.3304 ac		County GIS reports 57,943 sq ft	

Corner coordinates (WGS84) and corner elevations

Corner	Latitude	Longitude	Elevation (ft, NAVD 88)	Position
C1	33.4156561	-84.3693728	810.5	Rear / east, nearest the water
C2	33.4155360	-84.3698365	814.4	Rear / west
C3	33.4166312	-84.3702532	887.7	Road / west
C4	33.4167176	-84.3698848	891.2	Road
C5	33.4167280	-84.3698421	891.7	Road / east — highest corner

Elevations sampled from the USGS 3DEP 1-metre lidar DEM at each corner. **The road corners stand 73–81 ft above the rear corners** — the first quantitative indication that this is not a gentle lot. Bearings are grid bearings measured clockwise from true north in a local equirectangular projection

centred on the parcel; they are **not** plat bearings and must not be used in place of the recorded plat. GIS-DERIVED

4 GIS / aerial parcel mapping and discrepancy analysis



Figure A-3 — Property A on USGS NAIP aerial orthoimagery, with the official parcel boundary overlaid. 340 m across, north up. OFFICIAL IMAGERY —
PUBLIC DOMAIN BOUNDARY GIS-DERIVED Edgewater Drive runs east-west across the upper part of the frame; **J.W. Smith Reservoir occupies the lower right.** The lot is heavily wooded. Note the cleared, graded driveway-and-pad corridor on the neighbouring parcel immediately west — a useful precedent for what building on these deep, sloping lots actually requires, and a visible indication of the extent of clearing needed. Large custom homes with pools are visible on adjoining lots.



Figure A-4 — Property A, wider context. 1,240 m across. The reservoir's northern lobe ("Club Lake") wraps the southern and eastern edge of the subdivision. The subject lot sits on the south side of Edgewater Drive, backing onto CCWA land.

OFFICIAL IMAGERY



Figure A-5 — Property B on USGS NAIP aerial orthoimagery. 460 m across, north up. **OFFICIAL IMAGERY** **LOT OUTLINE IS A RECONSTRUCTION, NOT A SURVEY** Watersedge Cove and its two cul-de-sac bulbs run across the lower half of the frame; the imagery was flown during a lake drawdown, so **exposed shoreline and mudflat are visible at the top**, which usefully reveals how far the water retreats. Between the road and the water is an unbroken band of mature forest. Faint straight clearings are surveyed lot lines. **The dashed yellow line is the 330-ft full-pool contour and the dotted orange line the 346-ft elevation that defines the USACE purchase boundary** — both derived from the lidar DEM. The distance between the reconstructed rear lot line and the water is the central factual question on this property.



Figure A-6 — Property B, wider context. 1,520 m across. The Watersedge Cove peninsula is surrounded on three sides by arms of Clarks Hill Lake — which is why the lot is 11 miles from Lincoln in a straight line but **18.1 miles by road**. [OFFICIAL IMAGERY](#)

Discrepancies identified between GIS, plat, listing and our measurements

#	Discrepancy	Detail and our assessment
D1	A Which line is the frontage	A secondary analysis of this parcel reported ~147.5 ft of frontage on Edgewater Drive and ~129.8 ft at the rear. That is reversed. We established orientation three independent ways: (i) the C4/C5 corners lie 18.5 and 24.9 ft from the Edgewater Drive centreline while C1/C2 lie 434.7 and 453.8 ft away; (ii) C3–C5 stand at 888–892 ft elevation and C1–C2 at 810–814 ft, and the subdivision road runs along the ridge; (iii) the NAIP imagery shows the road to the north and the water to the south. Road frontage is the 130.3 ft line; the 148.1 ft line faces the reservoir. GIS- DERIVED
D2	A "Gentle rolling lot"	The listing's characterisation is contradicted by 1-metre lidar: 81.7 ft of relief, 18.4% average in-lot grade, 25.6% maximum over 50 ft. See §7. Treat the listing's topography language as marketing.
D3	A "Private access to lake"	An MLS listing for a neighbouring Waterpointe lot advertises private lake access. CCWA Rule 5 states access "shall be made only at the entrance gate," and Rule 8 prohibits wading, swimming or bathing. The two cannot both be true. OFFICIAL

#	Discrepancy	Detail and our assessment
D4	A RS-180 lot-depth ratio	RS-180 caps lot depth at $2.5 \times \text{lot width} > 2.5 \times 130.3 = 326 \text{ ft maximum}$, yet the lot is ~416 ft deep ; and Sec. 4.5(D)(2) separately requires $\geq 400 \text{ ft of depth}$ for lots abutting this reservoir. These two provisions are mathematically irreconcilable for any lot narrower than 160 ft. The lot was platted in 1988, so it is almost certainly a lawful non-conforming lot of record — but get that confirmed in writing. OFFICIAL NEEDS A ZONING DETERMINATION
D5	A Where the 150-ft buffer is measured from	Sec. 4.5(D)(3) says the buffer adjoins " <i>the reservoir property</i> " (= the rear lot line); Sec. 4.6(E) says adjoining the reservoir property " <i>from the normal full-pool elevation</i> " (~33 ft further out). The difference is ~4,400 sq ft of lot. Sec. 4.6(E)'s own conflict rule says the more restrictive standard governs , so assume measurement from the rear lot line. OFFICIAL
D6	A Asking price	\$125,000 vs \$98,000 reported by different aggregators, against a \$60,000 county appraisal and an \$85,000 August 2021 sale. Establish the actual current price and status with the listing broker. LISTING
D7	B "DOCKABLE"	Asserted in the remarks; contradicted by the structured "Lake Privileges" field, by sibling listings that enumerate dockable lots without 130/131, by the ~5× per-acre price discount, and by the absence of any claimed permit. The single most important item to resolve. See §26.
D8	B Price: owner vs MLS	Owner's HOA advert, Feb 2025: \$110,000 for both . MLS, Apr 2025: \$49,900 for both ; now \$55,000. A 2.2× gap within two months. LISTING
D9	B Road frontage type	MLS records "Road Frontage Type: City Street, State Road" for an interior subdivision cul-de-sac. Implausible — almost certainly a data-entry error. Watersedge Cove is a private or subdivision street. LISTING
D10	B Address-point geometry	The Esri geocoder places 1105–1177 Watersedge Cove as 13 perfectly evenly spaced points 99.8 ft apart on a line whose bearing (60.6°) differs from the mapped road centreline (75.3°) , drifting from 2 m off the road at 1105 to 267 ft off at 1147. These are interpolated address points, not surveyed building sites. We used the along-street station but not the lateral offset. GIS-DERIVED
D11	B Which "frontage" is 198 ft	MLS gives "Frontage Type: Lakefront; Frontage Length: 198.0 ft". For a waterfront listing this normally means <i>water</i> frontage, but 198 ft is also exactly $2 \times$ the 99.8 ft address-point spacing, which suggests <i>road</i> frontage. Unresolved without the plat ; our reconstruction assumes 99 ft of road frontage per lot. NOT FOUND
D12	B County of record	Listing portals index the property under "Tignall, GA 30668," a Wilkes County post office. The parcel is in Lincoln County . Affects every regulatory enquiry. OFFICIAL

How Property B's boundary was reconstructed — and the limits of it

Because no plat or parcel polygon is obtainable, Figure A-5's lot outline is a **reconstruction** built from: the OpenStreetMap-traced Watersedge Cove centreline (verified against NAIP imagery); the along-street stations of the 1147 and 1153 address points projected perpendicularly onto that centreline; a lot width of **99 ft** (from the 198-ft MLS frontage $\div 2$, corroborated by the 99.8-ft address-point spacing); a depth of **471 ft** solved from the stated 1.07-acre area; and an axis perpendicular to the road (bearing 345.3°). ESTIMATE

It reproduces the stated area to within 0.4% (2.149 ac measured vs 2.14 ac stated), which is reassuring but not probative. The **shape** could be materially different — lake-subdivision lots are frequently pie-shaped or follow the shoreline. **Every distance-to-water figure in this report for Property B therefore carries the reconstruction's uncertainty, and must be re-derived from the recorded plat and a boundary survey.** SURVEY REQUIRED

Topography & terrain

Measured from USGS 3DEP lidar-derived digital elevation models at 1-metre ground sample distance. Vertical datum NAVD 88.

Method, and what these numbers are and are not

Elevations throughout Part B are sampled from the **USGS 3D Elevation Program (3DEP)** seamless DEM, served by the USGS ImageServer and resampled to a 1-metre ground grid over an 840 m × 840 m window centred on each lot. The underlying lidar collections are **GA_Central_2019_B19 (1 m, flown Dec 2019 – Jun 2020)** for Property A and the Georgia 3DEP coverage for Property B. Vertical datum is **NAVD 88**; vertical accuracy of 3DEP lidar is typically **~10 cm RMSE** in open terrain and poorer under dense canopy. OFFICIAL SOURCE DATA ALL DERIVED VALUES GIS-DERIVED

This is a model-derived surface, not a survey. Contours, elevations, slopes and the sections below are accurate enough to classify terrain, size grading and foundations, and decide whether to proceed — and **not** accurate enough for permitting, floodplain determination, septic layout or construction staking. Each of those requires a **topographic survey by a Georgia-licensed land surveyor**. PROFESSIONAL SURVEY REQUIRED BEFORE DESIGN

5 True-scale topographic maps

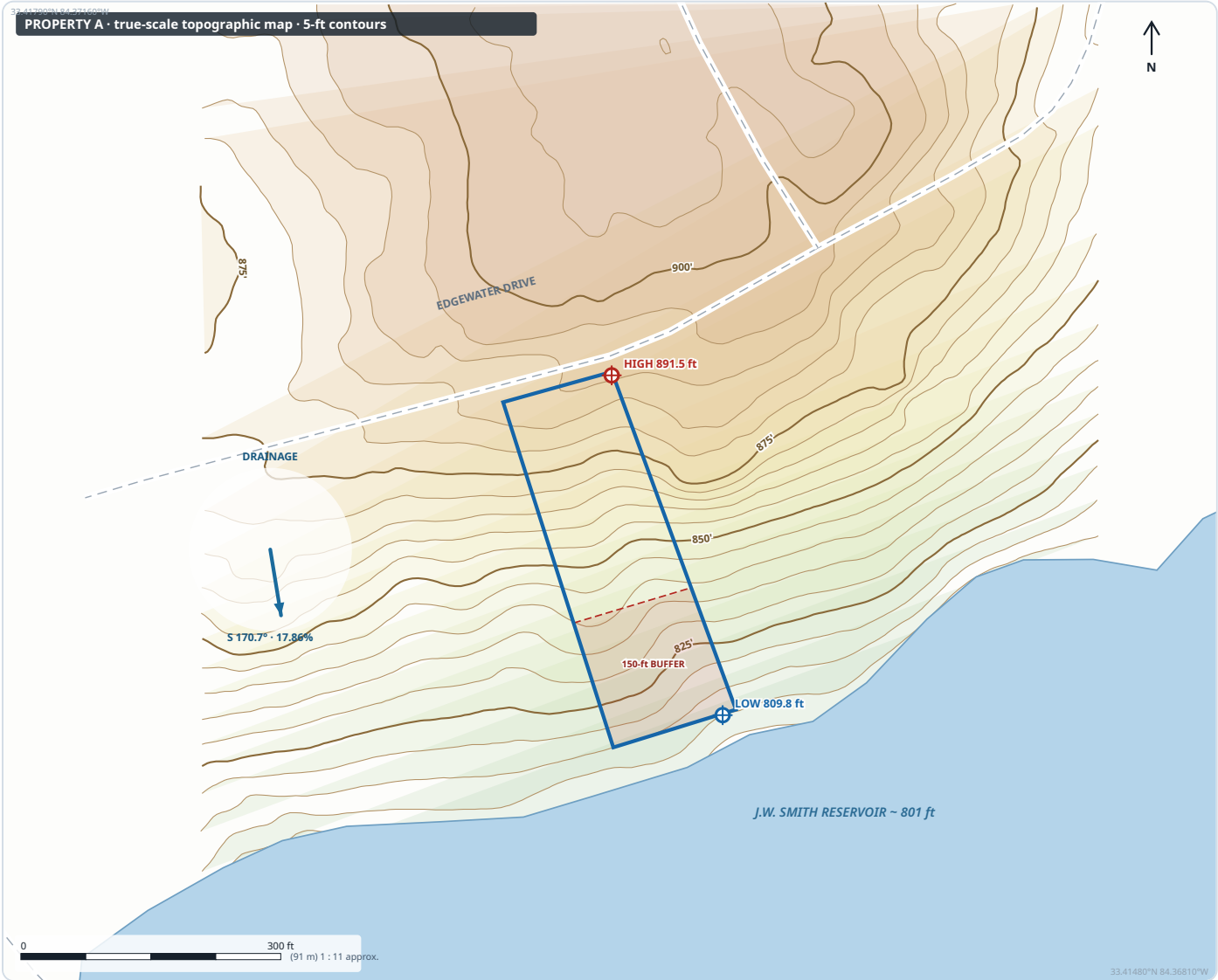


Figure B-1 — Property A: true-scale topographic map. North up, with graphic scale bar and north arrow. Contours at the selected interval, derived from the 1-metre lidar DEM and lightly smoothed (5-cell mean) to suppress canopy noise. GIS-DERIVED
The lot falls **continuously and steeply from Edgewater Drive at ~892 ft to the reservoir edge at ~801 ft**. Contours are tightly spaced through the upper and middle thirds — the signature of a sustained slope, not rolling ground. Drainage is **due south (bearing 170.7°)** straight into the reservoir, at a mean grade of 17.9%.

HIGHEST POINT ON LOT 891.5 ft — at the road, 33.41672, -84.36984	LOWEST POINT ON LOT 809.8 ft — rear/east, 33.41564, -84.36942	RELIEF ACROSS LOT 81.7 ft of fall	MEAN / MEDIAN ELEVATION 850.0 ft (median 847.1)	WATER SURFACE (LIDAR) 801.2 ft — reservoir
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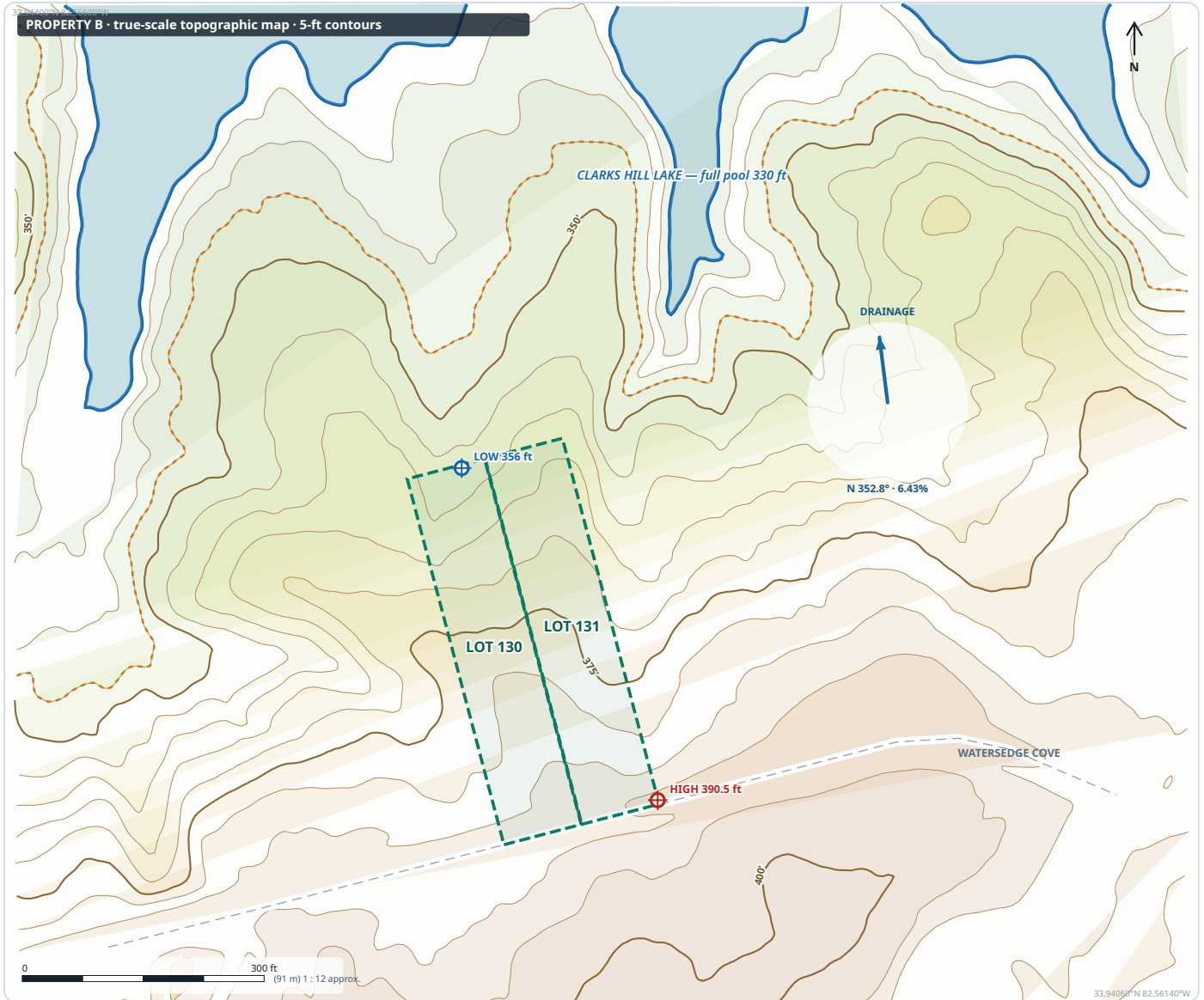


Figure B-2 — Property B: true-scale topographic map. North up. GIS-DERIVED LOT OUTLINE RECONSTRUCTED

The contrast with Figure B-1 is immediate: contours across the reconstructed lot are **widely spaced** — this is gentle ground. The tight contour bunching lies **beyond** the rear lot line, on the federal strip descending to the water. **The bold dashed line is the 330-ft full pool; the dotted line is the 346-ft elevation defining the USACE purchase boundary.** Both lie outside the reconstructed lot. Drainage is **due north (352.8°)** toward the lake at a mean grade of 6.4%.

HIGHEST POINT ON LOT

390.5
ft — at the road,
33.94128, -82.56347

LOWEST POINT ON LOT

356.0
ft — rear/NW, 33.94242,
-82.56427

RELIEF ACROSS LOT

34.5
ft of fall

MEAN / MEDIAN ELEVATION

375.0
ft (median 375.5)

LOT LOW POINT ABOVE FULL POOL

26.0
ft above 330.0 ft

Property B — the measurement that most matters

Across the **entire** reconstructed 2.14-acre footprint the lowest ground is **356.0 ft**. Full pool is **330.0 ft**. The lot's low point therefore sits **26 ft above the lake surface at full pool**, and **10 ft above the 346-ft elevation at which the federal purchase boundary was set**. Measured distances from the reconstructed lot to the relevant contours:

Nearest ground at 346 ft — the USACE boundary elevation	86.7 ft beyond the lot, bearing 56°
Nearest ground at 330 ft — full pool shoreline	198.9 ft beyond the lot, bearing 42.5°
Nearest ground at 326 ft — normal winter pool	418.3 ft beyond the lot
Water surface in the lidar epoch (a drawdown)	325.3 ft

GIS-DERIVED

SUBJECT TO THE BOUNDARY RECONSTRUCTION

Interpretation. Even allowing generously for reconstruction error, the lot does not reach the water. There is a band of land — on the evidence, federal fee land — between the rear lot line and the lake, and at winter pool the walk to water's edge is of the order of **400+ ft**. That is entirely normal for a Thurmond Lake lot and **not by itself a defect**; USACE acquired to elevation 346 ft everywhere. But it does mean **"direct waterfront access" describes a right to walk across public land, not ownership of frontage** — and it is why the dock question in §26 is decisive rather than incidental.

6 Longitudinal terrain cross-sections — road to lake

On vertical exaggeration — both views are shown, as requested

Terrain sections are conventionally drawn with the vertical axis exaggerated, because at true scale a natural hillside is almost invisible. Exaggeration is honest only if it is disclosed, so **each section below is drawn twice: at the chosen exaggeration, and immediately beside it at a true 1:1 scale** in which one foot vertical equals one foot horizontal. **The 1:1 panel is what the ground actually looks like.** Use the slider to see how the impression changes while the numbers do not. Profiles are sampled at ~1-ft stations and are **not** smoothed or idealised — the real convexities, benches and breaks in grade are preserved.

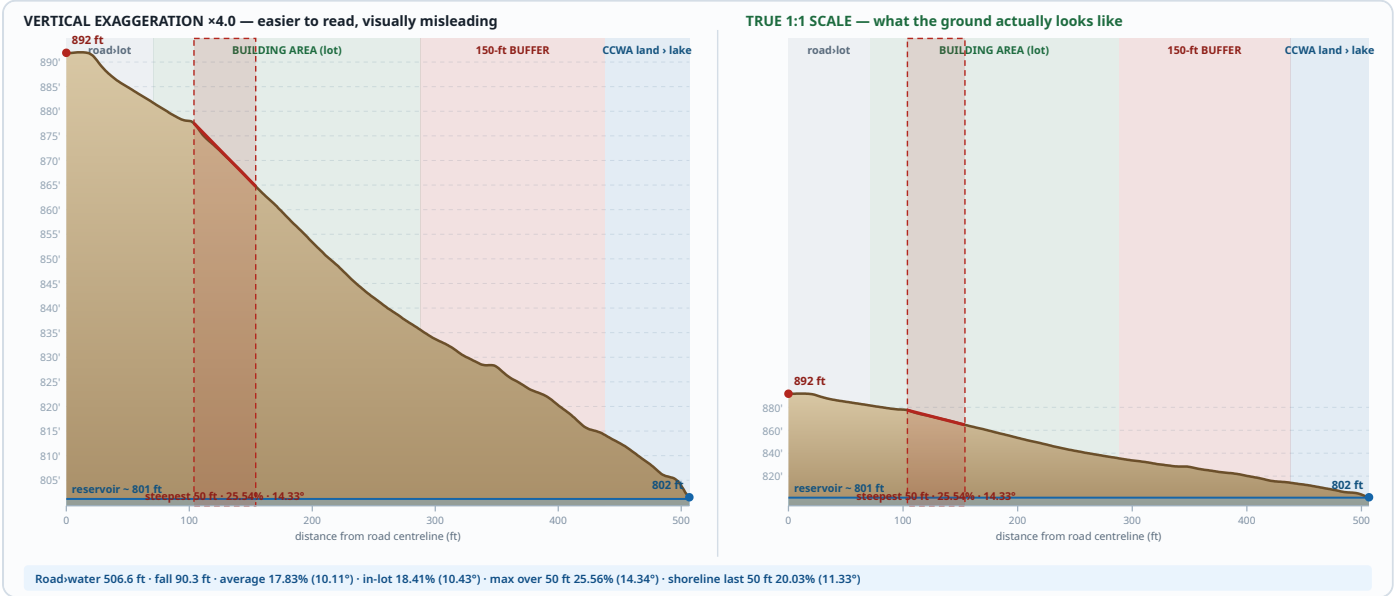


Figure B-3 — Property A: road-to-lake longitudinal section. Left panel exaggerated as selected; right panel at true 1:1 scale. The section runs from the Edgewater Drive centreline, through the front of the lot, the prospective building area, the rear of the lot and the 150-ft reservoir buffer, to the water's edge. GIS-DERIVED

The profile is **concave-upward and sustained** — it steepens immediately below the road, holds 18–25% through the upper half, then eases slightly before a renewed 20% pitch at the shoreline. There is **no natural bench or flat building pad anywhere on this lot.**

Measurement — Property A, road to water	Value	Note
Horizontal distance, road centreline to water's edge	506.6 ft	154.4 m
Maximum elevation on section	892.0 ft	at the road
Minimum elevation on section	801.5 ft	at the waterline
Total elevation difference	90.3 ft	27.5 m of fall
Average grade, road to water	17.83%	10.11°
Within the lot only (front line to rear line, 365.1 ft)	18.41%	10.43°; 67.2 ft of fall
Maximum grade over any 50-ft run	25.56%	14.34° — 13.11 ft of rise in 50 ft, at station 105–156 ft from the road
Direct rise angle at the lake side (last 50 ft of land)	20.03%	11.33° — 10.01 ft of rise in 50 ft
Approximate drainage direction	S, 170.7°	mean in-lot grade 17.86%
Contours crossed (5-ft interval)	~18	805, 810 ... 890 ft

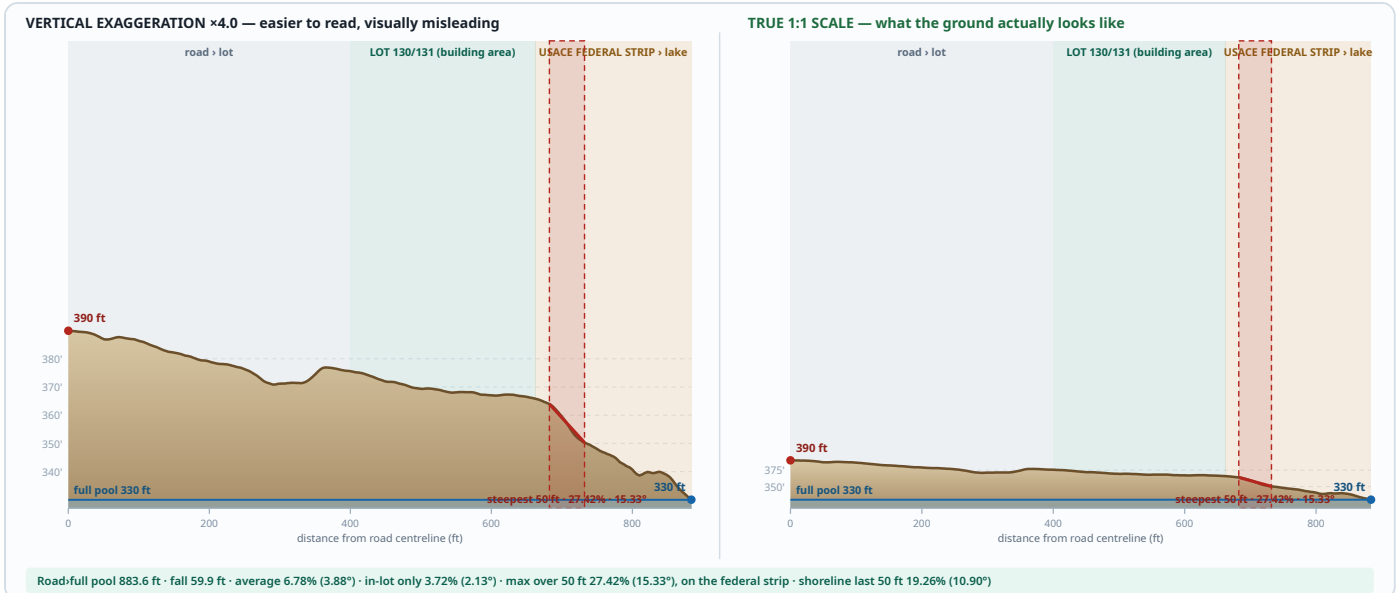


Figure B-4 — Property B: road-to-lake longitudinal section. Left panel exaggerated as selected; **right panel at true 1:1 scale.** The section runs from the Watersedge Cove centreline on bearing 42.5° — the bearing that reaches full-pool water soonest — through the reconstructed lot and across the federal strip to the 330-ft shoreline. **GIS-DERIVED**

The shape of this profile is the **opposite** of Property A's: a long, almost level upper reach across the buildable ground, then **all of the fall concentrated in the final ~220 ft** beyond the rear lot line. At 1:1 the lot itself looks genuinely flat — because it very nearly is.

Measurement — Property B, road to full pool	Value	Note
Horizontal distance, road centreline to 330-ft shoreline	883.6 ft	269.3 m, on bearing 42.5°
Maximum elevation on section	389.9 ft	at the road
Minimum elevation on section	330.1 ft	full pool
Total elevation difference	59.9 ft	18.3 m of fall
Average grade, road to water	6.78%	3.88°
Within the lot only (section crosses 399.6 > 662.1 ft, a 261-ft chord)	3.72%	2.13° ; only 9.7 ft of fall — and max just 7.33% over any 50 ft
Rear lot line to the water (221.2 ft of federal strip)	16.18%	9.19° ; 35.8 ft of fall
Maximum grade over any 50-ft run	27.42%	15.33° — 13.65 ft of rise in 50 ft, at station 682–732 ft, i.e. on the federal strip, not on the lot
Direct rise angle at the lake side (last 50 ft of land)	19.26%	10.90° — 9.63 ft of rise in 50 ft
Approximate drainage direction	N, 352.8°	mean in-lot grade 6.43%
Contours crossed (5-ft interval)	~12	330, 335 ... 390 ft

Reading the two sections together — the single most useful comparison in this report

Property A has 90 ft of fall in 507 ft, all of it on the lot. Property B has 60 ft of fall in 884 ft, almost none of it on the lot. The two maximum 50-ft grades are nearly identical (25.6% vs 27.4%) — but on Property A the steepest ground is **where you have to build**, and on Property B it is **on land you will never build on**.

Put plainly: **Property A's slope is a construction problem. Property B's slope is a walk to the water.** If the steep reach on Property B deters you, the answer is a path or steps across the federal strip — subject to a USACE licence, since improved walkways require one and are **not** permitted in Protected Shoreline areas. On Property A the answer is retaining walls and engineered fill measured in tens of thousands of dollars.

The requested dedicated slope visualisation: lot length, lot height, shoreline angle and worst 50-ft angle



Figure B-5 — Dedicated slope diagram for both lots, drawn at true 1:1 scale. For each property the panel shows the length of the lot along the fall line, the height (total rise) across it, the direct rise angle at the lake side measured over the last 50 ft of land, and the maximum rise angle found anywhere along the transect over a 50-ft run, with that worst run located and highlighted. The right-hand inset of each panel is an angle gauge comparing the two angles against reference grades. [GIS-DERIVED](#)

Requested slope metric	Property A	Property B
Length of lot along the fall line	~416 ft (415.5–418.3 ft side lines)	~471 ft (reconstructed)
Height (rise) across the lot	81.7 ft	34.5 ft
Lot grade, end to end	18.4% / 10.4°	3.7% / 2.1° (along the section chord)
Direct rise angle at the lake side (last 50 ft of land before water)	11.33° (20.03%)	10.90° (19.26%)
Maximum rise angle over any 50-ft length	14.34° (25.56%)	15.33° (27.42%)
Where that worst 50 ft occurs	On the lot, 105–156 ft below the road — squarely in the likely building zone	Off the lot, 682–732 ft from the road, on the federal strip
Rise in that worst 50 ft	13.11 ft	13.65 ft

7 Terrain classification and grading implications

Assessment	Property A	Property B
Classification	MODERATE SLOPE, locally steep 18.4% average in-lot; 25.6% max over 50 ft; 81.7 ft relief on 1.33 ac	GENTLE SLOPE (nearly flat in parts) 3.7% average in-lot; 7.3% max over 50 ft; 34.5 ft relief on 2.14 ac
Where it sits on the standard scale	Flat <2% · Nearly flat 2–5% · Gentle 5–10% · Moderate 10–20% ◀ · Steep 20–30% · Very steep >30%	Flat <2% · Nearly flat 2–5% ◀ · Gentle 5–10% · Moderate 10–20% · Steep 20–30% · Very steep >30%
Minimal grading	No	Plausible for a single-storey pad
Significant grading	Yes — unavoidable	Modest
Cut-and-fill	Yes — substantial, balanced cut/fill pad required	Light

Assessment	Property A	Property B
Retaining walls	Very likely — plan for them	Possibly a low garden wall; not structurally necessary
Extensive site engineering	Yes — civil design, erosion & sediment control plan, stormwater management	Standard rural lot engineering
Indicated foundation strategy	Stepped footings, daylight/walk-out basement, or pier-and-beam on the downhill side. A flat slab-on-grade would require a large engineered pad and walls.	Slab-on-grade or crawlspace both feasible with routine site preparation.
Driveway	Long, graded, likely 10–15% in places with a cut section; retaining and drainage needed	Long but near-level
Erosion risk during construction	High — steep slope, wooded lot being cleared, inside a drinking-water supply watershed where E&S control will be scrutinised	Moderate — but Zion surface soil has $K = 0.43$, a high erodibility factor, so bare soil will move

Property A: what the slope actually costs

18.4% average grade over a 416-ft-deep lot, combined with the **150-ft rear buffer** that pushes the building envelope uphill into the steepest third, is the central engineering problem on this property. The practical consequences, all of which belong in a build budget:

- An engineered cut-and-fill pad, with the cut on the uphill (road) side and fill downhill
- **Retaining structures** — segmental block or engineered wall — almost certainly required; anything over 4 ft high needs engineered design and a permit
- A **stepped or daylight-basement foundation** is the economical answer to this slope, and happens also to be the one that suits a lake-view lot
- **Septic on an 18% slope** is already rated "Very limited" by NRCS specifically *because* of slope; trenches must run on contour, which constrains where the house can sit
- Driveway grade, drainage, culverts and a turnaround
- Georgia land-disturbance permitting and an E&S plan — in a water-supply watershed

8 Three-dimensional terrain models



Figure B-6 — Three-dimensional terrain surfaces. Built from a 64 × 64 sample of the 1-metre lidar DEM over roughly 660 m × 660 m at each site, rendered as a shaded wireframe surface with hypsometric tinting and the water plane shown at the controlling pool elevation. The lot outline, the road and the fall-line section are projected onto the surface. [GIS-DERIVED](#)

Property A (upper) reads as a single uniform hillside running down to the reservoir — the subdivision road sits on the ridge and every lot on the south side is a slope. **Property B (lower)** reads as a broad, nearly level plateau that ends in a short steep bluff at the lake. The difference in building difficulty is visible without reading a number.

Property A — slope direction and exposure

Aspect is **due south (170.7°)** — the lot faces the water and the sun. Practical effects: excellent passive-solar and daylight potential for a lake-facing house; strong afternoon heat gain on west-facing glazing; a south-facing slope dries fastest after rain, which helps construction access but **accelerates runoff straight toward the reservoir**. All surface water from this lot discharges into a public drinking-water supply, which is precisely why the 150-ft buffer and the watershed ordinance exist.

Property B — slope direction and exposure

Aspect is **due north (352.8°)** at a gentle 6.4%. A north aspect means the lake view is to the north, so **a lake-facing house gets soft indirect light rather than direct sun on its main elevation** — pleasant in a Georgia summer, and worth knowing before orienting the plan. North slopes hold moisture longer and dry more slowly, which matters for a drainfield in a hydrologic-group-C soil. The gentle grade means runoff is slow, which is good for erosion and bad for shedding water away from a slab — **positive drainage away from the house will need to be designed, not assumed**.

Flood, elevation & drainage

FEMA determinations queried directly from the National Flood Hazard Layer at each lot's coordinates.

9 FEMA flood-zone determination

FEMA attribute	Property A	Property B
Flood zone	ZONE X	ZONE X
Zone subtype	"AREA OF MINIMAL FLOOD HAZARD"	"AREA OF MINIMAL FLOOD HAZARD"
Special Flood Hazard Area (SFHA)	False — not in an SFHA	False — not in an SFHA
Shaded Zone X (0.2% annual chance)?	No — unshaded Zone X	No — unshaded Zone X
Static BFE	None published (-9999)	None published (-9999)
Depth / velocity	None (-9999)	None (-9999)
Dual zone	False	—
Study type	NP — not a detailed study at this location	NP
DFIRM ID	13063C (Clayton County)	13181C (Lincoln County)
FIRM panel	13063C0165F , panel 0165, suffix F	13181C0050B , panel 0050, suffix B
Panel effective date	7 June 2017	17 April 2020 (preliminary 14 Mar 2018)
Panel type / scale	Countywide, panel printed; 1:12,000; orthophoto base	Countywide, panel printed; 1:24,000; orthophoto base
Flood hazard boundary feature at point	None intersecting	None intersecting
Floodway	None at the parcel	None at the parcel
County parcel record flood flag	FLOODPLAIN = NO OFFICIAL	—

Queried from the FEMA NFHL MapServer (layers 28 Flood Hazard Zones, 27 Flood Hazard Boundaries, 3 FIRM Panels, 16 Base Flood Elevations) at the exact lot coordinates on 7 Oct 2026. OFFICIAL **Note:** the Property A point also falls within the footprint of Henry County panel 13151C0140D — an artefact of proximity to the county line. The governing panel is the Clayton County one. Verify and retain a **FEMA Flood Insurance Rate Map print** and, if lending requires it, a **Letter of Map Amendment search** from msc.fema.gov.

What Zone X means in practice for both lots

- **No federal flood-insurance purchase requirement** for a federally backed mortgage. Insurance remains available and inexpensive under a Preferred Risk Policy, and is worth buying on a lake lot regardless.
- **No FEMA-driven minimum finished-floor elevation**, because there is no Base Flood Elevation at either site. Any minimum floor elevation will come from the building code (positive drainage away from the structure), the county, or good practice — **not** from the floodplain ordinance. See §13.
- **No floodplain-development permit** triggered, and no Elevation Certificate required.
- Both findings are consistent with the measured topography: Property A's low point stands **8.6 ft** above the reservoir's normal surface and Property B's stands **26 ft** above full pool. Neither lot is plausibly inundated by the 1% flood.

Two flood-adjacent risks that FEMA maps do not show

Property A — dam hazard classification. The J.W. Smith dam is classed "**High hazard**" in the National Inventory of Dams (GA03893) — meaning failure "will probably cause loss of human life" *downstream*. The subject lot is **upstream-adjacent**, i.e. beside the impoundment and not in the failure inundation path, so this is **not a direct risk to the parcel**. The official inundation mapping sits in the dam's Emergency Action Plan, held by CCWA and the Georgia Safe Dams Program. Last recorded inspection January 2016, condition "Satisfactory". OFFICIAL

Property B — reservoir operating range, not flooding. Thurmond Lake is actively regulated. Full pool is 330 ft; **normal winter pool is 326 ft (15 Oct – 15 Dec)**, returning to 330 ft Jan–May. Drought operations go lower: the lake registered **324.28 ft in Dec 2025 (drought trigger L1)** and **322.05 ft in Jan 2026 (L2)**, and stood at **319.96 ft on 7 Oct 2026 — about 10 ft below full pool**. OFFICIAL — USACE This is not a flood risk; it is a **usability risk**, and it is the reason the SMP allows permittees to "chase water." It also means **right now is close to an ideal time to inspect this lot**, because the shoreline is as exposed as it gets.

10 Third-party and forward-looking flood risk

Source	Property A	Property B
First Street Foundation (Flood Factor)	NOT RETRIEVED First Street's property-level API requires a commercial licence and its public site blocks automated access. Check manually at firststreet.org or via the Flood Factor tab on the Redfin listing pages. We decline to quote a Flood Factor we could not verify.	
FEMA National Risk Index — county inland-flood rating	Relatively Moderate (score 87.79); 0.50 events/yr; county EAL \$30.2 M	Very Low (score 12.72); 0.107 events/yr; county EAL \$1.37 M
FEMA NRI — census tract inland-flood rating (the relevant geography)	Relatively Low	Relatively Moderate
NRI overall risk — tract	Relatively Low (31.6)	Relatively Moderate (67.8)
Estimated flood depth at the lot	None modelled — outside any mapped flood area	None modelled
Future projections	Neither lot is coastal, so sea-level rise is irrelevant. The credible forward risk at both is higher-intensity convective rainfall , which is a stormwater and erosion design question (§45) rather than a floodplain one.	

The county-level flood ratings invert at tract level — and the tract is what matters

Clayton County rates worse than Lincoln County for flooding at county scale, but **Property A's own census tract (406.36) rates Relatively Low** and **Property B's tract (9701) rates Relatively Moderate** — the reverse. NRI composite scores are percentile bands weighted by *dollars at risk*, so a dense urbanised county scores badly because it has more to lose. **Read the tract row, not the county row.** OFFICIAL — FEMA NRI

11 Ground elevations and relationship to the water

Elevation measure (ft, NAVD 88)	Property A	Property B
Lowest natural ground elevation on the lot	809.8	356.0
Highest natural ground elevation on the lot	891.5	390.5
Average (mean) site elevation	850.0	375.0
Median site elevation	847.1	375.5
Relief (max - min)	81.7	34.5
Controlling water-surface elevation	801.2 — reservoir surface measured from lidar County hydrography maps the lobe at 247 m ~ 810 ft; the lidar-measured surface is the better figure	330.0 — USACE full pool (regulated) lidar epoch surface 325.3 ft; winter pool 326 ft
Lot low point above the water	+8.6 ft	+26.0 ft
Lot high point above the water	+90.3 ft	+60.5 ft
Area measured from DEM cells inside the boundary	1.334 ac (5,400 cells)	2.149 ac (8,697 cells)

12 Base Flood Elevation (BFE)

There is no BFE at either property, and none is required

FEMA publishes a Base Flood Elevation only inside Special Flood Hazard Areas with a detailed study. Both lots are **Zone X / minimal hazard** with `STATIC_BFE = -9999` and `STUDY_TYP = NP`, and a query of NFHL layer 16 (Base Flood Elevations) returns **no BFE line at either coordinate**. OFFICIAL

Question asked	Property A	Property B
Official BFE, if one exists	None — none exists	None — none exists
Applicable FEMA flood elevation	Not applicable outside an SFHA	Not applicable outside an SFHA
Relationship of the lot to the BFE	Entire lot is outside the 1% and 0.2% annual-chance floodplains	Entire lot is outside the 1% and 0.2% annual-chance floodplains
Difference between lowest ground and BFE	Not computable — no BFE. The lot's lowest ground is 8.6 ft above the reservoir's normal surface , which is the only meaningful local datum.	Not computable — no BFE. The lot's lowest ground is 26.0 ft above regulated full pool .
The datum that actually governs instead	Clayton Zoning Sec. 4.5(D)(3) — the 150-ft reservoir protection buffer, measured from the reservoir property line (or full pool, per the ambiguity at D5). This, not a flood elevation, is what restricts where you may build.	USACE purchase boundary at elevation 346 ft. Everything below the government property line is public land. There is no Corps-required setback from that line, but any encroachment across it — including roof overhangs — must be removed .

13 Minimum finished-floor elevation

Because there is no BFE, the usual arithmetic does not apply — and we will not invent one

The requested calculation is `estimated BFE + required freeboard = minimum finished-floor elevation`. **With no BFE at either property, that equation has no inputs.** Georgia's floodplain freeboard requirements (commonly BFE + 1 ft to + 3 ft depending on the local ordinance) apply only *within* a Special Flood Hazard Area. Neither lot is in one. OFFICIAL

Per the brief's instruction, we have specifically not assumed that fill is permitted. It mostly is not, in the places it would matter.

Determination	Property A	Property B
Minimum FFE from FEMA / floodplain rules	None imposed	None imposed
Governing minimum instead	International Residential Code (2024 edition, in force in Georgia) grading provisions — finished grade must fall away from the foundation, and the floor must sit above adjacent grade with positive drainage. No reservoir-driven floor elevation exists.	Same IRC grading provisions. No USACE-driven floor elevation exists; USACE regulates only land below the 346-ft boundary, which the lot does not include.
Is the existing terrain adequate?	Yes, for flood purposes — abundantly. The constraint here is slope, not elevation .	Yes — 26 ft of freeboard above full pool on the lowest ground.
Is fill necessary?	Not for flood reasons — but substantial cut-and-fill is needed to create a level building pad on an 18% grade. That is a grading problem, and it is regulated: Sec. 38-144.1(b) minimises grading and filling in stream setbacks, Sec. 4.6(A) requires the 150-ft buffer be "left in their natural undisturbed state," and a county land-disturbance permit with an erosion & sediment control plan will be required in a drinking-water supply watershed. Do not assume fill in the buffer is available at any price.	No. Routine site preparation only.
Must the house be elevated?	No	No

Determination	Property A	Property B
Restrictions on slab / crawlspace / pier?	None from floodplain rules. Real constraints come from (i) the 18% slope, which favours a stepped foundation or daylight basement ; (ii) paralithic bedrock at ~50 in , which raises the cost of any deep excavation; (iii) NRCS rating "Very limited" for dwellings both with and without basements , on slope grounds.	None from floodplain rules. Real constraints come from the soil: indurated lithic bedrock at ~30 in makes a basement impractical to impossible without rock excavation, and LEP 7.5% (high shrink-swell) in the Zion subsoil argues for a stiffened/post-tensioned slab or a crawlspace on properly prepared subgrade. NRCS also rates Zion "Very limited" for dwellings .
Freeboard we would nonetheless specify	Not a flood matter, but on both lots we would set the finished floor at least 12–18 in above final adjacent grade with graded swales, and on Property A specifically design for uphill surface water interception — a cut-slope above a house on an 18% grade collects water that must be taken around the structure. ESTIMATE — GOOD PRACTICE	

Soil, foundation, septic & garden

USDA NRCS SSURGO horizon data and engineering interpretations, queried at each lot.

14 Soil characteristics

Queried from the **USDA NRCS Soil Data Access** service against the SSURGO database using a polygon intersection over each lot: soil survey areas **GA625** (Clayton, Fayette and Henry Counties) and **GA645** (Lincoln and Wilkes Counties). **OFFICIAL**

Soil property	Property A	Property B
Map units present on/around the lot	GwE2 — Gwinnett sandy clay loam, 10 to 25 percent slopes, eroded W — Water (the reservoir)	ZnE — Zion silt loam, 10 to 25 percent slopes (<i>at the lot centre</i>) PeE3 — Pacolet sandy clay loam, 10 to 25 percent slopes, severely eroded CeB — Cecil sandy loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes
Soil series	Gwinnett (100% of the map unit)	Zion (100%), with Pacolet (88%) and Cecil (95%) nearby
Taxonomic class	Fine, kaolinitic, thermic Rhodic Kanhapludults — Ultisols	Fine, mixed, active, thermic Ultic Hapludalfs — Alfisols
Mapped slope range (low / representative / high)	10 / 18 / 25 %	10 / 18 / 25 % (Zion); 2 / 4 / 6 % (Cecil)
Drainage class	Well drained	Well drained
Hydrologic soil group	B — moderate infiltration	C (Zion) — slow infiltration, high runoff potential B for Pacolet and Cecil
Surface texture	Sandy clay loam — 55.5% sand, 14.5% silt, 30% clay	Silt loam — 29.1% sand, 53.4% silt , 17.5% clay
Subsoil texture (Bt horizon)	Clay — 23.3% sand, 29.2% silt, 47.5% clay	Clay — 23.3% sand, 29.2% silt, 47.5% clay
Saturated hydraulic conductivity (Ksat)	9 µm/s throughout — moderately slow	2 µm/s in the Bt (25–56 cm) — very slow ; 9 in the surface; 0.2 at bedrock
Shrink-swell (linear extensibility, LEP)	1.5% — LOW	7.5% in Bt and Bt2 — HIGH
Depth to restrictive layer	127 cm (50 in) — paralithic bedrock, "moderately coherent" (weathered, rippable)	77 cm (30 in) — lithic bedrock, "indurated" (hard rock requiring blasting or hammering)
Depth to seasonal groundwater	No water table recorded within the profile OFFICIAL	No water table recorded within the profile
Soil pH (1:1 water)	5.8 uniformly to 163 cm — moderately acid	5.3 surface > 5.9 > 6.2 at depth
Organic matter	2.0% in the top 13 cm, then 0.25%	1.25% in the top 25 cm, then 0.25%
Cation exchange capacity (CEC-7)	7.5 surface > 6.0 > 4.5 cmol/kg — low	17 in Bt, 15 in Bt2 — moderate (reflects the mixed mineralogy)
Available water capacity	0.14–0.15 cm/cm — moderate	0.17 surface, 0.11–0.15 below
Bulk density (½ bar)	1.45 / 1.38 / 1.43 g/cm³	1.35 / 1.35 / 1.45 g/cm³
Erodibility — K factor (surface)	0.10 — low	0.43 — high
Erodibility — T factor / wind erodibility	T = 4; WEI 56	T = 2 (low tolerable loss); WEI 56
Mapped erosion class	Eroded (the "E2" in GwE2)	Zion: none; Pacolet: Class 3 — severely eroded
Hydric rating	No	No
Flooding / ponding frequency	None recorded	None recorded
Runoff class	None recorded for Gwinnett	Low (Cecil); not recorded for Zion

The Zion soil on Property B is the most serious technical finding in this report

Three properties combine badly, and all three are official NRCS data:

- 1. Indurated lithic bedrock at 77 cm (30 inches).** "Indurated" means hard, unweathered rock — not the rippable saprolite typical of the Piedmont. Georgia's septic rule requires **24 inches of clean vertical separation below the trench bottom** to rock. A conventional drainfield trench bottom sits roughly 18–30 in down. **The arithmetic barely works, and often will not.**
- 2. Linear extensibility 7.5% in the Bt and Bt2.** That is a **high** shrink-swell rating — expansive clay that moves with moisture. It is a foundation and slab-cracking risk and requires deliberate design.
- 3. Ksat of 2 µm/s in the Bt and hydrologic group C.** Water moves through this subsoil very slowly, which is exactly what a drainfield must not have.

NRCS accordingly rates Zion **"Very limited" (1.00)** for septic absorption fields, dwellings with and without basements, local roads, shallow excavations, small commercial buildings *and* lawns and landscaping. **Every single engineering interpretation is "Very limited."** OFFICIAL

The mitigating fact: the lot area also contains **Cecil sandy loam (CeB)** on 2–6% slopes, which NRCS rates **"Not limited" for dwellings** and only **"Somewhat limited" (0.498) for septic** — a genuinely good soil. SSURGO is mapped at roughly 1:15,840 and **cannot resolve which soil lies under a specific 2.14-acre lot.** **The commercial outcome of this purchase may turn entirely on whether the drainfield area is Zion or Cecil — and only a site soil evaluation by a Georgia-licensed soil classifier can answer that.** SOIL EVALUATION AND PERC TEST ARE MANDATORY PRE-PURCHASE ITEMS

Full horizon profiles OFFICIAL — SSURGO

Site	Series	Horizon	Depth (cm)	Depth (in)	Sand %	Silt %	Clay %	pH	OM %	Ksat µm/s	LEP %	AWC	CEC	K
A	Gwinnett	H1	0–13	0–5	55.5	14.5	30.0	5.8	2.00	9	1.5	0.14	7.5	0.10
		H2 (Bt)	13–91	5–36	23.3	29.2	47.5	5.8	0.25	9	1.5	0.14	6.0	0.20
		H3 (BC)	91–163	36–64	34.8	33.2	32.0	5.8	0.25	9	1.5	0.15	4.5	0.28
B	Zion	H1 (A)	0–25	0–10	29.1	53.4	17.5	5.3	1.25	9	1.5	0.17	—	0.43
		H2 (Bt)	25–56	10–22	23.3	29.2	47.5	5.9	0.25	2	7.5	0.15	17	0.20
		H3 (Bt2)	56–89	22–35	29.5	28.0	42.5	6.2	0.25	8	7.5	0.11	15	0.15
		R — bedrock	89–99	35–39	indurated lithic contact					0.2				
B	Cecil (the favourable unit)	A	0–15	0–6	69.9	20.2	9.9	5.3	0.50	28	0.4	0.13	2.1	0.24
		Bt	15–107	6–42	29.6	15.6	54.8	5.0	0.10	9	1.8	0.10	5.7	0.15
		BC	107–203	42–80	45.0	20.1	34.9	5.0	0.10	9	1.0	0.15	3.7	0.17
B	Pacolet	Ap	0–8	0–3	58.0	16.0	26.0	5.5	1.00	9	1.2	0.11	—	0.17
		Bt	8–48	3–19	48.0	12.0	40.0	5.0	0.25	9	1.9	0.13	—	0.15

LEP = linear extensibility percent (shrink-swell). AWC = available water capacity (cm/cm). CEC = cation exchange capacity at pH 7 (cmol/kg). K = Universal Soil Loss Equation erodibility factor. Ksat = saturated hydraulic conductivity.

NRCS engineering interpretations — the ratings that matter for building OFFICIAL

Interpretation	A — Gwinnett	B — Zion	B — Pacolet	B — Cecil
Dwellings without basements	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Not limited (0.00)
Dwellings with basements	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Not limited (0.00)
Septic tank absorption fields	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Somewhat limited (0.498)
Shallow excavations	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Somewhat limited (0.865)
Local roads and streets	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)
Small commercial buildings	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Somewhat limited (0.001)
Lawn, landscape, golf fairway	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Very limited (1.00)	Somewhat limited (0.75)

Septic absorption field — which factors cause the limitation, and how strongly

A Gwinnett	Slope 8 to >15% > 1.00 (full limitation); shallow to bedrock 100–180 cm > 0.772; percolation 60–180 cm > 0.498
B Zion	Shallow to bedrock > 1.00 and slope 8 to >15% > 1.00 — two independent full limitations
B Pacolet	Slope > 1.00; percolation 60–180 cm > 0.498
B Cecil	Slow water movement (percolation 60–180 cm) > 0.498 only — no slope or bedrock limitation

A caution about reading these ratings

"Very limited" in NRCS language means the soil has features *unfavourable* for the use and that overcoming them requires special design, significant extra cost or intensive maintenance. **It does not mean prohibited.** Houses are built on Gwinnett soils across metro Atlanta every day. For **Property A the limitation is slope**, which engineering solves with money. For **Property B's Zion the limitation is 30-inch hard rock plus slope**, and **rock depth is the one constraint money cannot reliably solve for a septic drainfield** — which is why the alternative soil (Cecil) on the same lot matters so much.

15 Foundation suitability

Foundation type	Property A — Gwinnett, 18% slope, rock at 50 in	Property B — Zion, 4% slope, hard rock at 30 in
Slab-on-grade	Possible but expensive. Requires a large engineered cut-and-fill pad and retaining on the downhill side. Low shrink-swell (LEP 1.5%) is favourable for a slab; the slope is not.	Feasible — with design for expansive clay. The gentle grade suits a slab, but LEP 7.5% argues for a stiffened or post-tensioned slab , or removal and replacement of the upper clay with engineered fill. A conventional thin slab on Zion Bt invites cracking.
Crawlspace	Good fit. A crawlspace absorbs grade change cheaply and avoids a large pad. Requires proper venting/encapsulation and positive drainage on a slope that sheds water toward the structure from above.	Probably the best choice. Keeps the structure off the expansive clay, needs only shallow excavation (staying above the 30-in rock), and allows services to be run and inspected.
Pier / beam	Well suited to the downhill side of a sloping lot; minimises cut and site disturbance — valuable in a drinking-water watershed where disturbance is scrutinised.	Workable; piers must bear below the active clay zone, and rock at 30 in limits pier depth — likely a shallow rock-bearing design.
Basement / daylight basement	The natural solution to this lot. 81.7 ft of fall means a walk-out lower level is nearly free architecturally, turning the slope liability into lake-view living space. But: paralithic bedrock at ~50 in means a full basement excavation will meet weathered rock — rippable, not blast-requiring, but a real cost line. NRCS rates basements "Very limited."	Impactical. Indurated lithic bedrock at 30 in would require rock excavation or blasting for any basement, and the gentle grade gives no daylight opportunity. Design for no basement.
Stepped foundation	Strongly indicated. Stepped footings following the grade are the standard economical answer to an 18% slope and avoid mass earthworks.	Not needed — grade does not require it.
Retaining walls	Expect them. Engineered design and permit required above 4 ft. Budget accordingly; on a 25% local grade a terraced arrangement may be necessary.	Not structurally required. Any low landscape wall is discretionary.
Geotechnical investigation advisable?	Yes — strongly. Piedmont saprolite weathers in place and depth to competent rock varies dramatically over short distances (10 ft in one boring, 60 ft 50 ft away). Multiple borings across the actual footprint, plus slope-stability review given the 25% local grade.	Yes — strongly, and for a different reason. You need to know (i) the true depth to the indurated contact across the footprint and the drainfield area, and (ii) the plasticity index / swell potential of the Bt clay. Combine the geotech with the soil-classifier evaluation for the septic permit.

The shared Piedmont caveat

Both lots sit on **Piedmont crystalline bedrock** (\$42). Ruling out sinkholes does not rule out geotechnical trouble: expect **variable depth to rock, perched groundwater and seeps at the saprolite/rock interface** (common on lake-adjacent slopes and directly relevant to both basement waterproofing and drainfield suitability), and **rock near the surface driving up the cost of footings, utility trenches and especially septic trenches.** GEOTECHNICAL INVESTIGATION

REQUIRED

16 Septic and sewer

Question	Property A	Property B
Is public sewer available?	GENUINELY UNRESOLVED — and it is the #1 question on this property. Evidence points both ways; see the box below. NOT CONFIRMED	No. Septic is required. OFFICIAL
Is septic required?	Only if sewer is unavailable	Yes

Question	Property A	Property B
Permitting authority	Clayton County Health District, Office of Environmental Services — (678) 610-7469	Georgia DPH East Central Health District , Lincoln County environmental health
Soil suitability for septic (NRCS)	Very limited — slope (1.00), rock at 50 in (0.772), slow percolation (0.498)	Very limited in Zion — rock at 30 in (1.00) <i>and</i> slope (1.00). Somewhat limited (0.498) if the field falls in Cecil.
Perc / soil evaluation requirement	Georgia requires a site evaluation by a licensed soil classifier or the county health department, including seasonal high groundwater and rock occurrence, plus a construction permit from the county health department before any physical development of the lot begins (Rule 511-3-1). OFFICIAL MANDATORY	
Minimum vertical separation	24 inches from trench bottom to seasonal groundwater, rock or impervious layer — greater if contamination potential is indicated. This is the rule that Property B's 30-inch rock collides with.	
Setback — drainfield from the water body	50 ft from the normal water level of any impoundment (state rule). Superseded here by the far stricter 150-ft reservoir buffer, in which septic is expressly prohibited.	50 ft from normal water level. Also note Lincolnton's water-supply intake is on Lake Thurmond, which raises a possible 150-ft water-supply-watershed buffer within 7 miles of the intake — verify applicability.
Setback — drainfield from wells / springs / sinkholes	100 ft	
Setback — drainfield from property lines, buildings without basements, drives	5 ft (10 ft from buildings with basements and from water supply lines)	
Setback — septic tank from lakes/ponds/impoundments	25 ft; 10 ft from property line; 15 ft from a ditch or embankment	
Does slope create septic difficulty?	Yes — slope is the primary rated limitation. On 18% grade trenches must run on contour, which dictates where the house can go, and the usable area is further cut by the 150-ft buffer.	Not on the lot itself (3.7% is ideal for a drainfield). Rock depth, not slope, is the problem here.

Property A — sewer or septic? The evidence, and why it matters so much

Pointing toward sewer	Pointing toward septic
◆ Zoning Sec. 4.5(D)(5): for lots abutting J.W. Smith Reservoir, <i>"sanitary sewer to be installed unless EPD indicates such sewer should not be installed."</i> RS-180 Sec. 3.6: connection to public water and sewer <i>"is preferred."</i> CCWA operates ~1,400 miles of sewer and three water reclamation facilities. Georgia Rule 511-3-1-.03(a): connection to public sewer is mandatory if available within 200 ft of the property line or in an abutting right-of-way.	The zoning ordinance devotes a whole section (Sec. 6.6) to septic lot-size standards and expressly contemplates septic in drinking-water supply watersheds. Sec. 4.5(D)(3) bars septic inside the 150-ft buffer — a rule with no work to do unless septic is contemplated on these very lots. 1–2 acre lots in a 1988 subdivision is the classic septic development pattern.

CCWA publishes no sewer service-area map; its full sitemap contains no such resource. NOT FOUND

› **Call CCWA Engineering on (770) 960-5207 and ask exactly this: "Is gravity sanitary sewer available in the Edgewater Drive right-of-way, within 200 feet of parcel 05050A A003?"** The answer swings the build budget by tens of thousands either way, decides whether the NRCS "Very limited" septic rating matters at all, and determines whether the bedroom-count analysis below applies.

◆ **If public water and sewer are NOT available: how many bedrooms can this lot support?**

This is the brief's specific question. We answer it from the official rules and the measured soil and geometry. ESTIMATE FROM OFFICIAL INPUTS ONLY A

SOIL EVALUATION AND COUNTY PERMIT CAN DECIDE IT

Step 1 — The Georgia tank-sizing rule (both properties)

Bedrooms	Minimum septic tank	Design flow at 150 gpd/bedroom
1–4	1,000 gal	600 gpd
5	1,250 gal	750 gpd
6	1,500 gal	900 gpd
7	1,750 gal	1,050 gpd

Ga. Comp. R. & Regs. **511-3-1-.05:** 1,000 gal for one to four bedrooms, plus **250 gal for each bedroom over four; capacity must be increased by 50% if a garbage grinder (disposal) is installed** — so a 5-bedroom house with a disposal needs **1,875 gal**. Two compartments required, first $\geq 2/3$ of liquid

capacity. Bedroom count is a **declared design input on the permit application, verified against the house plans** — it is not derived from floor area.

OFFICIAL

Practical money-saving note: omit the garbage disposal and save 625 gallons of tank capacity.

Step 2 — Property A: the binding constraint is usable area, not tank size

Clayton County Zoning Sec. 6.6 test	Requirement	This lot	Result
Minimum lot size for septic, with public water	25,000 sq ft of usable soil	~37,900 sq ft usable	Passes, ~12,900 sq ft margin
Minimum lot size for septic, with a private well	43,560 sq ft (1 acre) of usable soil	~37,900 sq ft usable	FAILS by ~5,700 sq ft
Absolute floor, any zoning district	25,000 sq ft usable	~37,900 sq ft	Passes

Derivation of "usable": gross 57,954 sq ft, **less** the 150-ft reservoir buffer (~20,000 sq ft), which Sec. 6.6(B) excludes on two independent grounds — it is "deemed undisturbed by a county or governmental office" and septic is **expressly prohibited** in it by both Sec. 4.5(D)(3) and Sec. 6.6(C). The state's 50-ft from-water exclusion is already inside that 150 ft, so there is no double count. Road right-of-way and any easements would reduce it further.

ESTIMATE

The answer for Property A — and a trap in the question

The brief asks what happens "if public sewerage AND water are not available." On Property A those two cases give opposite answers:

- **Public water + septic > septic appears feasible.** 25,000 sq ft required, ~37,900 sq ft available. On the **tank rule** alone a 5- or even 6-bedroom house is permissible.
- **Private well + septic > the lot FAILS the county's 1-acre usable-soil test** by roughly 5,700 sq ft. A well would not merely add cost; **it could render the lot unbuildable for any number of bedrooms** unless the Board of Health grants relief, which Sec. 6.6(C) allows it to consider case by case for existing platted lots.

Bedroom capacity estimate, assuming public water is available:

Most likely permissible	4 bedrooms comfortably; 5 bedrooms probable
5-bedroom house (the brief's target)	Probable but not assured. Sec. 6.6(A) expressly warns that for "larger homes, swimming pools, tennis courts or outbuildings" or where trees interfere, "the Clayton County Board of Health may require larger lots" or may not approve the proposal. A 5-bedroom house plus a pool plus a garage on an 18% wooded slope is exactly the fact pattern that provision is aimed at.
6+ bedrooms	Unlikely without a reduced footprint elsewhere or an advanced treatment system.
The real limiting factor	Slope, not area. NRCS rates slope a <i>full</i> (1.00) limitation. Drainfield trenches on 18% ground must follow the contour, and the only contour-parallel ground that is both outside the 150-ft buffer and not under the house or driveway is a narrow band. Lay out house, driveway and drainfield together, at concept stage.

ESTIMATE DECIDED ONLY BY A SOIL CLASSIFIER AND THE BOARD OF HEALTH

Step 3 — Property B: septic is certain, and capacity is the open question

The answer for Property B

Public sewer does not exist and will not. Septic is mandatory. And the covenants prohibit individual wells — Exhibit C of the recorded Declaration bars "no individual wells" OFFICIAL — so water must come from the community/county system (§19).

Bedroom capacity depends entirely on which soil the drainfield lands in:

If the field is in...	Likely outcome
Cecil (CeB) 2-6% slopes "Somewhat limited"	A 5-bedroom conventional system is realistic. No slope or rock limitation; only moderate percolation. 2.14 acres gives ample area for a 750-gpd field plus a reserve area.
Zion (ZnE) indurated rock at 30 in "Very limited" x2	A conventional 5-bedroom field may not be permissible at all. With rock at 30 in there is little or no room for the mandatory 24 in of separation below the trench. Realistic outcomes, in ascending cost: a reduced bedroom count (2-3); a shallow / low-pressure-pipe or drip-dispersal system; an engineered mound; or an advanced pre-treatment system (ATU) with a reduced field — each of which needs engineered design, county approval and ongoing maintenance contracts, and adds roughly \$15,000-\$45,000 over a conventional field. ESTIMATE
Pacolet (PeE3) slope-limited, severely eroded	Workable with contour trenches; no rock limitation recorded. Intermediate case.

> **This is why a soil evaluation must be a condition of the offer, not a post-closing task.** Two lots totalling 2.14 acres is generous area, which materially improves the odds of finding a compliant field somewhere on the property — **but note the USACE trap in §26: building one house and driveway across both lots causes the Corps to treat them as a single lot for dock purposes.**

◆ **If a private well were needed: what is the ideal depth for good-quality water?**

Well parameter	Property A — Clayton County	Property B — Lincoln County
Aquifer	Piedmont and Blue Ridge crystalline-rock aquifer (USGS national aquifer code N400PDMBRX) — confirmed for every USGS groundwater site in both counties OFFICIAL	
How water is produced	Not from pore space but from fractures and joints in crystalline bedrock , overlain by saprolite. Yield depends on intersecting water-bearing fractures, so two wells 100 ft apart can differ by an order of magnitude .	
Recorded well depths (USGS NWIS)	Same aquifer system; county-specific distribution not tabulated here	Median 190 ft; 25th–75th percentile 160–300 ft; maximum recorded 450 ft OFFICIAL
Recommended target depth for reliable, good-quality water	200–400 ft , cased through the full saprolite and at least 20 ft into competent rock	200–350 ft , with 300–400 ft as the contingency budget
Why that depth	Shallow saprolite wells are cheaper but are the ones that go dry in drought and are most exposed to surface contamination and septic influence . Going deeper into the fractured bedrock buys (i) a larger fracture catchment and so better drought resilience, (ii) a longer travel path from the surface, and (iii) storage in the borehole itself. Below roughly 400 ft in Piedmont rock, additional depth usually buys little extra yield — fracture density declines — and the risk of encountering mineralised water with elevated iron, manganese or radon rises. Lincoln County's drought frequency (60.9 events/yr in the FEMA NRI, the highest hazard frequency recorded for that county) is a direct argument for depth. ESTIMATE FROM OFFICIAL INPUTS	
Typical yield to design for	5–15 gpm is normal for Piedmont domestic wells; a 5-bedroom house needs roughly 8–10 gpm or a smaller yield with storage. Below ~3 gpm, a storage tank and booster set become necessary.	
Mandatory setbacks	100 ft minimum from any septic drainfield (and from sinkholes); locate the well upgradient of the septic system where physically possible; grout the annular space; steel casing through the saprolite.	
Water quality to test for at commissioning	Total coliform and <i>E. coli</i> , nitrate/nitrite, pH, hardness, iron and manganese (common and staining in Piedmont wells), radon in water (both counties sit on the granitic/gneissic rocks associated with radon), arsenic, lead, and uranium. Retest annually for bacteria.	
Indicative cost	\$8,000–\$25,000 drilled, cased, pumped and plumbed, depending on depth and whether rock is met shallow; ~\$17,000 is a reasonable single-figure allowance at 250–300 ft. ESTIMATE	
Is a well actually an option?	Legally yes, practically no — a well pushes the septic lot-size requirement to 1 acre of usable soil, which this lot fails . Use public water.	No — expressly prohibited by the recorded covenants . Exhibit C: no individual wells. A well would require a covenant variance from the Association. OFFICIAL

17 Gardening suitability

Garden factor	Property A — Gwinnett	Property B — Zion / Cecil
Soil pH	5.8 throughout OFFICIAL	5.3 surface, rising to 6.2 at depth
Interpretation	Moderately acid. Fine for blueberries, azaleas, potatoes and sweet potatoes; too acid for most vegetables, which want 6.2–6.8 , and well below the 6.5 brassicas prefer.	Strongly to moderately acid at the surface — more acid than A and needing more lime . The near-neutral subsoil is a genuine advantage for deeper-rooted perennials and fruit trees.
Drainage	Well drained; hydrologic group B	Well drained <i>classification</i> , but group C with Ksat 2 µm/s in the Bt — water perches on the clay after heavy rain. Raised beds materially improve this.
Organic matter	2.0% in the top 5 in, then 0.25%	1.25% in the top 10 in, then 0.25%
Interpretation	Both are low. A productive vegetable garden wants 4–5% organic matter. The thin topsoil over dense clay subsoil is the classic Georgia Piedmont profile, and both sites need substantial, repeated organic amendment . Note that on Property A the lot is mapped as "eroded" and on Property B the adjacent Pacolet is " severely eroded " — much of the original A horizon is already gone.	
Texture / composition	Surface sandy clay loam : 55.5% sand / 14.5% silt / 30% clay. Subsoil 47.5% clay. Workable surface, heavy subsoil.	Surface silt loam : 29.1% sand / 53.4% silt / 17.5% clay — a pleasant, fertile-feeling surface that crusts and erodes readily (K = 0.43) . Subsoil 47.5% clay.
Nutrient-holding capacity (CEC)	Low — 7.5 > 4.5 cmol/kg. Nutrients leach; feed little and often .	Moderate — 17 in the Bt . Holds nutrients better than A, a real advantage.
Available water capacity	0.14 cm/cm — moderate; a south-facing 18% slope sheds water and dries fast , so irrigation will be needed	0.17 cm/cm at the surface — better; the north aspect and gentle grade retain moisture
Shrink-swell in the root zone	LEP 1.5% — negligible	LEP 7.5% — the clay cracks in drought and swells when wet, which shears fine roots and is hard on shallow-rooted perennials planted directly in subsoil
Are raised beds advisable?	Yes. Primarily to defeat the slope — terraced raised beds on contour give you level planting, stop the soil washing downhill, and keep nutrients out of the reservoir. Secondly to fix pH and organic matter in a controlled volume.	Yes — emphatically. Raised beds are the direct answer to 30-inch rock (you cannot dig deep anyway), to the expansive clay , and to the slow-draining group-C subsoil . Build up rather than down.
Is imported topsoil / compost needed?	Yes. Budget bulk compost and topsoil for any bed, and plan annual compost top-dressing.	Yes, and more of it — lower organic matter, lower surface pH, and rock limiting the effective rooting depth.
A site-specific warning	Everything applied on this lot drains into a public drinking-water reservoir at 17.9% grade. Fertiliser and manure management is not merely good practice here — the watershed ordinance exists precisely to control this. Favour compost over soluble fertiliser, keep soil covered, and never leave bare earth on the slope.	K = 0.43 means bare silt loam will move in the first hard rain. Mulch continuously; the covenants also impose a \$1,000 penalty per tree removed , so clearing for a garden needs Association approval first.

Both properties: get a soil test before buying a single amendment. UGA Cooperative Extension soil tests cost roughly \$12–\$20 through the county Extension office and return pH, lime requirement, phosphorus, potassium, calcium, magnesium, manganese and zinc for the actual sample. **Nothing in SSURGO substitutes for it** — SSURGO describes a map unit, not your garden. SOIL TEST RECOMMENDED BEFORE AMENDMENT

18 Gardening and farming — what will actually grow

Both sites are humid subtropical (Köppen *Cfa*) with near-identical growing seasons — **236 days at A, 233 at B** (32 °F threshold) — so the plant lists are largely shared. The meaningful differences are the **half-zone split (A = USDA 8a, B = 8b)**, A's **south-facing 18% slope** (more heat, faster drainage, frost drains away downslope) and B's **north aspect with 30-inch rock** (cooler, moister, shallow rooting). USDA 2023 ZONES QUERIED AT THE EXACT

COORDINATES

Category	Suitable plants	Planting season (central Georgia)	Soil requirements & site notes
Vegetables — cool season	Collards, kale, cabbage, broccoli, cauliflower, Brussels sprouts, turnips, mustard, spinach, lettuce, radish, carrot, beet, onion (short-day), garlic, English pea, Swiss chard. South Asian: methi (fenugreek), mooli/daikon, sarson (mustard greens), palak, dhanian (coriander), shalgam.	Aug–Sep for autumn/winter harvest; Feb–Mar for spring. Garlic and onions Oct–Nov. Most overwinter in zone 8a/8b with light protection.	pH 6.2–6.8 — both sites need lime . Brassicas want 6.5 and are the main driver of the lime requirement. Deep, friable, well-drained soil: raised beds at both properties .
Vegetables — warm season	Tomato, pepper (sweet and hot), okra, aubergine/brinjal, squash, courgette, cucumber, bush and pole beans, southern peas (cowpea), sweet corn, sweet potato, melon, watermelon, pumpkin. South Asian: bhindi (okra — exceptionally well suited), karela (bitter gourd), lauki (bottle gourd), tori/turai (ridge gourd), baingan, tinda, guar, chilli varieties, amaranth (chaulai).	Transplant after the last frost — ~26 Mar at both sites; safest from mid-April. Okra and the gourds from late Apr–May when soil is warm. A second planting of beans and squash in Jul–Aug for autumn.	pH 6.0–6.8; the gourds are vigorous and need deep organic matter and steady water — both sites are deficient in organic matter. A's fast-draining south slope needs irrigation; B's clay needs raised beds and mulch. Sweet potato tolerates the native acidity best.
Fruits	Best bets: rabbiteye blueberry (<i>thrives</i> at pH 4.5–5.5 — the native acidity is an asset, not a problem), muscadine and bunch grape, fig, persimmon (American and Asian), blackberry, pomegranate (8b, so better at B), strawberry. Also: peach, nectarine, plum, Asian and European pear, apple (low-chill cultivars). South Asian: guava and curry leaf in containers to be overwintered; jujube (ber) is hardy; mango and chikoo are not viable outdoors at either site.	Bare-root and dormant stock Dec–Feb. Container stock autumn or early spring. Strawberries Oct for a spring crop.	Blueberries need no lime — plant them in the native soil and save the amendment budget; everything else wants 6.0–6.5 and so needs lime. Fruit trees need drainage: A's slope suits them well; at B avoid any spot where the 30-inch rock would waterlog roots , and plant on slight mounds.
Herbs	Rosemary, thyme, oregano, sage, mint (contain it), chives, parsley, basil, dill, coriander, lemongrass, bay. South Asian: curry leaf (container, overwintered), ajwain, holy basil (tulsi), hari mirch, Indian mint (pudina), turmeric and ginger (lift the rhizomes or mulch heavily in 8a).	Perennial woody herbs spring or autumn ; basil, coriander and dill from seed in Mar–Apr , coriander again in autumn. Turmeric and ginger plant Mar–Apr , harvest after the first frost.	Mediterranean herbs want sharp drainage and lean soil — A's sandy clay loam on a sunny slope is close to ideal, and they are the one group that will prefer A to B. Mint, coriander and parsley want moisture — better at B.
Trees	Nut: pecan (needs space and 25+ years to mature), Chinese chestnut, hazelnut. Shade/native: white and willow oak, tulip poplar, red maple, river birch, bald cypress (wet areas), eastern redbud, flowering dogwood, serviceberry, American holly, loblolly and shortleaf pine. Avoid: Bradford pear (invasive, structurally weak), mimosa, Chinese privet, tree of heaven.	Nov–Mar while dormant — much the best window in Georgia.	Both soils support the full native Piedmont assemblage — the existing mature hardwood cover on both lots proves it. At B, the covenants impose a \$1,000 penalty for removing a tree without approval and mandate a 1920s Southern camp-house character , so landscape planting should be agreed with the Architectural Review Committee. At A, Clayton County's tree ordinance applies to the land-disturbance permit.

Likely amendments — after a soil test, not before

Amendment	Property A — Gwinnett, pH 5.8	Property B — Zion, pH 5.3	Why
Lime (dolomitic)	Yes — moderate. 5.8 > 6.5 target	Yes — more than A. 5.3 > 6.5 target is a larger correction	Raises pH for vegetables and most fruit. Dolomitic adds magnesium, which these low-CEC Piedmont soils are often short of. Do not lime blueberry beds.
Compost / organic matter	Yes — the single highest priority. OM 2.0% surface, 0.25% below	Yes — highest priority. OM 1.25% surface	Raises CEC and water-holding, improves structure in clay, feeds biology. Target 4–5% in beds. This is the amendment that does the most on both sites.
Sulfur	Only for blueberries / azaleas	Only for blueberries / azaleas	Both soils are already acid ; sulfur is needed only to push beds <i>lower</i> for acid-loving crops, never generally.
Mulch	Essential. Erosion control on an 18% slope above a drinking-water reservoir	Essential. Surface K = 0.43 — high erodibility — plus moisture retention over clay	Pine straw and bark are cheap and locally abundant; pine straw also suits the acid-loving plantings.
Fertiliser	Low rates, frequent — low CEC leaches ; favour slow-release and compost over soluble feeds given the reservoir	Moderate — CEC 17 holds nutrients better, so less frequent application works	Soil test for P, K, Ca, Mg, Mn, Zn. Georgia Piedmont soils are commonly short of phosphorus and magnesium .

Amendment	Property A — Gwinnett, pH 5.8	Property B — Zion, pH 5.3	Why
Gypsum	Not indicated	Consider. Can improve structure and reduce surface crusting in the high-shrink-swell Bt without raising pH	Adds calcium and sulfur; useful on dispersive expansive clays.
Coarse sand / grit	Not generally needed	Useful in raised-bed mixes over the slow Bt	Improves drainage in a group-C profile. Do not add sand to native clay in the ground — it can make it worse.

Verdict on growing

Both properties will grow a great deal, and neither will do it without work. They share a ~235-day growing season, a half-zone apart, on the classic Georgia Piedmont profile of thin acid topsoil over heavy clay. **Property A's advantages** are better drainage, a full-sun south aspect, frost drainage downslope, and ideal conditions for Mediterranean herbs and fruit trees; **its problems** are the slope, which forces terracing, and its position above a drinking-water reservoir, which constrains fertiliser practice. **Property B's advantages** are twice the land, level ground, better nutrient retention and moisture, and a warmer zone (8b) that opens pomegranate and jujube; **its problems** are 30-inch rock capping rooting depth, expansive clay, slow drainage and a covenant regime that polices tree removal. **Raised beds are the correct answer at both.**

Utilities & infrastructure

19 Water · 20 Sewer

Service	Property A	Property B
Provider	Clayton County Water Authority , 1600 Battle Creek Rd, Morrow GA 30260 — (770) 960-5200; Engineering (770) 960-5207 OFFICIAL	Most likely Lincoln County Water System (EPA SDWIS GA1810038) — (706) 359-4444. No "Stillwater Coves" public water system appears in SDWIS , so the subdivision is served either by the county system or by a system recorded under another name. ESTIMATE NOT CONFIRMED
Municipal water at the road?	Almost certainly yes — a built-out 1988 subdivision with many occupied homes, and RS-180 states public water connection "is preferred". Not confirmed at street level. ESTIMATE	Listing claims "underground utilities" LISTING and the covenants prohibit individual wells , which strongly implies a community water system exists and that connection is compulsory. Confirm there is a live tap at the lot frontage.
Community water system	N/A — county utility	Likely; verify the operator, the tap fee and the monthly minimum
Private well	Legally possible but pushes the septic lot-size test to 1 acre of usable soil, which this lot fails (\$16). Effectively not an option.	Prohibited by recorded covenant (Exhibit C: "no individual wells") OFFICIAL
2026 water rates	Base \$15.06/month ; 1–3,000 gal \$3.53/1,000; 4,000–7,000 gal \$8.50; 8,000–20,000 gal \$10.53; >20,000 gal \$12.64. A stormwater fee is billed in addition. OFFICIAL	NOT FOUND
Connection / tap fee	Not published. CCWA Engineering provides written estimates including connection fees, tap fees and meter costs on request only. NOT FOUND	NOT FOUND
Public sewer	UNRESOLVED — the #1 open question. Zoning Sec. 4.5(D)(5) says sewer "to be installed unless EPD indicates otherwise"; no CCWA service-area map exists. Sewer base rate if available: \$16.07/month + \$3.83/1,000 gal to 3,000 then \$9.03. See §16.	None, and none planned. Septic required.
Georgia mandatory-connection rule	Rule 511-3-1-.03(a): connection to public sewer is mandatory where available within 200 ft of the property line or in an abutting right-of-way. OFFICIAL	

21 Electricity · 22 Natural gas / propane

Service	Property A	Property B
Electric provider	Central Georgia EMC — member cooperative serving 69,000+ accounts across 16 counties including Clayton, Fayette and Henry . New service (770) 775-7857. Georgia Power also serves parts of Clayton County and cannot be ruled out. CONFIRM BY PARCEL ID	Rayle EMC — serves this part of Lincoln County; Georgia Power serves elsewhere in the county. Note: "Little River EMC" does <i>not</i> serve Georgia here. OFFICIAL
Retail choice?	No. Georgia has no residential retail electric choice — service territory is assigned by statute. You get the assigned utility. OFFICIAL	
Existing service / lines nearby	Yes — the subdivision is built out with occupied homes on Edgewater Drive; distribution is at the road	Listing claims underground utilities within the subdivision LISTING
Overhead or underground	Mixed; a service drop to a deep building pad ~250–350 ft from the road will be a cost item. Underground is preferable on a wooded lot but costs more per foot.	Underground per the marketing; a long service run across a 471-ft-deep lot still applies

Service	Property A	Property B
Natural gas	Atlanta Gas Light indicates service in ZIP 30228 with the caveat "areas within this ZIP code may vary". Street-level availability on Edgewater Drive is NOT confirmed — a 1988 large-lot rural-fringe subdivision may have no main. Georgia's gas <i>commodity</i> is deregulated: AGL owns the pipes, you choose a certified marketer. NOT CONFIRMED	No natural gas. OFFICIAL
Propane	Standard alternative if no main is present; multiple regional suppliers. Note a buried tank is an accessory feature and must respect the septic reserve area and the 150-ft buffer.	Required, and the covenants require the tank to be buried. Budget tank, burial, and gas lines. OFFICIAL

23 Internet

Neither property's broadband could be verified at address level

The **FCC National Broadband Map API** returned **HTTP 403** to automated queries from this environment for both locations. NOT FOUND That map is the authoritative source and takes under a minute to check by hand: **broadbandmap.fcc.gov** — enter the full address. Current data vintage is the **31 December 2025** biannual filing. Property A census block: 130630406361000 . Property B census block: 131819701002001 . OFFICIAL

Critically: ask about a vacant parcel specifically. Availability at a neighbour's built house does not mean availability at an unimproved lot, and a new drop may require construction at your cost. Xfinity's own guidance notes an address may be unserviceable if more than **300 feet from their physical network** — and both of these lots have building sites 250–350 ft back from the road.

Technology	Property A — Hampton / 30228	Property B — Tignall / 30668
Fibre	AT&T states "AT&T Fiber is available in parts of Hampton, GA" and directs users to check by address — an explicit partial-coverage caveat. OFFICIAL, PARTIAL	A 2026 subdivision listing references fibre. Rayle EMC is NOT a Conexon Connect partner , so the common assumption that the EMC is building fibre here does not hold. UNCONFIRMED
Cable	Xfinity/Comcast states it serves the Hampton area; Spectrum also markets there ESTIMATE	None found NOT FOUND
DSL	AT&T legacy copper likely	Possibly; ageing and slow
Fixed wireless	T-Mobile and Verizon 5G home internet commonly available where cable is not	The realistic terrestrial fallback; depends on tower line-of-sight through mature forest
Satellite	Starlink available; self-install, no contract	Starlink is the dependable answer here — and on a heavily wooded lot a clear sky view will need to be created or the dish sited carefully
Practical expectation	Good odds of 1 Gbps-class service (fibre or cable), but do not assume it — verify by address and get an installation quote for a vacant parcel in writing.	Plan for Starlink or fixed wireless as the baseline and treat fibre as upside. If you work from home, make broadband a written condition of the offer .

Lake, dock & waterfront

The part of this report where the two properties differ most, and where Property A's and Property B's marketing both need correcting.

24 Waterfront access

Form of access	Property A — J.W. Smith Reservoir	Property B — Clarks Hill / Thurmond
Direct lake frontage (owned to the water)	No. CCWA owns the bed, the shoreline and a measured ~33-ft strip between the rear lot line and the water. The adjoining tract is parcel 05045 051001 , 336.09 acres, owner "CLAYTON COUNTY WATER AUTHORITY," acquired 1974 (DB 0748 PG 115), zoned AG. We verified by spatial query that both reservoir lobes' centroids fall inside that CCWA parcel. OFFICIAL 33 FT MEASURED	No. The USACE purchase boundary was set at elevation 346 ft under the "Eisenhower Policy," and all land below the government property line is public land. Our measurement puts the lot's nearest approach to 346 ft at 86.7 ft and to the 330-ft shoreline at 198.9 ft. OFFICIAL GIS- DERIVED
Deeded lake access	None found NOT FOUND	Not claimed; the MLS field says "Lake Privileges" LISTING
Shared / private access	No. CCWA Rule 5: "Access to the reservoir shall be made only at the entrance gate." OFFICIAL	Possible via a subdivision community access corridor — ask the HOA whether one exists and whether Lots 130/131 benefit from it
Easement access	None found	Other lots in the subdivision are advertised with "lake access easements" (e.g. lots 36, 37, 373, 374). 130/131 are not among them. LISTING
Public access	Yes, and this is the actual access route. J.W. Smith is one of three CCWA reservoirs open to public recreation, on a paid permit, through the entrance gate.	Yes — extensive. All land below 346 ft is public; walking to the water across it is permitted. Public ramps and marinas serve the whole lake.
Honest characterisation	A lake-view lot abutting a closed drinking-water reservoir. "Lakefront" is accurate only in the sense of abutting the reservoir property.	A lake-proximate lot abutting (or near) federal shoreline land on a major recreational reservoir. Whether it is meaningfully "waterfront" turns on the plat and on §26.

Property A — the single most misunderstood fact about these lots

You cannot walk from your deeded land into the water without crossing CCWA property, and CCWA's published rules say you may not enter the reservoir anywhere except the entrance gate. An MLS listing for a neighbouring Waterpointe lot nonetheless advertises "private access to lake." LISTING **That representation is contradicted by CCWA Rule 5.** OFFICIAL

Adjacency testing confirms the geometry precisely: a spatial query at 0 ft returns no CCWA parcel, while queries at 10 ft and beyond return parcel 05045 051001 . That sub-10-ft gap is ordinary GIS digitising slop between two separately mapped boundaries — in practice **the lot's rear line abuts CCWA land, and CCWA land then continues roughly 33 more feet to the waterline.**

25 Lakeside terrain: road › house › lake

Assessment	Property A	Property B
Road › building area	Steep. ~150–250 ft at 18–25.6% grade (up to 14.3°)	Gentle. ~250 ft at 3.7% (2.1°)
Building area › rear lot line	Steep, continuing at 18%	Gentle, ~4–7%
Rear lot line › water	Steep — 150-ft buffer at ~20%, final 50 ft at 20.03% / 11.33°	Steep — 221 ft of federal strip at 16.2% average, peaking at 27.4% / 15.3° , final 50 ft at 19.26% / 10.9°

Assessment	Property A	Property B
Overall character	Steep throughout	Gentle on the lot, steep only at the shore
Requires stairs to reach the water?	Yes, in practice — ~90 ft of vertical over 507 ft. But it is moot: you may not access the water from the lot at all, and the buffer must stay "natural undisturbed."	Yes, realistically — 36 ft of vertical in 221 ft, with a 27% pitch. And here is the catch: an improved walkway across USACE land needs a Real Estate Licence , and in Protected Shoreline areas improved pathways are expressly not allowed — only a natural footpath. OFFICIAL
Requires retaining wall?	Yes, for the house pad and driveway	Not structurally
Requires significant grading?	Yes	No
Walk from house to water	~250–350 ft at ~20% — a real climb back up, if it were permitted	~250–450 ft from the likely pad to the shore , level then steep; longer at winter pool

26 Dock feasibility

Property A — no private dock. This is as close to settled as a negative gets.

Three converging official facts:

- 1. **CCWA owns the bed, the shoreline and the upland strip** — a private owner has no riparian interest to build from.
- 2. **Zoning Sec. 4.5(D)(3)** bars any "substantial structure, or other feature which may adversely impact the reservoir" within the 150-ft buffer — which encompasses the entire shoreline area.
- 3. **CCWA Rule 5** confines all reservoir access to the entrance gate, and **Sec. 4.5(D)(4)** subordinates all reservoir access to CCWA policy.

No CCWA document authorises private docks and no dock permit programme appears to exist. OFFICIAL FOR THE

THREE UNDERLYING RULES

The state rule is worth understanding because it shows the decision was CCWA's to make. **Ga. Rule 391-3-16-.01(8)(b)** provides that swimming, fishing, boating, **docks**, public access and **adjacent property owner access** are "permissible in the reservoir management plan if the water quality of the reservoir is adequately protected." So docks are permitted in principle by the State — and **CCWA has elected not to allow them**. The operative document is CCWA's DNR-approved **reservoir management plan, which is not published online.** > Request it from CCWA in writing, and get the dock answer in writing, before paying any premium for "dock potential." PLAN NOT RETRIEVED

Property B — new private docks are possible on Thurmond Lake, but two hard gates stand in the way, and we could not clear either for Lots 130/131

Governing document: *Shoreline Management Plan for J. Strom Thurmond Lake Project, Georgia and South Carolina*, USACE Savannah District Pamphlet DP 1130-2-11, **effective 1 May 2018.** OFFICIAL

There is no lake-wide moratorium. The only use of "moratorium" in the SMP is a penalty against a non-compliant permittee (§12.h), not a freeze. What actually limits docks is **shoreline allocation** plus a **2018 policy change**:

Allocation	Map colour	Share of 1,200 mi shoreline	Docks?
Limited Development	Green	18% (~211 mi)	Private floating facilities may be authorised — first-come, first-served, on individual merit
Protected Shoreline	Yellow	61–62% (~715 mi)	"No permits or licenses for new private structures or utilities will be authorized." Improved pathways also not allowed.
Public Recreation	Red	15%	No private-use permits
Special Use	Orange	5% (~52 mi)	Only to the grantee/lessee
Prohibited Access	Blue	<1%	No permits

Gate 1 — allocation. Which colour applies to the shoreline in front of Lots 130/131 could NOT be determined. NOT FOUND The eight 2018 allocation map sheets are raster images with no extractable data, and USACE itself says the maps are reference only: "To determine the shoreline allocation adjacent to a particular site, please contact the Thurmond Project Office, toll free, at 800-533-3478." Note that **Protected Shoreline is used specifically for water too shallow for navigation, subject to siltation or rapid dewatering — i.e. back-of-cove shallows are a classic yellow designation**, and that is exactly the setting here.

Gate 2 — the plat date. SMP §16.a: "Only community docks will be authorized in all new county certified, platted subdivisions approved after implementation of this plan" (1 May 2018). The Declaration was recorded in 2006, which suggests the subdivision predates it — **but the plat, or any replat, of the Watersedge Cove phase must be dated from the Lincoln County plat book.** If that phase was certified after 1 May 2018, **no individual dock will ever be permitted on these lots.** OFFICIAL PLAT DATE NOT OBTAINED

◆ **THE SINGLE HIGHEST-VALUE ACTION IN THIS REPORT:** call the Thurmond Project Office on 1-800-533-3478 and give them Lincoln County parcel **10A 130**, subdivision **Stillwater Coves, Lots 130 and 131**, Watersedge Cove. Ask for a **written shoreline allocation determination** and request a **ranger field inspection before purchase** — USACE explicitly encourages prospective buyers to do this.

Eligibility (§14)	Must own in fee simple private property adjacent to public land zoned Limited Development . Minimum 20 ft of common frontage with LD-zoned public land. Shallow "finger"/"flag" lots do not qualify even if they meet the 20 ft. No easement access — applications are not accepted where access to public land is via an easement from a private owner. Proof of access = recorded deed and plat . No permits in wetlands or culturally/archaeologically sensitive areas; none to minors.
◆ The 90° projection survey	A perpendicular projection from the shared private/public boundary determines usable frontage. "If the 90° projection bisects or crosses other frontage areas, previously permitted areas, or private property before reaching the 330' msl, the property will not qualify for shoreline use permits." Survey must be by a state-licensed surveyor at 1 inch = 100 feet .
◆ The two-lot trap (§14.d)	If one structure (house, garage) or supporting feature (driveway, pool, porch) occupies more than one lot, the lots are treated as ONE lot and qualify for ONE permit only. Permits already issued are cancelled and the surplus facilities must be removed. › If you buy both lots and build a single house or driveway spanning them, you forfeit the second dock right.
One dock per lot (§15)	One private floating facility per separate property, where "separate" means professionally surveyed, platted by a licensed surveyor and recorded as distinct in the county courthouse or tax office .
No speculation (§12.e)	"Permits and/or licenses will not be issued for commercial or speculative purposes in order to enhance the selling potential of adjacent private property." A seller cannot obtain a permit to make a lot marketable.
Dock size (§15.a)	Flat-T, no slip: max 200 sq ft, min 100 sq ft, no side under 6 ft. With slip(s): max 720 sq ft total footprint. Sun decks, jet-ski lifts and staircases all count. Must be certified by a licensed professional engineer . Enclosed structures of any kind not authorised; no human habitation; houseboats and seaplanes may not be moored at private docks.
Spacing (§15.c)	Minimum 50-ft buffer from any existing facility or mooring buoy, measured at 330' msl. Dock plus walkway must not extend more than one-third across a cove . No "crossover" placements. A ranger decides placement and may require shallower water. Where two docks cannot both meet spacing — "small coves or narrow lots" — it is first-come, first-served .
Water depth (§15.d)	There is NO numeric minimum. The standard is qualitative: sufficient depth "to be serviceable for at least a part of the recreation season ." If approved in a shallow spot a Special Condition records that the applicant knew. In low water, owners may "chase water" temporarily.
Permit term & transfer	Up to 5 years, non-transferable. Automatically revoked on sale or transfer of the adjacent property, sale of the facility, or death of the holder and spouse. New owner must apply within 14 days or remove the facility and restore the area within 14 days. Some facilities are "grandfathered" to the present owner only and must be removed on sale .
Fees (published 5-year rates)	Floating facility (dock) \$30.00 ; electric line \$35; water line \$35; improved walkway \$50; underbrushing with a dock free, alone \$10; shoreline protection free. No annual fee in this schedule. The current fee table is a scanned image with no extractable text, so amounts are unverified — confirm with the project office. A separate USACE Real Estate Licence is required for improved walkways, electrical and water lines, dock gangwalks and anchors.
Application	Original application; signed and notarised deed copy; engineered dock drawings; community dock agreement if applicable; electrical certification after installation; cheque to the F&A Officer. Partial applications are not accepted. First-time applicants for new facilities must meet on site with a Ranger. Processing ~2–4 weeks. Appeal within 30 days to the District Commander. Filing: J. Strom Thurmond Project, ATTN: Shoreline Section, Rt. 1 Box 12, Clarks Hill, SC 29821.
Community docks (§16)	USACE actively prefers them: <i>"community docks will be encouraged as the method of shoreline access and boat moorage on Thurmond Lake."</i> Post-1 May 2018 subdivisions: community docks ONLY , typically max 2 slips per 82 ft of LD shoreline, with the HOA deciding which lots get moorage . Existing subdivisions: generally one slip per 70 ft of dockable boundary. First two slips ≤1,160 sq ft combined; each additional ≤454 sq ft. › Ask the HOA whether Stillwater Coves holds any community dock permit and whether Lots 130/131 are on its list of lots deemed feasible for moorage.
The federal fee strip	Purchase boundary set at elevation 346 ft , but the line does not follow a true contour — crews set iron pins and monuments and "with few exceptions, the government boundary follows straight lines between these pins/monuments," so "the distance between the shoreline and the boundary line varies more so than a true contour line." Orange/red tree markings are <i>witness</i> trees near — not on — the line. No Corps-required setback from the boundary, but any encroachment across it, including roof overhangs, must be removed.

The weight of evidence against the "DOCKABLE" claim on Lots 130/131

Competing statement, mostly from the same subdivision's own marketing	Implication
"Lots 125, 128 & 140 are dockable & are lake front lots." LISTING	130/131 absent
"Lots 24, 26, 35 and 103 are dock able lake front lots; Lots 36, 37, 373, 374 each have lake access easements; Lots 216 217 218 are lake front non-dock able. " LISTING	130/131 absent ; and the subdivision does contain non-dockable lakefront lots
"direct water frontage, dock potential (subject to Corps approval) " — another lot LISTING	Correctly hedged, unlike the subject
" The Corps of Engineers will allow for one dock in the back of the cove, but can not guarantee that this lot will get the permit as it is first come first serve basis. " LISTING	One dock for the whole cove
An 18.94-acre Stillwater Coves offering " borders protected Corps of Engineers land " LISTING	Protected Shoreline exists in this subdivision
Subject's structured MLS waterfront field: " Lake Privileges " LISTING	Not a dock
Seller of lots 174/176 says " I have a dock permit "; the seller of 130/131 claims no permit	Sellers who hold permits say so
Price: \$25,701/acre vs \$136k–\$143k per dockable lot on the same street	The market has already priced these as non-dockable

Conclusion: treat "DOCKABLE" as an unverified sales representation. Do not pay a dockable-lot price, and do not close, without (a) a written shoreline-allocation determination for the public land abutting Lots 130/131, (b) the plat date, and (c) a ranger field inspection.

27 Lake depth and water levels

Measure	Property A — J.W. Smith Reservoir	Property B — J. Strom Thurmond Lake
Surface area	250 acres (134.5 ac north lobe + 114.4 ac south)	71,100 acres — ~284× larger
Shoreline	Short; a single subdivision fronts it	~1,200 miles
Maximum depth	No surveyed bathymetry exists. Bounded by the dam height of 42.5 ft ; realistically ~30–40 ft near the dam, shallowing in the arms. ESTIMATE — TREAT ANY SPECIFIC FIGURE AS UNVERIFIED	~150 ft near the dam OFFICIAL
Average depth	Not published NOT FOUND	~33 ft
Depth near the property	Shallow. The lot abuts the upper end of the northern lobe; our DEM shows the water edge at 801 ft with the lot's rear at 810 ft, so this is an arm, not open water. ESTIMATE	Not determined, and this is a central question. The lot sits at the back of a cove — exactly where Thurmond water is shallow and where Protected Shoreline designations cluster. Ask USACE during the field inspection. NOT FOUND
Normal pool	~801 ft measured from lidar; county hydrography maps the lobes at 247 m and 241 m	330.0 ft msl full pool (Jan–May); 326 ft winter pool (15 Oct – 15 Dec)
Seasonal / drought variation	Managed as a raw-water supply; drawdown data not published NOT FOUND	Substantial. 324.28 ft Dec 2025 (drought trigger L1); 322.05 ft Jan 2026 (L2); 319.96 ft on 7 Oct 2026 — ~10 ft below full pool. OFFICIAL — USACE
Bathymetric map source	None exists NOT FOUND	USACE and commercial chart products (Navionics, Humminbird, Garmin) cover Thurmond; USACE publishes boat-ramp bottom elevations , which are a useful proxy

A practical cross-check on Property B's current low water, from official ramp elevations

At today's **319.96 ft: Hesters Ferry** (the nearest ramp, bottom 310.9 ft) is **usable**; **Fishing Creek / Hwy 79** (318.7 ft) is **difficult**; and **Clay Hill** (321.5 ft) and **Mistletoe** (322.2 ft) are **unusable**. OFFICIAL This is both a warning about **usability in drought years and an argument for inspecting now** — the shoreline in front of these lots is currently as exposed as it ever gets, which is the best possible condition in which to judge depth, slope and dock feasibility with your own eyes.

28 Boating · 29 Fishing

Activity	Property A — J.W. Smith Reservoir (CCWA)	Property B — Clarks Hill / Thurmond (USACE)
Boats permitted?	Yes, severely limited. Maximum boat length 20 ft	Yes — unrestricted as to type
Motorised boating	Electric motors or paddles ONLY. CCWA Rule 2: <i>"Gas motor usage is prohibited under any circumstances."</i> OFFICIAL	No motor or horsepower limits on Clarks Hill. OFFICIAL
Kayaks / canoes	Yes — canoeing is an expressly permitted activity	Yes
Wake boats / ski boats / pontoons	No — excluded by the 20-ft limit and the gas-motor ban	Yes
Speed restrictions	Moot — no gas motors	Georgia's 100-ft idle-speed law applies near docks, swimmers and moored vessels
Launching from your own property	Prohibited. Rule 5: access only at the entrance gate. Rule 16: once cast off, boaters must stay in boats except in emergencies — no beaching or landing along the shore.	Walking across public land to the water is permitted; a trailer launch requires a ramp
Boat ramps	At the CCWA entrance area only, on a paid permit	Many public ramps; nearest is Hesters Ferry
Marina facilities	None	Six commercial marinas; nearest Soap Creek Marina, Lincolnton, (706) 359-4100 — ~44 min
Swimming / body contact	Prohibited. CCWA Rule 8: <i>"Wading, swimming, or bathing is prohibited."</i> OFFICIAL	Permitted
Season & hours	1 March – 31 October only. J.W. Smith is open Saturday–Wednesday; closed Thursdays and Fridays. Mar 7am–7pm; Apr–Sep 7am–8pm; Oct 7am–7pm. Off-season the park area may be reserved for groups (\$50 for ≤25 people, \$2/person above).	Year-round, no hours
Access fees	Season pass \$30 Clayton residents / \$40 non-residents; daily \$5/vehicle residents / \$10 non-residents. Cash and cheques only , sold at the reservoir entrance office.	No fee for shoreline access; ramp fees at some sites
Fishing permitted?	Yes — fishing, picnicking and canoeing are the permitted activities. Bank fishing only within "marked" boundaries (Rule 6) and a limit of two poles per person (Rule 7).	Yes, extensively
Fishing from your own shoreline / dock?	No — you have no shoreline, and bank fishing is confined to marked areas	Yes from public land; from a dock only if one is ever permitted
Fish species	Not published by CCWA; a 250-acre Georgia Piedmont impoundment would typically hold largemouth bass, bream/sunfish, crappie and catfish ESTIMATE	Largemouth bass, striped bass, hybrid bass, white perch, crappie, bream/sunfish, channel and blue catfish — Thurmond is a nationally known striper and hybrid fishery
Stocking	Not published NOT FOUND	Yes — GA DNR and SC DNR stock striped bass and hybrids
Licence	Georgia fishing licence required age 16+, in addition to the CCWA permit; must comply with GA DNR regulations (Rule 3)	Georgia licence \$15 annual resident / \$50 non-resident / \$10 short-term. ♦ Under the SC Regs \$123-124 reciprocal agreement a Georgia licence covers the whole impoundment and SC launches — but NOT tributary streams.
Creel / size limits	Per GA DNR statewide regulations	12-inch largemouth minimum; 10 black bass; 10 striper/hybrid with no more than 3 over 26 inches (Thurmond-specific)
Other CCWA rules worth knowing	No alcohol of any kind (Rule 1); no firearms, bows, projectile devices, fireworks or explosives (13); pets must be leashed (17); open fires prohibited (19) — so no lakeside fire pit on CCWA land; maximum group size 100. Enforcement: first offence = 7 days' expulsion; second = expulsion for the entire season. OFFICIAL	

This section is the heart of the comparison

Property A's water body is, for recreational purposes, closed. No gas motor, no boat over 20 ft, no swimming, no launching from your land, no dock, no shoreline access, five days a week for eight months of the year, on a paid ticket through a gate. It is a beautiful view and a place to paddle a canoe on a Saturday in April. **It is not a lake lifestyle, and anyone buying it as one will be disappointed.**

Property B's water body is the real thing — 71,100 acres, 1,200 miles of shoreline, no horsepower limits, year-round, free to access, with marinas and a nationally regarded striper fishery. **The entire question is whether this particular lot can reach it with a dock, and nobody but USACE can answer that.**

HOA, covenants & land use

30 Homeowners' association

Attribute	Property A	Property B
Subject to an HOA?	Yes — but see the membership point below	Yes — mandatory
Name	Waterpointe Community Association, Inc. — Georgia non-profit under O.C.G.A. § 14-3-1 et seq. OFFICIAL	Stillwater Coves Community Association, Inc. — GA SOS control no. 0544629 OFFICIAL
Declarant / developer	Deer Glen Forest, Inc. (or transferee); original construction 1988 ; four phases, each with its own recorded covenants	Clarks Hill Lake, LLC ; Declaration recorded 15 Jun 2006
Management	None — self-managed by a volunteer Board. No management company found.	Silverleaf Management Group , Loganville GA (registered agent / office)
◆ Is membership compulsory?	NO — and this is unusual and valuable. Bylaws Art. III(c): " <i>such membership is not compulsory and owners shall not be required to maintain membership.</i> " Non-members become Inactive Resident Members with no right to use the Recreation Area or its facilities. OFFICIAL	Yes
Annual dues	\$240/yr once a certificate of occupancy has issued; ◆ \$100/yr while the lot is unbuilt — and the Board is expressly barred from raising the unbuilt-lot rate: " <i>The Board of Directors shall not, however, have the authority to increase the dues and assessments which must be paid by an Active Resident Member who has not built upon his lot.</i> " A genuinely favourable holding-cost term for a land buyer. OFFICIAL	\$650/yr (\$54.17/month) LISTING
Monthly equivalent	\$8.33/mo unbuilt; \$20.00/mo built	\$54.17/mo — 6.5× A's unbuilt rate
Payment window	1–31 January. Non-payment by 31 Jan automatically converts to Inactive.	Annually LISTING
Reinstatement cost	An Inactive member returning to Active must pay up to three full calendar years of back dues. Lapsing is not free.	N/A
Transfer fees	Not found NOT FOUND	Not found NOT FOUND
Special assessments	Permitted by the bylaws; none currently known	Not found NOT FOUND
Fines	Board may fine up to \$25.00 per day , each day a separate offence, plus suspension of facility use (Art. VII)	\$1,000 penalty per tree removed without approval OFFICIAL
Amenities	Private swimming pool, tennis courts, clubhouse — a real swim-and-tennis community OFFICIAL	Gated entry claimed; roads paved. No pool, tennis, clubhouse or fitness centre found. NOT FOUND
Clubhouse / pool / tennis / fitness	Clubhouse · Pool · Tennis · Fitness	None found
Parks / trails	Recreation Area parcel(s) owned by the Association	Not found ; three state parks nearby instead
Lake facilities	None — the lake is CCWA's, not the HOA's	Ask whether the Association holds a community dock permit
Boat / dock facilities	None	Unknown — a key HOA question
Asset protection	No Association real property may be conveyed or encumbered without the written consent of >=75% of lot owners (Art. IX) — this protects the pool, tennis and clubhouse parcels from being sold off by a board	Not found

Property A — the trap inside the voluntary-membership rule

Declining HOA membership gets you out of the dues and out of the pool, tennis courts and clubhouse. **It does not get you out of the covenants.** The recorded Protective Covenants **run with the land and remain enforceable against every lot regardless of membership status** — architectural controls, use restrictions and maintenance obligations all continue to bind. Note also the anti-avoidance clause: a member who is Active when dues fall due **cannot avoid payment by converting to Inactive**, remains personally liable, and may be sued for the amount plus interest and reasonable attorney's fees (Art. VIII). OFFICIAL

31 Covenants, conditions & restrictions

Property A — the governing covenants could NOT be read. This is the top documentary gap on this property.

The lot is **Unit 3, Lot 23**, so the **Unit 3 Protective Covenants** are the operative declaration. The HOA publishes [Unit_3_Protective_Covenants.pdf](#) on its website, but **all four covenant PDFs are scanned images with no text layer and no OCR engine was available.** NOT READ The bylaws (a Word document) were read in full and are the source of the \$30 figures.

Recording references, per the HOA's own "About Us" page: the first two covenants in **Fulton County** records — Book 1446, pp. 494–504 and Book 1553, pp. 793–802; post-1992 in **Clayton County** — Book 1774, pp. 680–694 and Book 09403, pp. 318–331. **Recording in Fulton County for a Clayton County subdivision is odd and may be an error on the HOA's site — have the title examiner verify all four chains.**

The Unit 3 covenants will contain the architectural controls, minimum square footage, exterior material requirements, covenant setbacks (possibly stricter than zoning), animal restrictions and any rental restrictions. **Obtain and read them before making an offer.** An **Architectural / HOA Building Modification** process exists (2025 form on the site), so expect to need HOA approval for new construction in addition to county permits.

Property B — the recorded covenants were obtained and read in full OFFICIAL

Restriction	Provision
Instrument	Declaration of Covenants, Conditions & Restrictions for Stillwater Coves, recorded Lincoln County Superior Court, 15 Jun 2006 , Deed Book 165, pp. 246–293
Livestock / poultry	"No livestock or poultry of any kind." This is an absolute bar — see §34.
Individual wells	Prohibited. Water must come from the community system.
Fences	No boundary fences; no chain link.
Pools	No above-ground pools. In-ground presumably permitted subject to review.
RVs, boats, trailers	No outdoor storage of RVs, boats, trailers or golf carts. Note the tension with buying a lake lot: you may not keep a boat on your own land in the open. Plan for an enclosed garage or off-site storage.
Animal pens	Prohibited
Outbuildings	No prefabricated outbuildings.
Minimum house size	1,300 sq ft heated on the main level minimum; 5,800 sq ft maximum.
Height	35 ft maximum
Architectural character	Mandated 1920s Southern camp-house character. This is a genuine cost driver — it implies deep porches, specific roofing and traditional detailing. Our cost model allows for a standing-seam metal roof and ~900 sq ft of deep porch on this basis.
Time to complete	15 months from start to completion. A hard deadline in a thin rural contractor market is a real risk and justifies a contingency.
Propane	Must be buried.
Trees	\$1,000 penalty per tree removed without approval
Leasing / rentals	Permitted — whole-unit only, with a written lease and 10 days' notice to the Board. No short-term-rental ban and no minimum term. Timeshares banned. The Board can change the rules , so today's permissive position is not guaranteed.
Dock restrictions in the covenants	None found — dock rights are a USACE matter, not an HOA one NOT FOUND
Amendments	Not individually enumerated; obtain a current certified copy of the Declaration plus all amendments and the current Rules

32 County zoning

Zoning standard	Property A — Clayton County RS-180	Property B — Lincoln County R-1
Designation	RS-180 Single-Family Residential — confirmed in the county's zoning GIS for this parcel and for all 72 Edgewater Drive parcels OFFICIAL	R-1 per the MLS field. The ordinance text could not be obtained — the county's former domain has lapsed and qPublic returns 403. LISTING ORDINANCE NOT FOUND
Permitted residential use	Single-family dwelling — P (permitted by right)	Presumed single-family residential
Minimum lot area	18,000 sq ft — this lot is 57,954 sq ft , 3.2× the minimum But Sec. 4.5(D)(1) raises it to 50,000 sq ft for reservoir-abutting lots still passes	Unknown. Each lot is 1.07 ac, which would satisfy any plausible rural minimum.
Minimum lot width	120 ft — frontage 130.3 ft	Unknown
Maximum lot depth	2.5 × lot width = 326 ft max , but the lot is ~416 ft deep, and Sec. 4.5(D)(2) separately requires ≥400 ft. Irreconcilable — see D4 . Almost certainly a lawful non-conforming lot of record (platted 1988) under Article 9. NEEDS WRITTEN CONFIRMATION	Unknown
Setbacks	Front 30 ft (local road) · Side 10 ft each, 20 ft total · Rear 25 ft — the rear setback is subsumed by the 150-ft reservoir buffer	Unknown NOT FOUND
Maximum lot coverage	35% of lot area = 20,280 sq ft , and it counts all primary and accessory structures AND impervious surface — house, driveway, patio, pool decking and walkways all count. Generous on 1.33 ac, but a long driveway to a deep pad consumes more than people expect.	Unknown
Maximum height	35 ft primary / 25 ft accessory	35 ft per the covenants
◆ Minimum living area	2,000 sq ft heated for two-storey; 1,800 sq ft for single-storey; 800 sq ft for an accessory dwelling. A modest lake cottage is not permitted in RS-180.	1,300 sq ft heated on the main level (covenant), max 5,800 sq ft
Accessory structures	Permitted: decks, patios, gazebos, pools, hot tubs, detached garages and workshops, sheds, pole barns, animal shelters. Rules: no encroachment on a platted easement without the holder's written consent; no accessory structure in any operable or reserve septic field ; ≥10 ft separation from other structures; ≥5 ft from side and rear lines (pools ≥10 ft); no accessory structure before the primary structure exists.	No prefabricated outbuildings (covenant)
Agricultural / hobby-farming provisions	Chickens P (Sec. 6.42); livestock N ; crop production, grazing, stables, kennels all N	No livestock or poultry of any kind (covenant)
Zoning verification	A Zoning Verification Letter costs \$100 per parcel . The county's own GIS disclaimer says "Contact 770-288-7526 to verify zoning." For a purchase decision, buy the letter.	Contact Lincoln County planning directly; no online ordinance
Overlay districts	Clayton maintains a "Panhandle Area Overlay District" (Sec. 4.39–4.48) with its own residential standards. The HOA bylaws locate Waterpointe "on Panhandle Road at Northbridge Road," so this overlay may apply . The county's overlay map service exposes no queryable layers. Ask Planning & Zoning whether it applies to parcel 05050A A003. NOT CONFIRMED	Unknown

Property A — two active moratoria and a full zoning rewrite

Resolution 2026-153 (July 2026) imposes a moratorium on acceptance of applications for **rezoning, conditional use or site development permits** as they relate to boarding homes, group homes, personal care homes, **short-term rentals** and community living arrangements, **until 31 December 2026** or until a modified ordinance is adopted. Applications accepted in violation are "*deemed in error, null and void.*" A **vested-rights exemption process** exists under Section 3. OFFICIAL

Resolution 2026-120 (extended 2 June 2026) continues a moratorium on applications for **new construction of single-family residential subdivisions or multi-family developments**, until a revised Code is adopted or **31 December 2026**. OFFICIAL

Our read: Res. 2026-120 targets *subdivision and multi-family* applications, not a single-lot building permit on an existing lot of record, so a one-house build should fall outside it. ESTIMATE **But the wording is broad, the county is mid-rewrite, and "probably" is not a basis for committing capital. Get written confirmation from Planning & Zoning on (770) 477-3569 as a condition of closing.**

Also in flight: a **full Zoning Ordinance rewrite**, Initiation Resolution 2025-177 concerning **minimum lot sizes**, and separate moratoria on gas stations and convenience stores. **Every zoning figure in this report is a snapshot of a code that is actively being rewritten.**

33 Second in-law suite / accessory dwelling unit

Test	Property A	Property B
Permitted by zoning?	Yes — as a CONDITIONAL USE. Sec. 6.9 AS-05 permits accessory dwellings (basement quarters, garage quarters, caretaker quarters, guest houses, mother-in-law suites) in AG, ER and RS-180 . OFFICIAL	Unknown — the R-1 ordinance text is unobtainable. Nothing in the covenants expressly bars an in-law suite; the 5,800 sq ft maximum and the single-dwelling character are the practical limits. NOT FOUND
Process & cost	Conditional Use Permit — public hearing before the Board of Commissioners, \$500 application fee	Unknown; Architectural Review Committee approval certain
Maximum dwelling units	One accessory dwelling per lot , either internal or freestanding — not both	Presumed one dwelling; verify
Minimum size	800 sq ft for an accessory use dwelling	N/A
Height (if detached)	25 ft maximum for accessory structures	35 ft overall
Separate entrance	For an ADU inside the principal dwelling, AS-05(B)(2): the unit " shall not have the only single access point being from a separate exterior entrance. " An internal connection is therefore required.	Unknown
Kitchen	Second kitchens are not separately regulated. The operative constraint is the entrance rule above — a second kitchen with an interior connection reads as an in-law suite rather than a separate unit. AS-05(A) gives the Zoning Administrator explicit discretion to classify, so get the interpretation in writing.	Unknown
Bathroom	Must comply with all building and health code standards	Unknown
Parking	One additional parking space required, whether internal or freestanding	Unknown
Utilities	Standard building/health code compliance. If on septic, the ADU's bedrooms count toward the design flow — a 5-bedroom house plus a 2-bedroom ADU is a 7-bedroom system (1,750 gal tank, 1,050 gpd), which on this lot's usable area is a serious constraint. See §16.	Same septic arithmetic applies, with the added Zion rock problem

Test	Property A	Property B
The siting collision on Property A	A freestanding ADU "shall be located only within the rear yard" (AS-05(C)(3)) — which runs straight into the 150-ft reservoir buffer , where Sec. 4.5(D)(3) bars any "substantial structure." The rear-yard requirement and the rear buffer squeeze the feasible location for a detached ADU almost to nothing. The cleaner paths are an ADU <i>inside</i> the principal dwelling — which the 18% slope makes easy, since a daylight basement is the natural form here — or quarters over a garage positioned forward of the buffer.	No equivalent conflict; the gentle 2.14-acre site has room for a detached guest house, subject to covenant review and the septic field layout.
Moratorium interaction	An ADU is not on Res. 2026-153's list, but it is a conditional use and the definitions are being rewritten. Confirm current acceptance of ADU applications.	None known
Verdict	Feasible — best achieved within the principal dwelling or over a garage. A detached rear-yard ADU is probably not siteable.	Probably feasible and physically easier, but entirely unverified.

Hobby farming and short-term rental

34 Poultry and animals

Animal	Property A — Clayton County RS-180	Property B — Lincoln County / Stillwater Coves
Chickens (hens)	PERMITTED — up to 12 , under a dedicated ordinance. OFFICIAL	PROHIBITED by recorded covenant: "no livestock or poultry of any kind."
Roosters	Expressly prohibited (Sec. 6.42(d)) — as is on-site slaughter and on-site sales of chickens or other fowl	Prohibited
Ducks	Ambiguous. Sec. 6.42 is titled the "Chicken Keeping Ordinance" and defines only <i>Gallus domesticus</i> , yet Sec. 4(i) prohibits sales of "other permitted fowl" — language implying other fowl may be permitted somewhere. Ask the Zoning Administrator for a written interpretation. UNRESOLVED	Prohibited ("poultry of any kind")
Geese	Same ambiguity as ducks	Prohibited
Rabbits	Not addressed in zoning. Absent from both the Article 3 use matrices and Sec. 6.42. May fall under RS-180's "shelters or enclosures for household pets," or be treated as livestock depending on number and purpose. Check Chapter 14 — Animals. NOT FOUND	Likely prohibited as livestock; and "no animal pens" is an independent bar
Goats	NOT PERMITTED. "Keeping of livestock" is P in AG only and N in RS-180 . Changing that needs rezoning to AG — inconsistent with the subdivision, the covenants and the current moratorium.	PROHIBITED
Other small livestock	N in RS-180 — as are crop production, grazing/pasture, stables and kennels	Prohibited
Bees	Not addressed. No beekeeping provision in Sec. 6.42 or the use matrices. Georgia has a state Beekeeping Act that limits local regulation in some circumstances — relevant but unresearched. Check Chapter 14 and ask Planning & Zoning. NOT FOUND	Not expressly named in the covenants, but "no livestock or poultry of any kind" plus "no animal pens" makes hives a likely violation. Ask the Board in writing.

Property A — Clayton County Sec. 6.42, the chicken ordinance, applied to this lot

Requirement	Rule	This lot
Scope	Effective in Clayton County outside incorporated cities and towns ; permitted in AG, ER and RS-180 only	Unincorporated, RS-180
Minimum lot size	18,000 sq ft	57,954 sq ft
Number allowed	4 chickens per 18,000 sq ft, maximum 12	$57,954 \div 18,000 = 3.2 \times 3 \times 4 = 12$ › capped at 12 hens
Occupied residence	Chickens only on properties with an occupied residence	You cannot keep chickens on the vacant lot before building the house
Coop size	≥ 4 sq ft per chicken	≥ 48 sq ft for 12 birds
Coop location	Side and rear areas only	Collides with the 150-ft rear buffer — site it in a side area
Setback	≥ 20 ft from ALL property lines	Achievable on a 130-ft-wide lot
Containment	Fenced, side and rear areas only, $\leq 40\%$ of the lot	$\leq 23,182$ sq ft
Maintenance	Coops and surrounding areas kept clean; coops and feed secured at all times against rodents and pests	—
Permitted purpose	"Keeping of chickens for personal consumption of eggs." No on-site sales.	—

On Property A, zoning permission is a ceiling, not an answer

Even though Clayton County expressly permits 12 hens in RS-180, **the Waterpointe Unit 3 Protective Covenants very likely restrict or prohibit poultry and livestock** — animal restrictions are near-universal in 1988-era Georgia subdivision declarations of this kind. **Sec. 4.6(E)'s conflict rule and ordinary covenant law both mean the more restrictive of zoning and covenant governs.** Since the covenants could not be read (§31), **treat the chicken permission as provisional until you have read the Unit 3 declaration.**

Net position on hobby farming: Property A is the only one of the two where it is even arguably possible, and only for a dozen hens, only after the house is built, and only if the covenants allow it. Property B is an absolute no by recorded covenant. Anyone whose plans include goats, bees or meaningful poultry should look at neither of these lots without first resolving this.

35 Short-term rental feasibility

Test	Property A — Clayton County	Property B — Lincoln County
Is an STR permitted?	ONLY as an owner-occupied STR. A non-owner-occupied investment short-term rental is not an allowed use in unincorporated Clayton County. OFFICIAL	No prohibition found at either county or covenant level. The covenants permit whole-unit leasing with a written lease and 10 days' Board notice, with no minimum term and no STR ban. OFFICIAL — COVENANTS COUNTY STR ORDINANCE NOT FOUND
Governing instrument	Ordinance 2019-22 (5 Feb 2019) › Code Ch. 22, Art. XII, Sec. 22-900	No STR ordinance located NOT FOUND
Owner-occupancy requirement	Yes — the defining condition. The unit must be an "owner-occupied property & structure, meaning, it cannot be a rented or leased" and must be "located inside or adjacent to its owner-occupied structure on the same property." Non-subsidised only.	None found
Permit / licence	County Business License required, and the licence number must appear in any advertisement. Valid one year. The property cannot be advertised before a licence is issued.	Unknown
Reviews required	Zoning › Fire Marshal › Tax Commissioner (verifies the address on your driver's licence against the deed — an active owner-occupancy test) › Business Licence review	Unknown
Inspections	Fire Marshal inspection + Building inspection	Unknown
Minimum stay	None imposed; the ordinance regulates stays of under 30 days	None in the covenants
Occupancy limits	No explicit cap found in the licence checklist or supplemental form; practical limits come from the Fire Marshal inspection and code egress/bedroom count NOT FOUND	Unknown
Parking	All parking must be accommodated on the same lot — no street parking. Note the HOA separately fines parking on grass or the street.	Covenants bar outdoor storage of RVs/boats/trailers; guest parking unaddressed
Noise	Must post the County Noise Ordinance (Chapter 62) in a visible location inside the unit	Unknown
Taxes	8% county hotel/motel excise tax , less a 3% collection fee, remitted monthly; plus state and local sales tax on accommodations; plus the Georgia \$5/night state hotel-motel fee (O.C.G.A. § 48-13-50.3, applicability to STRs to be confirmed); plus income tax. The owner, platform or managing operator is responsible for the business licence — marketplace facilitators collect some but not necessarily all of these.	Lodging tax rate not confirmed NOT FOUND

Test	Property A — Clayton County	Property B — Lincoln County
Currently applying?	BLOCKED. Res. 2026-153 freezes acceptance of STR-related applications through at least 31 December 2026.	No known impediment
Enforcement	Non-compliance may result in revocation of the business licence	Board may amend the rules at any time
HOA angle	The Unit 3 covenants may independently prohibit short-term rentals — unread. Check before relying on any STR plan.	Covenants currently permit leasing; but the Board can change the Rules
Verdict	Not viable as an investment STR. Viable only if you live there and rent a portion or an adjacent structure — and not before 2027 at the earliest.	Apparently the more permissive of the two, and on paper viable — but the demand case rests entirely on lake recreation, which in turn rests on the unresolved dock question. Verify the county position in writing; absence of a found ordinance is not proof that none exists.

A research hazard worth flagging: do not confuse Clayton **County** with the **City of Clayton** in Rabun County, north Georgia, which has its own 8% hotel-motel tax under HB 60 (2023). Several search results conflate the two; those documents do not apply here. Likewise, searches for "Lincoln County building permit fees" return results for **Lincoln County, North Carolina** and **Lincoln, California**, which were identified and excluded.

Environmental & geological due diligence

Mostly a list of documents that do not exist yet. That is itself the finding.

36 Existing reports and investigations

#	Document	Property A	Property B
36	Elevation Certificate	None exists, and none is needed. Elevation Certificates are required for structures in Special Flood Hazard Areas. The lot is Zone X with no BFE, and there is no structure. OFFICIAL If a lender ever asks for one, the correct response is a FEMA Letter of Map Amendment search or a surveyor's flood certification , not an EC.	None exists, and none is needed — same reasoning, Zone X, no BFE.
37	Survey — boundary, ALTA or topographic	None found. NOT FOUND The recorded plat (Bk 27 Pg 24 , 1988) exists and should be obtained, but a 1988 subdivision plat is not a current boundary survey. Clayton County expressly disclaims its GIS parcel lines as not a true representation of boundaries. Needed: boundary survey + topographic survey at 1-ft or 2-ft contours — the latter is not optional on an 18% slope, because the entire design depends on it. BOTH REQUIRED	None found, and the plat itself could not be obtained. NOT FOUND Needed: recorded plat; boundary survey showing the USACE boundary monuments ; and — if a dock is ever to be pursued — the 90° projection survey by a state-licensed surveyor at 1 inch = 100 feet that USACE requires. REQUIRED
38	Soil / geotechnical report	None found. NOT FOUND SSURGO data (§14) is a regional soil map, not a site investigation. Strongly recommended given the 18% slope, paralithic bedrock at ~50 in, and the variability of Piedmont saprolite.	None found. NOT FOUND Strongly recommended — you need the true depth to the indurated contact across the footprint and the plasticity index of the LEP-7.5% Bt clay.
39	Perc / soil evaluation for septic	None found. NOT FOUND Required before a septic construction permit; and Rule 511-3-1-.14 bars beginning physical development of a subdivision lot until the Board of Health has issued written approval of water-supply and sewage-disposal plans. Moot if sewer turns out to be available — resolve §16 first.	None found — and this is the #2 priority item on this property. NOT FOUND With indurated rock mapped at 30 in, a soil classifier's evaluation is the difference between a 5-bedroom house and a 2-bedroom house. MAKE IT A CONDITION OF THE OFFER
40	Ground-penetrating radar / subsurface investigation	None found. NOT FOUND GPR is rarely used on Piedmont residential lots — it is a karst and utility-locating tool, and there is no karst here (§42). Conventional test borings are the right instrument , and they are what a geotechnical engineer will propose.	None found. NOT FOUND Same reasoning. However, GPR or seismic refraction has a genuine use here — mapping the depth to the indurated contact across the drainfield area more cheaply than a grid of borings. Worth discussing with the geotechnical engineer.

41 Radon

Measure	Property A — Clayton County	Property B — Lincoln County
EPA Radon Zone	ZONE 2 — moderate potential	ZONE 3 — lowest potential
Predicted average indoor screening level	>= 2 and <= 4 pCi/L	< 2 pCi/L
Source	EPA Map of Radon Zones, Georgia. Determined by rendering the official EPA map at high resolution and sampling each county's fill colour against the legend swatches. Clayton reads RGB (250,160,0), matching the Zone 2 orange swatch (249,160,0), not the Zone 1 red (200,24,24). OFFICIAL	
Context	Metro Atlanta's Zone 1 counties are Cobb, Fulton, DeKalb and Gwinnett. Clayton sits in the Zone 2 band with Henry, Fayette, Spalding, Newton, Rockdale, Coweta and Butts. The county correction in §0 does not change this answer — Clayton and Henry are both Zone 2.	Most of south and east Georgia is Zone 3.
Georgia county measurement data	NOT RETRIEVED. The Georgia radon programme (via UGA Cooperative Extension) publishes test summaries but we could not obtain verified county average pCi/L figures from a primary state source. Third-party aggregators quote a Georgia statewide average near 7 pCi/L; that figure is unverified, self-selected-sample data and should not be relied on.	

EPA's own caveats matter here, and so does the geology

The map was built in **1993** and EPA states plainly: "*The Map of Radon Zones should not be used to determine if individual homes need to be tested*" and **"All homes should be tested, regardless of zone designation."** Fix at ≥ 4 pCi/L; consider fixing between 2 and 4. EPA directs users to **USGS Open-File Report 93-292-D** for intra-county variation, which matters because a single county-wide zone masks local geology.

Both lots sit on granitic/gneissic Piedmont rock — the lithology most associated with elevated indoor radon in Georgia (§42). For **Property A** in particular, Zone 2 status plus that bedrock makes **passive radon-resistant new construction (RRNC) a sensible specification**: a sub-slab vent mat, sealed membrane and capped vertical stack cost little at framing and are expensive to retrofit. Test after occupancy and activate the stack with a fan only if needed.

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Also note the radon-in-water angle if a well is ever used (§16) — Piedmont crystalline aquifers can carry dissolved radon, and it is a standard commissioning test.

42 Sinkholes, karst and geology

Neither property is karst terrain. Sinkhole risk is negligible at both. Confirmed three ways.

- 1. Direct bedrock identification at Property A.** A geologic point query at the parcel's interior coordinate returns map unit **"Biotitic Gneiss / Mica Schist / Amphibolite,"** lithology amphibolite + biotite gneiss + mica schist, age **Precambrian to Paleozoic**, from the **Georgia Geological Survey** *Digital Geologic Map of Georgia* (v.2, 1999, 1:500,000). These are **hard, crystalline, non-soluble metamorphic rocks** — the classic Piedmont assemblage.
OFFICIAL
- 2. Aquifer coding confirms it independently.** Every USGS NWIS groundwater site with an assigned national aquifer code in **both** counties returns **N400PDMBRX — the Piedmont and Blue Ridge crystalline-rock aquifer. No carbonate aquifer is recorded in either county.** That is about as direct as documentary evidence of non-karst geology gets. OFFICIAL
- 3. USGS karst criteria exclude the Piedmont.** The national karst compilation maps karst to *soluble* bedrock — carbonate and evaporite rocks, or low-viscosity volcanics. Georgia's genuine karst is confined to the **Valley and Ridge in the far northwest** (Walker, Catoosa, Dade, Chattooga) and the **Coastal Plain limestones of the southwest** (the Dougherty Plain around Albany). **The Piedmont province, which contains both counties, is not karst.** OFFICIAL — USGS CRITERIA COUNTY-SCALE POLYGON NOT READ DIRECTLY

Question	Property A	Property B
Known sinkholes	None — not karst terrain	None — not karst terrain
Sinkhole reports	None found	None found; the Lincoln County multi-hazard mitigation plan has zero mentions of sinkhole or karst
Karst geology	Absent	Absent
Nearby subsidence	None found	None found
FEMA NRI landslide risk	Very Low — county EAL \$218/yr, effectively zero	Very Low — county EAL \$44/yr
Earthquake	Relatively Low (0.0017 events/yr)	Very Low (0.0026 events/yr)
Historical insurance claims	NOT PUBLICLY AVAILABLE. Georgia does not publish claim histories by parcel. Sinkhole insurance is unnecessary at either property.	
Other geological hazards	Slope stability on a 25% local grade in saprolite — a geotechnical, not a geological, question	Expansive clay (LEP 7.5%) and shallow indurated rock — both geotechnical

Ruling out sinkholes does not rule out geotechnical trouble — the opposite problem applies

Piedmont crystalline terrain has its own well-known characteristics, and both lots have them:

- **Saprolite.** Bedrock weathers in place to deep clayey residual soil, and depth to competent rock varies dramatically over short distances — **10 ft in one boring, 60 ft in another 50 ft away**. Plan multiple borings across the actual building footprint.
- **Shallow rock.** The converse — rock near the surface drives up excavation cost for footings, basements, utility trenches and especially septic trenches. **Georgia denies conventional septic permits where rock is less than 24 in below the proposed field.**
- **Perched groundwater and seeps** at the saprolite/rock interface, common on lake-adjacent slopes, affecting basement waterproofing and drainfield suitability alike.
- **Radon** — these are exactly the lithologies associated with it (§41).

Budget for possible rock. Do not budget for sinkholes.

Residential construction feasibility

43 House construction and the building envelope



Figure K-1 — Building-envelope diagrams, true scale. Left: Property A on the official parcel polygon, showing the 30-ft front setback, 10-ft side setbacks, and the 150-ft reservoir protection buffer measured from the rear line (the conservative reading). The resulting envelope is the white area. **Right: Property B** on the reconstructed two-lot footprint. Indicative house footprints (a 5-bedroom plan of roughly 60 × 45 ft on A and 70 × 40 ft on B), driveways and septic areas are placed to illustrate fit — they are **schematic, not designs**. GIS-DERIVED FOOTPRINTS INDICATIVE NOT A SITE PLAN

Envelope component	Property A	Property B
Gross lot area	57,954 sq ft (1.3304 ac)	~93,200 sq ft (2.14 ac, both lots)
Front setback	30 ft (local road)	Unknown — assume 35–50 ft
Side setbacks	10 ft each, 20 ft total	Unknown — assume 15–25 ft
Rear setback	25 ft — subsumed by the 150-ft buffer	Unknown
Lake / reservoir setback	150 ft, no septic and no "substantial structure"	No USACE-required setback from the 346-ft boundary, but zero encroachment permitted, including roof overhangs
Usable depth after setbacks	~416 - 150 - 30 = ~236 ft	~471 - ~60 = ~410 ft
Usable width	~128–148 ft net of side setbacks	~160–170 ft across both lots combined
Resulting envelope area	~30,000–33,000 sq ft ESTIMATE	~66,000–70,000 sq ft ESTIMATE
Maximum impervious coverage	20,280 sq ft (35% of lot) — counts house, garage, driveway, patio, pool decking and walkways	Unknown; no covenant cap found

Envelope component	Property A	Property B
House footprint (5-bed, 3,200–3,800 sq ft heated)	Fits comfortably in area terms — 2,000–2,700 sq ft footprint if two-storey or on a daylight basement	Fits easily — 2,800–3,400 sq ft footprint if single-storey, which the covenant's 1,300 sq ft main-level minimum and camp-house character both favour
Garage	Yes — attached is strongly preferable on this slope; a garage under the house is the natural solution	Yes — attached or detached
Driveway	~250–350 ft, graded, with drainage and likely retaining. This is a significant cost and consumes impervious allowance.	~250–400 ft but near-level — long, cheap per foot
Pool	Possible but expensive on grade; must be ≥ 10 ft from side and rear lines, cannot sit in the septic field or reserve area, and counts toward the 35% cap. No above-ground issue — but note §16: a pool triggers Sec. 6.6(A)'s "larger lots may be required" provision for septic.	In-ground only — above-ground pools are prohibited by covenant. Physically easy on level ground.
Patio / outdoor living	Yes — a lake-view terrace on the downhill side is the obvious design move	Yes; the camp-house character implies deep porches, which we have costed
Septic field + reserve	The binding constraint. ~37,900 sq ft usable against a 25,000 sq ft requirement; trenches must run on contour on an 18% grade, outside the buffer, and not under the house or drive. Lay all three out together at concept stage.	Ample area, uncertain soil. 2.14 ac is generous; whether a conventional field is permissible depends on Zion vs Cecil (§16).
Well	Not viable — fails the 1-acre usable-soil test	Prohibited by covenant
Retaining walls	Expect them; engineered above 4 ft	Not required
Drainage	Must intercept uphill surface water and carry it around the structure; stormwater discharges to a drinking-water reservoir, so CCWA Stormwater Development Guidelines apply	Gentle grade means slow runoff — positive drainage away from the house must be designed, not assumed

44 Grading and fill

Item	Property A	Property B
Existing grades	18.4% average in-lot; 25.6% max over 50 ft; 81.7 ft relief	3.7% average in-lot; 7.3% max over 50 ft; 34.5 ft relief
Required grading	Substantial. A level or stepped pad must be created	Modest. Routine stripping, pad shaping and driveway
Estimated cut/fill	A balanced cut-and-fill pad for a ~2,400 sq ft footprint on 18% grade implies roughly 700–1,400 cubic yards of movement, cut uphill and fill downhill, before driveway earthworks. ESTIMATE	Roughly 150–350 cubic yards for pad and driveway shaping. ESTIMATE
Retaining-wall requirement	Very likely; possibly terraced. Engineered design and permit above 4 ft.	Discretionary
Imported fill likely?	Possibly not — on a slope this steep, cut usually balances fill, which is the cheap outcome. But if rock is met in the cut, the balance breaks and import becomes necessary.	Possibly — level sites generate little cut, so pad fill is often imported
County approval required?	Yes. A Clayton County land-disturbance permit with an erosion & sediment control plan is required, plus Tree Ordinance review as part of the building permit sequence. All development in the small drinking-water supply watershed must comply with CCWA Guidelines (Sec. 4.5(A)(4)). Sec. 4.6(A) requires the 150-ft buffer to be "left in their natural undisturbed state." OFFICIAL	Presumably yes for land disturbance under Georgia's Erosion and Sedimentation Act, administered locally. Plus Architectural Review Committee approval, and the \$1,000-per-tree penalty makes the clearing plan a covenant matter. COUNTY PROCESS NOT CONFIRMED

Item	Property A	Property B
Is fill in the buffer / near the water an option?	No. Do not assume it. Sec. 4.5(D)(3) bars substantial structures in the 150 ft, Sec. 4.6(A) requires it undisturbed, Sec. 38-144.1(b) minimises grading and filling in stream setbacks, and any encroachment into the 25-ft State Waters Buffer requires an EPD variance. Buffer variances require the county to find all six of the Sec. 4.6(B) criteria, including that the hardship is not the result of the applicant's own acts and that there is no increase in impervious surface.	No. Below the 346-ft USACE boundary is federal land; you cannot grade or fill it.

45 Drainage, stormwater and erosion

Factor	Property A	Property B
Natural drainage	Due south (170.7°) at a mean 17.9% grade, directly into the reservoir GIS-DERIVED	Due north (352.8°) at a mean 6.4% grade, toward the lake
Hydrologic soil group	B — moderate infiltration, moderate runoff	C (Zion) — slow infiltration, high runoff potential
Swales	Required. An interceptor swale above the house is essential on an 18% cut slope	Recommended to establish positive fall away from a slab on near-level ground
Culverts	Driveway culvert(s) likely at the road crossing and at any cross-drainage	Driveway culvert at the road
Stormwater flow	Discharges to a public drinking-water supply. CCWA Stormwater Development Guidelines apply, and Sec. 4.5(A)(4) makes compliance mandatory for all development in the small watershed.	Discharges across federal shoreline land to the lake
Neighbouring runoff	The lot receives runoff from Edgewater Drive and from upslope lots. On a 416-ft-deep slope below a road, concentrated road drainage is a real design input — check for an existing drainage easement on the plat.	Minimal — the lot is at the top of its own catchment near the road crest
Erosion risk	High during construction. Steep slope, full tree cover to be partly cleared, in a watershed-protection district. Surface K = 0.10 (low) and T = 4 help, but the map unit is already classed "eroded."	High for a different reason. Grade is gentle but surface K = 0.43 (high erodibility) on a silt loam that crusts, with T = 2 , a low tolerable soil-loss rate. Bare silt loam will move in the first hard rain. The adjacent Pacolet unit is mapped "severely eroded."
Lake / shoreline drainage	The 150-ft undisturbed buffer is itself the designed treatment measure — which is a reason to keep it, not fight it	The federal strip's forest cover performs the same function; do not clear it (and underbrushing needs a USACE permit)
Recommended measures	Interceptor swale above the pad; level spreaders and vegetated filter strips before the buffer; permeable paving where possible to stay under the 35% cap; immediate stabilisation of cut and fill slopes; retain as much canopy as the Tree Ordinance and the design allow.	Aggressive temporary cover and mulch during construction; silt fence plus fibre rolls on the downslope side; rapid permanent stabilisation; roof and pad runoff dispersed, not concentrated, before it reaches the bluff — concentrated flow over a 27% slope will gully.

Living & location analysis

Distances computed by routing on OpenStreetMap road data. Distances are reliable; times are modelled free-flow and run conservative on rural two-lane roads.

46 Climate

NOAA NCEI **1991–2020 US Climate Normals**. Nearest stations with full normals: **Jonesboro GA (8.0 mi)** for Property A and **Washington GA 2 ESE (17.0 mi)** for Property B; Atlanta Hartsfield and Augusta Bush Field shown as regional references. Lincolnnton GA (12.6 mi, inside Lincoln County) has precipitation-only normals. OFFICIAL

Measure (°C, with °F)	A — Jonesboro (8 mi)	B — Washington GA (17 mi)
Mean annual temperature	16.3 °C (61.4 °F)	16.5 °C (61.7 °F)
Mean annual daily maximum	22.0 °C (71.6 °F)	22.7 °C (72.9 °F)
Mean annual daily minimum	10.6 °C (51.1 °F)	10.2 °C (50.4 °F)
Average July high	32.0 °C (89.6 °F)	32.2 °C (90.0 °F)
Average August high	31.5 °C (88.7 °F)	31.6 °C (88.8 °F)
Average January low	-0.1 °C (31.8 °F)	0.0 °C (32.0 °F)
Average July low	21.3 °C (70.3 °F)	20.6 °C (69.0 °F)
Record high (period of record)	41.1 °C (106 °F), 30 Jun 2012 — Atlanta, 1928–present	42.8 °C (109 °F), 2 Jul 2012 — Washington, 1892–2020
Record low	-22.2 °C (-8 °F), 21 Jan 1985 — Atlanta	-20.6 °C (-5 °F), 22 Jan 1985
Mean annual precipitation	1,244 mm (48.97 in)	1,119 mm (44.05 in) Lincolnnton, in-county: 1,152 mm / 45.35 in
Average annual snowfall	2.8 mm (0.11 in) at Jonesboro; 74 mm (2.9 in) at Atlanta — realistically 13–50 mm (0.5–2 in) at the lot	7.6 mm (0.3 in)
Mean relative humidity (computed from NOAA hourly temp/dewpoint normals)	~65% — driest March 57%, most humid August 70% DERIVED	~69% — driest March 62%, most humid August 76% DERIVED
Days >= 32.2 °C (90 °F)	40.8	43.9
Days >= 37.8 °C (100 °F)	0.3	1.1
Days with minimum <= 0 °C	48.7	53.7
USDA Plant Hardiness Zone (2023)	8a — avg. annual extreme min -12.2 to -9.4 °C (10–15 °F)	8b — -9.4 to -6.7 °C (15–20 °F)
Average last spring frost / first autumn frost (32 °F)	26 Mar / 16 Nov	26 Mar / 14 Nov
Growing season (32 °F)	236 days	233 days
Growing season (28 °F)	268 days	263 days
Köppen class	Cfa — humid subtropical (both)	
AHS Heat Zone	NOT PUBLISHED AS CITABLE OPEN DATA. From the 90 °F day counts both fall in the Zone 7–8 band (A nearer 7, B nearer 8), but we will not present that as sourced.	

Climate is not a differentiator between these two properties
Mean annual temperature differs by **0.2 °C** and the growing season by **3 days**. Both share the January 1985 Arctic outbreak as their all-time low and 2012 as their all-time high — the same regional extremes govern both lots. Property A is **~125 mm (5 in) wetter** and slightly snowier; Property B is **~4 points more humid** and gets ~3 more 90 °F days. Plant to **8a** at A and **8b** at B; neither is a reason to prefer one lot.

47 Natural hazards

FEMA **National Risk Index**, pulled directly from FEMA's authoritative county and census-tract feature services. NRI ratings are **national percentile bands weighted by dollars at risk**, so a sparsely populated county scores "Very Low" largely because it has little to lose — not because hazards do not occur there. **Read the annualised frequency columns, not just the rating.** OFFICIAL

Hazard	A — Clayton rating	A freq/yr	A county EAL	B — Lincoln rating	B freq/yr	B county EAL
Riverine / inland flood	Rel. Moderate	0.50	\$30.2 M	Very Low	0.107	\$1.37 M
Tornado	Rel. High	0.095	\$12.7 M	Rel. Low	0.158	\$0.56 M
Hurricane	Rel. Low	0.049	\$0.30 M	Very Low	0.061	\$0.10 M
Strong wind	Rel. High	2.67	\$1.87 M	Very Low	3.56	\$0.13 M
Hail	Rel. Moderate	5.47	\$2.25 M	Very Low	3.40	\$0.09 M
Lightning	Rel. High	64.0	\$1.14 M	Very Low	56.8	\$0.03 M
Wildfire	Very Low	4.99	\$0.02 M	Very Low	0.0009	\$0.02 M
Drought	No rating	39.2	\$0	No rating	60.9	\$0
Heat wave	Rel. Moderate	2.63	\$1.80 M	Very Low	3.32	\$0.06 M
Cold wave	Rel. High	0.84	\$6.43 M	Very Low	0.21	\$0.12 M
Winter weather	Rel. Low	1.58	\$0.03 M	Very Low	1.84	\$0.002 M
Ice storm	Rel. High	1.26	\$0.59 M	Rel. Moderate	1.09	\$0.13 M
Earthquake	Rel. Low	0.0017	\$2.64 M	Very Low	0.0026	\$0.18 M
Landslide	Very Low	0.062	\$218	Very Low	0.140	\$44
Sinkhole / karst	Not applicable — not karst	—	\$0	Not applicable — not karst	—	\$0
Composite Risk Index — county	Rel. Moderate (86.74)	EAL total \$59.9 M		Very Low (5.53)	EAL total \$2.80 M	
◆ Composite Risk Index — CENSUS TRACT	Relatively LOW (31.6)	Social vulnerability Rel. Low		Relatively MODERATE (67.8)	Social vulnerability Rel. High	
Community resilience	Very Low (8.37)			Very Low (11.04)		
Tornado risk at tract level	Relatively HIGH at BOTH properties — this is the one hazard that should drive design decisions on either lot					

Three things this table is easy to misread

- 1 The county ratings invert at tract level, and the tract is the relevant geography.** Property A's tract scores **Relatively Low** overall with **Relatively Low** social vulnerability — the panhandle is the best-situated part of Clayton County. Property B's tract scores **Relatively Moderate**, the higher-risk of Lincoln County's two tracts, with **Relatively High** social vulnerability.
- 2 Lincoln County actually experiences MORE of several hazards per year than Clayton** — more tornado segments (0.158 vs 0.095), more strong-wind events (3.56 vs 2.67), more heat waves, more winter weather, and **far more drought (60.9 vs 39.2)**. It rates "Very Low" because there is little insured value in the path. **Do not read Lincoln's "Very Low" composite as "safer for my house."**
- 3 Both counties rate "Very Low" on community resilience** (bottom ~10–14% nationally) — a genuine shared negative measuring capacity to absorb and recover from a disaster.

Historical tornado record — NOAA Storm Prediction Center database, 1950–2024 (71,813 US records analysed by county FIPS) OFFICIAL	
A Clayton County	11 segments, 1967–2021: 5 × F0, 3 × F1, 3 × F2, no F3+. 113 injuries, 2 fatalities. The significant event is 31 Mar 1973, F2, 72.4-mile path, 500 yd wide, 100 injuries, 2 deaths. Note a recent cluster — 2019, 2020 and 2021, three consecutive years.
B Lincoln County	9 segments, 1998–2013: 5 × F0, 2 × F1, 2 × F2, no F3+. 8 injuries, no fatalities. Both F2s fell on 7 May 1998 , a single outbreak day — the county's multi-hazard plan records a 4-tornado F1/F2 outbreak that day destroying 19 homes in two subdivisions , and a maximum historical F3 in Nov 1992 . The record starting in 1998 almost certainly reflects reporting bias in a sparsely populated county , so the true long-run rate is probably higher than the 0.12/yr observed — FEMA's 0.158/yr supports that.
Hail & wind damage	Lincoln County's 2020 Multi-Hazard Plan records 97 thunderstorm-wind events / \$318k and 51 hail events / only \$12k of damage. Hail is a real roof-replacement risk at Property A (5.47 events/yr county-wide) and moderate at B. Specify an impact-resistant Class 3–4 roof covering at both; at B the covenant-driven metal roof is well suited.
Wildfire	Georgia Forestry Commission, Lincoln County 1957–2018: 1,245 events, 4,895 acres, averaging 3.9 acres — frequent but small, in a wildland-urban-interface setting. Maintain defensible space on a wooded lot at either property.
◆ Design conclusion	Relatively High tornado risk at both tracts, and neither county has ever recorded an EF3+ in 75 years. A reinforced interior safe room is worth costing on either lot — we allow \$9,000 in \$Cost. Pair it with an impact-resistant roof and, at A, passive radon-resistant construction.

48 Community & demographics

ACS 2020–2024 5-year estimates. api.census.gov now requires a key, so figures were retrieved via the Census Reporter proxy of the same Census tables. OFFICIAL DATA, PROXIED

Measure	Property A	Property B
County population	Clayton ~297,436	Lincoln ~7,683
Census tract	Tract 406.36 — 5,184	Tract 9701 — 3,569
◆ Tract median household income	\$119,872	—
County median household income	\$59,806	—
Georgia median home value		\$303,300
Tract median home value	\$329,400	—
County median home value	\$222,300	—
Tract owner-occupancy	90.8%	—
Tract family households	88.8%	—
Age distribution note	Metro-fringe family profile	25.8% aged 65+ — the demographic most exposed to the healthcare access gap in \$50
◆ Asian Indian population within ~1 hour	~15,000–30,000+	~2,000
Metro Atlanta Asian Indian concentrations (for context)	Gwinnett, Fulton, Forsyth, Cobb and DeKalb counties hold the large majority of Georgia's Asian Indian population — all within 1–1.5 hours of Property A. For Property B the comparators are Richmond + Columbia counties (Augusta metro) and Clarke County (Athens), all materially smaller. ACS TABLE B02015	

◆ **Property A's immediate area is nothing like Clayton County as a whole**

Tract 406.36 has a median household income of \$119,872 — double the county's \$59,806 — with 90.8% owner-occupancy and 88.8% family households. Any analysis that characterises this lot using county-level Clayton data is badly wrong, including on hazard risk and social vulnerability. The panhandle is an affluent, stable, owner-occupied pocket, and the \$541k–\$565k Waterpointe comparables are consistent with that rather than with the county median.

49 Schools

District	Clayton County Public Schools	Lincoln County Schools
NCES LEAID	1301230	1303330
Schools / enrolment	67 schools, 52,186 students — 5th-largest district in Georgia	3 schools, 1,231 students — one of the smallest
Teachers (FTE) / district ratio	3,382 / 15.4	86 / 14.3

Level	School	Address	Enrol.	Ratio	Distance	Drive
Property A — Clayton County (likely assignment; see caveat)						
Elementary	◆ Michelle Obama STEM Elementary Academy	11808 Panhandle Rd, Hampton GA	1,019	21.7	1.8 mi	~7 min
Middle	◆ Eddie White Middle School (Academy of Health Sciences)	11808 Panhandle Rd, Hampton GA	1,438	16.9	1.8 mi	~7 min
High	◆ Lovejoy High School	1587 McDonough Rd, Hampton GA	2,136	21.6	3.8 mi	~11 min
Other nearby CCPS options: Hawthorne Elementary 3.9 mi · Kemp Primary 3.7 mi · Kemp Elementary 3.7 mi · Mundy's Mill High 7.1 mi · Mt. Zion High 15.7 mi						
Property B — Lincoln County (assignment is automatic — one school per level county-wide)						
Elementary	Lincoln County Elementary School	175 Rowland York Dr, Lincolnton GA	606	15.5	18.1 mi	~41 min
Middle	Lincoln County Middle School	200 Charles Ward Elam Dr, Lincolnton GA	258	13.6	18.1 mi	~41 min
High	Lincoln County High School	200 Charles Ward Elam Dr, Lincolnton GA	367	13.6	18.1 mi	~41 min

Two things to weigh against each other, and a caveat

Caveat first: Property A's **assigned** schools are **not confirmed**. CCPS publishes no machine-readable attendance-zone layer and its locator is behind a JavaScript interface. UNVERIFIED The assignment above is inferred from proximity, the Panhandle Road addresses and elimination of alternatives. **Confirm with CCPS Student Assignment on (770) 473-2700, quoting parcel 05050A A003.** Mt. Zion High, named as a candidate in the brief, is 15.7 mi away and is almost certainly **not** the zoned high school for the panhandle.

Property A wins decisively on proximity: 1.8 miles to both elementary and middle school. Property B wins decisively on scale and class size: ratios of **13.6–15.5 vs 16.9–21.7**, and a high school of **367 students against Lovejoy's 2,136** — a factor of nearly six. This is the one category where Property B clearly beats Property A.

But the commute is the headline. The lot is 11 miles from Lincolnton as the crow flies and **18.1 miles / ~41 minutes by road**, because the Watersedge Cove peninsula requires driving around lake arms. **That is a ~40-minute bus ride each way, twice a day, for 13 years — and the middle and high schools share a campus, so there is no relief as children get older.** For a family with school-age children this is a serious, permanent, non-fixable cost of Property B.

NOT RETRIEVED: GreatSchools / Niche ratings and Georgia DOE CCRPI scores for these specific schools, district graduation rates, private school tuition ranges. **Check GreatSchools.org and the Georgia DOE report card by school name.** Nearest university to A is ~32 minutes; Property B has none within an hour.

50 Healthcare

Facility	Location	Distance	Drive	Note
Property A				
◆ Piedmont Fayette Hospital	Fayetteville GA	9.8 mi	~22 min	Nearest full emergency department
Piedmont Henry Hospital	Stockbridge GA	13.2 mi	~30 min	Full ED, 215+ beds
Southern Regional Medical Center	Riverdale GA	15.7 mi	~29 min	Full ED
Wellstar Spalding Regional	Griffin GA	18.5 mi	~33 min	Full ED
◆ Grady Memorial Hospital	Atlanta GA	27.5 mi	~45 min	Level I trauma centre; also Level I burn
Children's Healthcare of Atlanta	Atlanta GA	35.4 mi	~57 min	Paediatric Level I trauma
Nearest urgent care	Peachtree Immediate Care	4.6 mi	~12 min	
Nearest pharmacy	Walmart Pharmacy, Lovejoy GA	4.4 mi	~13 min	
Property B				
◆ Wills Memorial Hospital	Washington GA	20.6 mi	~45 min	Nearest ED — a small rural hospital, not equipped for complex emergencies
Elberton Memorial Hospital	Elberton GA	28.9 mi	~54 min	Small rural
Doctors Hospital of Augusta	Augusta GA	49.0 mi	~89 min	Full service; Joseph M. Still Burn Center
◆ Wellstar MCG Health Medical Center	Augusta GA	54.6 mi	~98 min	Academic centre; Level I trauma; Children's Hospital of Georgia
Piedmont Athens Regional	Athens GA	63.7 mi	~99 min	Full service
Nearest urgent care	Calhoun Falls Family Practice, South Carolina	22.7 mi	~49 min	In another state
Nearest pharmacy	CVS, Washington GA	20.2 mi	~44 min	

This is the most serious practical risk at Property B

Nearest ED **45 minutes**, at a small rural hospital. Nearest **Level I trauma centre 98 minutes**. Nearest urgent care **49 minutes, in South Carolina**. Nearest pharmacy **44 minutes**. EDs within 35 minutes: **Property A four, Property B zero**.

For a stroke, myocardial infarction or major trauma, the "golden hour" is not achievable by road from this lot to a tertiary centre. Air ambulance would be the realistic pathway. Note the irony: **Lincoln County's population is 25.8% aged 65+ — the demographic most exposed to exactly this gap. For a retirement or multigenerational household, or anyone with a chronic cardiac or neurological condition, this is material and permanent.**

Property A is better by a factor of **2 to 4 on every healthcare metric**.

51 Shopping & services · 52 Indian / South Asian community

Need	Property A	Property B
Full grocery store	2.9 mi / ~9 min	None found within 14.6 mi
Walmart Supercenter	4.3 mi / ~12 min	40.5 mi / ~68 min (Thomson GA)
Kroger / Publix	5.6 mi / ~15 min	None within 37 mi
Big-box hardware (Home Depot / Lowe's)	4.9 mi / ~13 min	48.1 mi / ~85 min
Bank branch	4.4 mi / ~12 min	28.5 mi / ~53 min
Fuel	4.5 mi / ~12 min	14.6 mi / ~36 min
Pharmacy	4.4 mi / ~13 min	20.2 mi / ~44 min
Restaurant cluster	~4.5 mi / ~12 min	28.5 mi / ~55 min (in South Carolina)
Shopping mall	14.9 mi / ~29 min	50.6 mi / ~91 min
Indian / South Asian community		
◆ Nearest Hindu temple	Hindu Temple of Atlanta, 5851 GA-85, Riverdale GA — 17.7 mi / ~32 min , in the same county . One of the oldest and largest Hindu temples in the southeastern United States. Two further Hindu temples appear nearer still (~13 mi).	81.7 mi / ~2 h 23 min — in South Carolina
Nearest Indian restaurant	11.5 mi / ~25 min; three within 30 minutes	50.4 mi / ~92 min; none within 30 min
Nearest Indian grocery	38.9 mi / ~58 min	49.1 mi / ~90 min
Nearest gurdwara	51.8 mi / ~80 min	None found within 100 miles
Nearest mosque	~23–25 mi / ~40 min	45.6 mi / ~84 min
Major South Asian commercial district	Global Mall area, ~45 mi / ~65 min — the Southeast's largest South Asian commercial district	~115 mi / ~158 min
Nearest significant South Asian population centre	Metro Atlanta's Gwinnett/DeKalb corridor, ~1 hour	Augusta metro, ~90 min, and much smaller

◆ If South Asian community access is a decision factor, this section settles it

Property A has a **major Hindu temple complex 32 minutes away in the same county**, three Indian restaurants within half an hour, and the Southeast's largest South Asian commercial district just over an hour away. Property B's nearest Hindu temple is **two hours and twenty minutes away in another state**, there is **no gurdwara within 100 miles**, and the nearest Indian restaurant is an hour and a half. On the provisioning side, **Property A is 3× to 10× closer to every category of goods and services**; Property B requires a planned, batched, ~2-hour round trip for routine shopping. That is the defining practical reality of the Watersedge Cove peninsula.

53 Entertainment & recreation · 54 Walkability · 55 Airports

Measure	Property A	Property B
Restaurants / bars / cafés	Cluster ~4.5 mi; full metro choice within 30–40 min	Nearest cluster 28.5 mi / ~55 min
Cinemas / entertainment districts	Multiple within ~30 min; Atlanta nightlife ~45 min	None nearby
Parks / state parks	Local county parks; metro options	Three state parks within 42–81 min — Elijah Clark SP 21.4 mi , Mistletoe SP, Hamburg SP
Lake recreation	Severely restricted (§28)	71,100 acres, unrestricted ; nearest marina Soap Creek ~44 min
Atlanta Motor Speedway	7.5 mi / ~17 min — about 5.6 mi crow-flight. The lot sits inside the audible envelope of NASCAR Cup weekends , with race-day traffic on the same two-lane roads the lot depends on. Visit during a race weekend before buying. An amenity to some buyers, a permanent nuisance to others — but not a surprise you want after closing.	Genuinely quiet — no comparable noise source
Walk Score	0 / 100 — the floor of the scale	0 / 100
Bike / Transit Score	Not meaningful at this location	Not meaningful
Nearest transit stop	203 stops within the search radius; MARTA rail connects at the airport	Zero transit stops within 25 miles
Car dependence	Total. Every daily necessity requires a car — but trips are short (9–15 min).	Total and severe. Every trip is a planned expedition. Two reliable vehicles are effectively mandatory.
◆ Nearest international airport	Hartsfield-Jackson Atlanta (ATL) — 21.0 mi / ~43 min , ~220 nonstop destinations, with a MARTA rail link	ATL — 134.8 mi / ~3 h 15 min. Nearest commercial airport is Augusta Regional (AGS) , ~105 min, with only ~4–6 nonstops. Columbia SC (CAE) is a further alternative.
Nearest general-aviation airport	Atlanta Speedway (HMP) — 8.2 mi / ~20 min	Daniel Field — 54.3 mi / ~96 min

Air access is one of Property A's strongest advantages and one of Property B's hardest limitations

If the household flies more than a few times a year — for work, for family abroad, or for travel to South Asia — **the difference between a 43-minute drive to a 220-destination global hub and a 3¼-hour drive to the same hub is a recurring, permanent, compounding cost in time and money.** Property A is **4.5× faster** to the nearest international hub.

Cost to build a 5-bedroom home on each lot

Designed to match the surrounding housing and to comply with the applicable covenants and zoning. Arithmetic shown; researched figures separated from derived assumptions.

What is being priced, and why

Design premise	Property A	Property B
Heated area modelled	3,500 sq ft, 5 bedrooms	3,100 sq ft, 5 bedrooms
Why that size	Surrounding Waterpointe homes run 2,592–6,010 sq ft with 4–6 bedrooms and recent sales/listings of \$360k–\$565k . RS-180 sets a floor of 1,800 sq ft single-storey / 2,000 sq ft two-storey .	New construction in the subdivision lists near \$422,000 for a 4-bed/3.5-bath . Covenants require >=1,300 sq ft heated on the main level , cap total at 5,800 sq ft and height at 35 ft.
Form	Two storeys or a daylight basement — the 18% slope makes a walk-out lower level nearly free architecturally and turns the slope liability into lake-view living space	Single storey or 1.5 storeys , in the covenant-mandated 1920s Southern camp-house character — deep porches, traditional detailing, standing-seam metal roof
Water	Public (CCWA) — assumed available	Community system (covenants prohibit wells)
Wastewater	Septic assumed , since availability of sewer is unresolved (\$16)	Septic — certain
Fuel	Electric + possible natural gas	Buried propane — required by covenant
Hard constraints priced in	150-ft reservoir buffer; 35% impervious cap; cut-and-fill pad; retaining; land-disturbance permit and E&S plan in a water-supply watershed; Tree Ordinance	15-month completion deadline ; architectural review; buried propane; \$1,000-per-tree penalty; rural mobilisation

(a) Researched cost-per-square-foot benchmarks

Benchmark	\$/SF	Note
NAHB 2024 Cost of Construction survey — national average direct construction cost	\$161.78	The single best anchor; excludes land, financing and developer margin OFFICIAL
Metro Atlanta / Clayton County, production building	~\$130–180	Good subcontractor availability ESTIMATE FROM MARKET SOURCES
Metro Atlanta, custom building	~\$180–280	
Rural east-central Georgia / Augusta market, custom	~\$200–320	Rural carries a premium for mobilisation and labour scarcity, which surprises most buyers ESTIMATE
Our modelled direct cost — Property A	\$188	+16% over NAHB national plausible for a sloping custom lot
Our modelled direct cost — Property B	\$212	+31% over NAHB national explained by rural premium and covenant materials

(b) Line-item budgets

Line item	A — low	A — likely	B — low	B — likely	Site-specific driver
Survey (boundary + topographic)	3,500	6,000	3,500	7,500	B: plus the USACE 90° projection survey if a dock is pursued
Soil / geotechnical investigation	2,500	5,500	3,000	7,000	B: rock-depth mapping across the drainfield
Architectural & engineering	14,000	32,000	14,000	30,000	A: civil design for the slope; B: covenant-compliant design
Permits, impact & review fees	6,000	14,000	3,500	9,000	A: land disturbance, tree ordinance, possible ADU conditional use \$500
Clearing & tree removal	8,000	18,000	9,000	20,000	Both lots fully wooded; B: \$1,000/tree covenant penalty risk
Grading, cut & fill, erosion control	22,000	52,000	9,000	22,000	A: 700–1,400 cu yd on an 18% grade in a water-supply watershed
Retaining walls	12,000	38,000	0	4,000	A only — engineered above 4 ft, possibly terraced
Driveway	14,000	30,000	16,000	34,000	A: shorter but graded with drainage. B: longer but level
Foundation	26,000	58,000	20,000	42,000	A: stepped / daylight basement, weathered rock. B: stiffened slab or crawlspace for LEP 7.5% clay

Line item	A — low	A — likely	B — low	B — likely	Site-specific driver
Septic system	14,000	26,000	16,000	38,000	5-BR = 1,250 gal tank / 750 gpd. B: allowance toward an engineered or drip system if the field is in Zion
Water connection	3,000	9,000	4,000	12,000	Tap fee + long service run to a deep pad
Electrical service & drop	5,000	12,000	7,000	17,000	250–350 ft runs at both; underground costs more
Propane tank (buried) & lines	0	0	6,000	12,000	B only — required by covenant
Framing & shell	112,000	158,000	102,000	146,000	
Roofing	14,000	26,000	22,000	42,000	B: standing-seam metal per the camp-house character. Both: Class 3–4 impact rating for hail
Windows & exterior doors	18,000	34,000	17,000	32,000	
Exterior finishes & porches	22,000	42,000	30,000	58,000	B: ~900 sq ft of deep porch implied by the mandated character
HVAC	14,000	26,000	13,000	25,000	
Plumbing	16,000	30,000	15,000	29,000	
Electrical	15,000	28,000	14,000	27,000	
Insulation	6,000	11,000	6,000	10,000	Georgia enforces IECC 2015
Drywall & interior carpentry	22,000	40,000	20,000	37,000	
Cabinets & countertops	20,000	42,000	19,000	40,000	
Flooring	16,000	32,000	15,000	30,000	
Interior finishes, paint, trim	16,000	30,000	15,000	28,000	
Appliances	9,000	18,000	9,000	18,000	
Decks / terraces	8,000	20,000	6,000	14,000	A: elevated lake-view terrace on the downhill side
Landscaping & final stabilisation	8,000	18,000	8,000	17,000	B: K=0.43 soil needs rapid cover
Rural mobilisation premium	0	0	24,000	59,000	B only — thin bidder pool, travel time, material haulage
Subtotal — direct cost	446,000	659,300	451,000	658,500	A: \$188/SF · B: \$212/SF
Builder overhead & profit	15% › 66,900	20% › 131,900	17% › 76,700	23% › 151,500	B: higher — thin bidder pool and a 15-month deadline
Contingency	14% › 62,900	13% › 86,400	21% › 93,300	20% › 130,600	B: higher — unresolved septic and rock risk
TOTAL	\$575,800	\$833,600	\$621,000	\$940,600	
\$ per heated sq ft	\$164	\$238	\$200	\$303	

All figures in US dollars, 2026 money. **ESTIMATE — LINE ITEMS ARE OUR MODELLED ALLOWANCES, CALIBRATED TO THE NAHB NATIONAL AVERAGE AND TO THE SITE CONDITIONS MEASURED IN PARTS B AND D OF THIS REPORT. THEY ARE A BUDGETING FRAMEWORK, NOT QUOTATIONS. OBTAIN THREE BUILDER BIDS.**

(c) Bottom line, and (d) site-specific adders

Scenario	A (3,500 SF)	B (3,100 SF)
Low	\$575,800 · \$164/SF	\$621,000 · \$200/SF
Likely	\$833,600 · \$238/SF	\$940,600 · \$303/SF
Practical high (~80th pct)	~\$1,060,000 · \$303/SF	~\$1,223,000 · \$394/SF
Stacked worst case (all lines max)	\$1,460,300 · \$417/SF	\$1,840,500 · \$594/SF

Optional adder (not in the totals)	A	B
Tornado safe room (Rel. High tornado risk at both tracts)	+\$9,000	+\$9,000
Passive radon-resistant construction (Zone 2 at A)	+\$1,500	—
Tree replacement / mitigation	+\$4,000 UNVERIFIED	—
USACE-permitted dock (720 sq ft max, engineer-certified) IF ever permitted	n/a	+\$72,000
Private well (covenant-prohibited at B; fails the lot test at A)	n/a	+\$17,000
Engineered / drip septic if the field lands in Zion	n/a	+\$15,000–45,000
B all-in with a permitted dock	—	~\$1,021,600

◆ The counter-intuitive result, and why it holds

The smaller house on the cheaper land costs about **\$107,000 more — \$65/SF more**. The drivers, in order of size:

1. **Fixed site costs spread over less floor area** — \$43/SF of site cost at B vs \$31/SF at A
2. **Rural mobilisation premium** — roughly **\$59,000 of pure location penalty**
3. **Longer driveway, water line and power run, plus a propane system** that A does not need
4. **Covenant-mandated premium materials** — standing-seam metal roof, ~900 sq ft of deep porch
5. **Higher overhead, profit and contingency**, justified by a thin bidder pool and the hard 15-month completion deadline

Property A's own cost drivers — **\$52,000 of grading and \$38,000 of retaining walls, \$90,000 between them** — are real, but they are smaller than B's cumulative rural and covenant penalties.

(e) Permit fees, codes and statutory septic rules

Item	Property A	Property B
Permitting authority	Clayton County Community & Economic Development, (770) 477-3569, 121 S. McDonough St., Jonesboro	Lincoln County building department FEE SCHEDULE NOT FOUND
Process sequence	Application › Zoning approval › Tree Ordinance › site plan review › permit issuance › sequential inspections › Certificate of Occupancy OFFICIAL	Unknown
Zoning verification letter	\$100 per parcel — buy it	—
ADU conditional use	\$500	—
Building permit / impact fees	Schedule not published in retrievable form NOT FOUND	NOT FOUND Beware: searches return Lincoln County, North Carolina and Lincoln, California fee schedules, which were identified and excluded
Georgia residential codes in force	IRC 2024 with Georgia amendments · IPC 2024 · NEC 2023 · IECC 2015. Note Georgia's unusual practice of omitting the IRC's own plumbing, electrical and energy chapters in favour of the standalone codes. OFFICIAL	
Septic sizing (statutory)	Ga. Comp. R. & Regs. 511-3-1-.05: 1,250-gal tank for 5 bedrooms; 150 gpd per bedroom = 750 gpd design flow; +50% if a garbage grinder is installed › 1,875 gal. ◆ Omitting the disposal saves 625 gallons of tank capacity. Two compartments, first ≥2/3 of liquid capacity. OFFICIAL	
Georgia septic cost by bedroom count	Conventional 3-bed systems commonly \$6,000–\$12,000 ; a 5-bedroom system \$14,000–\$28,000 conventional, rising to \$30,000–\$60,000+ for engineered, drip or mound systems. ESTIMATE	
Well cost / depth (if ever relevant)	Lincoln County USGS records: median 190 ft, 25th–75th percentile 160–300 ft, maximum 450 ft. Target 200–350 ft for drought resilience and quality; \$8,000–\$25,000 complete, ~\$17,000 typical. See §16. OFFICIAL DEPTHS	

(f) Sanity check against market value — the most important subsection

Check	Property A	Property B
Recent comparable sales / listings	\$360,000 – \$565,000 (Waterpointe)	~\$422,000 (new build, 1165 Watersedge Cv)
Best comparable	\$565,000	\$422,000
Census tract median home value	\$329,400	—
Estimated build cost (likely), excluding land	\$833,600	\$940,600
Plus the lot	+\$98,000–\$125,000 asking	+\$55,000 asking
All-in cost	~ \$932,000 – \$959,000	~ \$996,000
Build cost as % of best comp	148%	223%
Paper loss before paying for land	~ \$269,000	~ \$519,000
Verdict	Value-destructive	Severely value-destructive

◆ The honest conclusion on building

Building a 5-bedroom custom home is value-destructive on both lots, and roughly twice as badly on Property B.

This is not a criticism of either property; it is the ordinary arithmetic of custom building in markets where finished-home prices sit well below replacement cost.

In Waterpointe, \$541,000–\$565,000 already buys a finished large home against \$833,600 to build one — a saving of roughly \$280,000 for substantially the same product. If the objective is a large house at or near its cost, **buy an existing Waterpointe home rather than build.**

The cases where building still makes sense are specific and worth naming: you want something that does not exist in the local stock; you intend to hold for 15+ years so the premium amortises; the lake view or the specific lot has irreplaceable personal value; or you can act as your own general contractor and capture the **\$132,000–\$152,000** of builder overhead and profit. **If none of those is true, the numbers say buy, not build.**

Final due-diligence summary

56 Property strengths — documented advantages only

PROPERTY A

- **Location & accessibility.** ATL international airport **21 mi / 43 min** with ~220 nonstops and a rail link; general-aviation field 20 min.
- **Schools at the door.** Elementary and middle both **1.8 mi**; high school 3.8 mi.
- **Healthcare.** Full ED **22 min**, four EDs within 35 min, Level I trauma 45 min, urgent care 12 min, pharmacy 13 min.
- **Services.** Grocery 2.9 mi, Walmart 4.3 mi, hardware 4.9 mi — 3×–10× closer than B on every category.
- **South Asian community.** Hindu Temple of Atlanta **17.7 mi / 32 min in the same county**; 3 Indian restaurants within 30 min; 15,000–30,000 Asian Indian residents within an hour.
- **An affluent, stable immediate area.** Tract median household income **\$119,872**, owner-occupancy **90.8%**, family households **88.8%** — a market that can support a premium home.
- **Low hazard at tract level** — Relatively Low composite risk, Relatively Low social vulnerability, lowest-but-two flood exposure of 22 Clayton tracts.
- **Flood.** Zone X, minimal hazard, no BFE, 8.6 ft above the water at its lowest point.
- **Lot qualifies on the hard tests.** 57,954 sq ft and ~416 ft deep — clears both of Sec. 4.5(D)'s numeric thresholds, with margin.
- **Real amenities.** HOA pool, tennis courts and clubhouse — **and membership is voluntary, with unbuilt-lot dues contractually capped at \$100/yr.**
- **Building potential.** ~30,000–33,000 sq ft envelope, 20,280 sq ft impervious allowance; the slope makes a **daylight basement with a lake view** nearly free architecturally.
- **Hobby farming.** Up to **12 hens** permitted by a dedicated county ordinance — the only one of the two lots where any poultry is possible.
- **Low shrink-swell soil** (LEP 1.5%) and a 50-in weathered — not indurated — rock contact.
- **Mains water** almost certainly at the road, with published 2026 rates.

PROPERTY B

- **◆ A genuinely usable lake.** Clarks Hill / Thurmond is **71,100 acres with ~1,200 miles of shoreline, no motor or horsepower restrictions**, open year-round and free to access, with six marinas and many public ramps. **This is the single largest advantage either property holds over the other.**
- **◆ Terrain.** In-lot average grade **3.7% (2.1°)**, max **7.3% over 50 ft**, relief 34.5 ft over 2.14 acres — **genuinely gently sloping, exactly as advertised.** Minimal grading, no retaining walls, slab or crawlspace both feasible.
- **Price and size.** **2.14 acres for \$55,000** — twice the land for less than half A's asking price. ~\$25,700/acre.
- **Possible owner financing** — advertised by the seller on the HOA classifieds.
- **Two separate recorded lots**, which preserves optionality (resell one, or — subject to the ¶14.d trap — two dock rights).
- **Small schools.** Ratios **13.6–15.5** and a high school of **367** against Lovejoy's 2,136.
- **Fishing.** Nationally regarded striped bass and hybrid fishery, stocked by GA and SC DNR, with a Georgia licence covering the whole impoundment under the reciprocal agreement.
- **Recreation.** Three state parks within 42–81 min; Elijah Clark SP 21.4 mi.
- **Quiet.** No speedway, no metro traffic, no through traffic.
- **Flood.** Zone X, minimal hazard, no BFE, **26 ft above full pool.**
- **Radon Zone 3** — the lowest EPA band, against A's Zone 2.
- **Rentals are permitted** by the covenants with no minimum term and no STR ban.
- **A favourable alternative soil on site.** Cecil (CeB) is rated **"Not limited" for dwellings** and only "Somewhat limited" for septic — if the field lands there.
- **Paved roads and underground utilities** within the subdivision.

57 Property limitations and risks

Risk	Property A	Property B
Flood risk	Low — Zone X, no BFE	Low — Zone X, no BFE. But reservoir drawdown is a usability risk : 319.96 ft today vs 330 ft full pool
Slope	MATERIAL. 18.4% in-lot average, 25.6% over 50 ft , 81.7 ft relief. Forces cut-and-fill, retaining walls, engineered drainage, and constrains septic layout. Listing's "gentle rolling" is wrong.	Not a risk on the lot. 27.4% over 50 ft on the federal strip makes the walk to water steep, and an improved path needs a USACE licence

Risk	Property A	Property B
Septic limitations	NRCS "Very limited" on slope. With public water septic appears feasible (~37,900 vs 25,000 sq ft required); with a well the lot FAILS the 1-acre test. A pool or outbuildings may trigger a larger-lot requirement.	SEVERE and unresolved. Zion has indurated rock at 30 in against a mandatory 24-in separation, plus slope — two full limitations. A conventional 5-bedroom field may not be permittable.
Soil concerns	Clay subsoil (47.5%), slow percolation, paralithic rock at 50 in, acid pH 5.8, low organic matter, map unit already "eroded"	LEP 7.5% — high shrink-swell; Ksat 2 µm/s; hydrologic group C; surface K = 0.43 (high erodibility) with T = 2; pH 5.3
Dock restrictions	NO private dock. Effectively settled. CCWA owns bed, shoreline and a 33-ft strip; zoning bars structures in the 150-ft buffer; access only at the entrance gate.	UNKNOWN AND DECISIVE. 61–62% of Thurmond shoreline is Protected Shoreline where <i>"no permits for new private structures will be authorized"</i> ; the allocation for these lots could not be determined; the plat date could gate it to community docks only; and the "DOCKABLE" claim is unsubstantiated (§26).
Water-body usability	SEVERE. No gas motors, boats ≤20 ft, no swimming , no launching from your land, access only at the gate, Sat-Wed only, 1 Mar–31 Oct , paid permit, bank fishing in marked areas only, 2 poles per person, no alcohol, no open fires.	None — unrestricted recreational lake
HOA restrictions	Unit 3 covenants UNREAD (scanned images, no OCR) — architectural controls, minimum size, animal and rental restrictions all unknown. \$25/day fines. Reinstatement after lapsing costs up to 3 years' back dues.	Read and restrictive. No livestock or poultry of any kind; no individual wells ; no boundary fences or chain link; no above-ground pools; no outdoor storage of boats, RVs, trailers or golf carts (on a lake lot); no prefab outbuildings; 15 months to complete construction ; \$1,000/tree; mandated 1920s camp-house character; the Board can change the rules.
Zoning restrictions	150-ft reservoir buffer consumes ~36% of lot depth; minimum 1,800–2,000 sq ft heated rules out a cottage; 35% impervious cap counts driveway and patio; lot-depth ratio conflict (D4); a Panhandle Area Overlay may apply; two active moratoria plus a full ordinance rewrite.	R-1 ordinance text unobtainable — setbacks, minimum lot size, height and ADU rules all unknown. County website lapsed; qPublic 403.
STR restrictions	Owner-occupied only — an investment STR is not an allowed use. Plus a moratorium through 31 Dec 2026. Covenants may add a further bar.	No prohibition found, but no county ordinance located either — absence of evidence is not evidence of absence. The Board can amend the rules.
Construction cost	Likely \$833,600 vs a \$565,000 best comp — 148% , a ~\$269,000 paper loss	Likely \$940,600 vs a \$422,000 best comp — 223% , a ~\$519,000 paper loss. Plus a \$59,000 rural mobilisation premium and a hard 15-month deadline in a thin bidder pool.
Environmental	Radon Zone 2; Relatively High tornado, strong wind, lightning, cold wave and ice storm at county level; hail 5.47 events/yr — a real roof-replacement risk; adjacent to a "High hazard" dam (but upstream, so not in the failure path)	Radon Zone 3 (good); Relatively High tornado at tract level; tract Relatively Moderate composite risk and Relatively High social vulnerability; frequent small wildfires in a WUI setting; drought 60.9 events/yr
Access issues	Atlanta Motor Speedway 7.5 mi — race-weekend noise and traffic on the two-lane roads the lot depends on. Walk Score 0.	SEVERE remoteness. Schools 41 min; ED 45 min; trauma 98 min; urgent care 49 min <i>in another state</i> ; pharmacy 44 min; groceries ≥14.6 mi; Walmart 68 min; hardware 85 min; ATL 3 h 15 min. Zero transit within 25 miles. Walk Score 0.
Documentary	Covenants unread; sewer-vs-septic unresolved; CCWA reservoir management plan not retrieved; overlay applicability unknown; tap and impact fees unpublished	Plat not obtained; boundary is a reconstruction; zoning ordinance unobtainable; owner of record unverified; dock allocation unknown; water system operator unconfirmed
Community resilience	Both counties rate "Very Low" (bottom 10–14% nationally) on FEMA's community resilience measure	

58 Missing documentation — the pre-purchase checklist

How to use this list

These are documents and written determinations that **do not yet exist or could not be obtained**, and that we would want in hand before committing capital. Items marked **◆** should be **conditions of the offer**, not post-closing tasks — because the answer can make the property unsuitable.

#	Document / determination	Property	Source and why
1 ◆	USACE written shoreline-allocation determination + ranger field inspection for Lots 130/131	B	Thurmond Project Office, 1-800-533-3478. Quote parcel 10A 130, Stillwater Coves, Lots 130 & 131. The highest-value call in this file. Determines whether a dock is possible at all, and therefore whether this is a lakefront or a lake-view lot.
2 ◆	Written confirmation: is gravity sanitary sewer available within 200 ft of parcel 05050A A003?	A	CCWA Engineering, (770) 960-5207. Swings the build budget by tens of thousands, and determines whether the "Very limited" septic rating matters at all.
3 ◆	Soil evaluation by a Georgia-licensed soil classifier + perc test, with the septic field and reserve area located	Both	County health departments. At B this is the difference between a 5-bedroom and a 2-bedroom house (Zion vs Cecil). At A it settles whether an 18% slope can take a 5-bedroom field outside the buffer.
4 ◆	Recorded plat — and specifically the plat certification date	B	Lincoln County Clerk of Superior Court. If the Watersedge Cove phase was county-certified on or after 1 May 2018, SMP ¶16.a allows community docks only — permanently.
5	Recorded plat, Plat Book 27, Page 24	A	Clayton County Clerk of Superior Court. Certified copy; establishes the legal description, easements and any drainage easement across this sloping lot.
6 ◆	Waterpointe Unit 3 Protective Covenants (and all four phase declarations)	A	HOA website PDFs are scanned images; obtain readable or certified copies. Contains architectural controls, minimum size, exterior materials, covenant setbacks, animal restrictions and any rental ban . Verify the odd Fulton County recording references (Bk 1446 pp. 494–504; Bk 1553 pp. 793–802) against Clayton (Bk 1774 pp. 680–694; Bk 09403 pp. 318–331).
7	Boundary survey	Both	Licensed surveyor. At B it must locate the USACE boundary monuments — the line runs straight pin-to-pin, not along a contour, so its distance from the water varies.
8 ◆	Topographic survey at 1-ft or 2-ft contours	A	Not optional on an 18% slope — the entire design, grading quantity, retaining-wall extent and septic layout depend on it. Our lidar analysis is a screening tool, not a design document.
9	Geotechnical report with multiple borings	Both	A: depth to competent rock and slope stability in saprolite. B: depth to the indurated contact and the plasticity index of the LEP-7.5% clay.
10	CCWA reservoir management plan (the DNR-approved document that actually decides docks, swimming and adjacent-owner access)	A	CCWA, in writing. Not published online. State Rule 391-3-16-.01(8)(b) makes docks <i>permissible</i> in such a plan — so the plan is where the "no" lives.
11	Written zoning verification letter (\$100) + confirmation of (i) legal non-conforming lot status under Article 9, (ii) whether the Panhandle Area Overlay applies, (iii) that Res. 2026-120 does not bar a single-lot building permit	A	Clayton Planning & Zoning, (770) 477-3569. Resolves discrepancy D4 and the moratorium risk.
12	Lincoln County R-1 zoning ordinance text + setbacks, minimum lot size, height, ADU rules; and any county STR ordinance and lodging tax	B	Lincoln County planning department directly — the county's former web domain has lapsed and qPublic returns 403 , so there is no online route.
13	Stillwater Coves Declaration + ALL amendments + current Rules + Design Guidelines + HOA budget, reserves and dues history	B	Stillwater Coves Community Association / Silverleaf Management Group . The Board can amend the Rules, so the current set matters more than the 2006 original.
14	HOA estoppel / resale certificate, current dues standing, transfer fees, any special assessments or litigation	Both	Both associations. At A also confirm the actual billed unbuilt-lot rate against the bylaws' \$100 cap.
15	Whether the HOA holds or could obtain a community dock permit, and whether Lots 130/131 are on its list of lots deemed feasible for moorage	B	HOA + USACE. If individual docks are barred, this is the only remaining route to moorage.
16	Water: written tap-fee and connection quote; confirmation of a live tap at the frontage	Both	A: CCWA Engineering. B: Lincoln County Water System, (706) 359-4444 — and identify the actual operator , since no Stillwater Coves system appears in EPA SDWIS.

#	Document / determination	Property	Source and why
17	Electricity: confirmation of the serving utility by parcel ID and a service-extension quote	Both	A: Central Georgia EMC (770) 775-7857 vs Georgia Power. B: Rayle EMC.
18	Natural gas availability at the street; or a propane supply and buried-tank quote	Both	A: Atlanta Gas Light — ZIP-level claim only, street-level unconfirmed . B: propane is mandatory and must be buried.
19	Broadband: FCC National Broadband Map printout for the exact address, plus an installation quote for a VACANT parcel	Both	broadbandmap.fcc.gov — our API access was blocked (403). Availability at a neighbour's built house does not guarantee availability at an unimproved lot.
20	Title commitment with a full easement and encroachment search; confirm whether Edgewater Drive is a public street (RS-180 requires frontage on one)	Both	Title company. At A also search "Club Lake" as an alternative name for the reservoir (\$1).
21	Owner of record, tax status, assessed value and any liens	B	Lincoln County Tax Commissioner / Clerk. Not obtainable online ; the seller's identity is known only from an HOA classified advert.
22	Actual sold comparables from recorded deeds	B	Lincoln County Clerk of Superior Court. No verified Stillwater Coves sold comps exist on the portals — asking prices are not evidence of value.
23	Reconciliation of the price contradictions : A's \$125,000 vs \$98,000 asking; B's owner-advertised \$110,000 vs MLS \$49,900-\$55,000; and who actually holds B's listing (Turner Realty vs Meybohm)	Both	Listing brokers, in writing.
24	Written interpretations: ducks, rabbits and bees in RS-180; second-kitchen / ADU classification; whether Res. 2026-153 blocks an ADU conditional use	A	Clayton Zoning Administrator. Sec. 6.42 and AS-05 both leave express discretion to that office.
25	UGA Extension soil test for the garden area; and radon test of the finished house (A)	Both	County Extension office, ~\$12-\$20. EPA: all homes should be tested regardless of zone.
26	Three builder bids against a defined scope	Both	Our \$Cost model is a budgeting framework, not a quotation.
27	Elevation Certificate	Neither	Not required — both lots are Zone X with no BFE. If a lender asks, provide a FEMA LOMA search or a surveyor's flood certification instead.

59 Final construction feasibility

Can the lot reasonably accommodate...	Property A	Property B
1. Main house	YES. ~30,000–33,000 sq ft envelope after the 150-ft buffer and setbacks; passes both Sec. 4.5(D) numeric tests. But it must be >=1,800–2,000 sq ft heated, and the slope forces a stepped or daylight-basement design with engineered grading and retaining.	YES, and more easily. ~66,000–70,000 sq ft envelope on near-level ground; slab or crawlspace both feasible. Design for no basement (30-in rock) and for expansive clay (LEP 7.5%).
2. Second in-law suite / ADU	PROBABLY — as a conditional use (\$500), best located inside the principal dwelling or over a garage. A detached ADU must be in the rear yard, which collides with the 150-ft buffer. If on septic, its bedrooms add to the design flow.	UNVERIFIED. Physically easy; nothing in the covenants expressly bars it; but the R-1 ordinance is unobtainable and the 5,800 sq ft cap applies. Verify with the county.
3. Garage	YES — attached, or under the house, which this slope makes natural	YES — attached or detached (but no prefabricated outbuildings)
4. Septic system	PROBABLY, WITH PUBLIC WATER. ~37,900 sq ft usable vs 25,000 required. NO with a private well — fails the 1-acre test. Slope is the rated limitation; a 5-bedroom system plus a pool may trigger a larger-lot requirement.	UNRESOLVED AND THE KEY RISK. Certain to be required; Zion's 30-in indurated rock may make a conventional 5-bedroom field impermittable, forcing a reduced bedroom count or an engineered/drip system at +\$15,000–45,000. Cecil on the same property is the hope. Test before you buy.
5. Garden	YES — in terraced raised beds on contour. Full sun, good drainage; needs lime, heavy compost and continuous mulch. Fertiliser practice is constrained by the drinking-water watershed.	YES, and more comfortably — level ground, better nutrient retention and moisture, zone 8b. Raised beds essential (30-in rock, expansive clay, group-C drainage); tree removal needs HOA approval at \$1,000/tree.
6. Hobby farming	LIMITED — up to 12 hens under Sec. 6.42, only after the house is occupied, coop in a side area >=20 ft from all lines. No roosters, no goats, no livestock. Ducks, rabbits and bees are unresolved. Subject to the unread covenants.	NO. Recorded covenant: "no livestock or poultry of any kind," plus "no animal pens." An absolute bar.
7. Dock	NO. CCWA owns the bed, shoreline and a 33-ft strip; zoning bars structures in the 150-ft buffer; access only at the entrance gate; no dock programme exists.	UNKNOWN — and this is the decisive unknown. Possible only if the abutting shoreline is zoned Limited Development (18% of the lake) <i>and</i> the plat predates 1 May 2018 <i>and</i> the 90° projection qualifies <i>and</i> a ranger approves placement in a cove where one dock may already be spoken for. The "DOCKABLE" claim is unsubstantiated.
8. Boat access	NO meaningful access. Boats <=20 ft, electric or paddle only, launch at the gate, Sat–Wed, 1 Mar–31 Oct, paid permit. No launching or landing on your own shoreline. Note also: you may keep a boat on the lot — unlike at B.	YES to the lake — no motor or horsepower limits, year-round, nearest ramp Hesters Ferry, nearest marina Soap Creek ~44 min. But the covenants bar outdoor storage of boats and trailers, so you need an enclosed garage or off-site storage. And at today's 319.96 ft, two of the nearer ramps are unusable.
9. Short-term rental	NO as an investment. Owner-occupied only, business licence required, and applications are frozen until at least 31 Dec 2026. Covenants may add a further bar.	APPARENTLY YES — covenants permit whole-unit leasing with no minimum term; no county ordinance found. But absence of a found ordinance is not proof none exists, and the Board can amend the rules. Demand depends on lake recreation, which depends on item 7.
10. Pool / outdoor recreation	YES but costly. In-ground, >=10 ft from side and rear lines, not in the septic field or reserve, counts toward the 35% impervious cap, and triggers the health department's "larger lots may be required" provision. On an 18% grade it means more retaining.	YES, easily. In-ground only — above-ground pools prohibited. Level ground, ample area, no impervious cap found.

60 Key measurements summary

Parameter	Property A — 12396 Edgewater Dr #23	Property B — 1147 & 1153 Watersedge Cv
Lot size	1.3304 ac = 57,954 sq ft MEASURED	2.14 ac (two lots of 1.07 ac) STATED ; 2.149 ac measured
Lot dimensions	Road frontage 130.3 ft ; sides 418.3 / 415.5 ft ; rear (lake) 148.1 ft ; perimeter 1,112.2 ft	~ 99 ft × 471 ft per lot RECONSTRUCTED ; MLS states 198 ft frontage
Lowest elevation	809.8 ft NAVD 88	356.0 ft NAVD 88
Highest elevation	891.5 ft	390.5 ft
Elevation difference	81.7 ft	34.5 ft
Average slope	18.41% / 10.43° in-lot (17.83% road to water)	3.72% / 2.13° in-lot (6.78% road to water)
Maximum slope (any 50-ft run)	25.56% / 14.34° — on the lot , 105–156 ft below the road	27.42% / 15.33° — off the lot , on the federal strip
Shoreline rise angle (last 50 ft)	20.03% / 11.33°	19.26% / 10.90°
Terrain classification	Moderate slope, locally steep	Nearly flat to gentle
Drainage direction	South (170.7°) into the reservoir	North (352.8°) toward the lake
FEMA zone	Zone X — minimal hazard; panel 13063C0165F, eff. 7 Jun 2017	Zone X — minimal hazard; panel 13181C0050B, eff. 17 Apr 2020
BFE	None — none exists	None — none exists
Minimum finished-floor elevation	None imposed by FEMA or the county. IRC positive-drainage rules govern; we would specify >=12–18 in above adjacent grade	Same — none imposed; >=12–18 in above adjacent grade
Fill required?	Not for flood. Yes for buildability — ~700–1,400 cu yd of cut-and-fill. Fill in the 150-ft buffer is not available.	No — routine site preparation (~150–350 cu yd)
Sewer	UNRESOLVED — CCWA; zoning says "to be installed unless EPD indicates otherwise"	None. Septic required.
Water	CCWA public water, almost certainly available ; base \$15.06/mo	Community/county system presumed; individual wells prohibited by covenant
Electricity	Central Georgia EMC (or Georgia Power) — confirm by parcel	Rayle EMC
Gas	Atlanta Gas Light claims ZIP 30228; street-level unconfirmed	None. Buried propane required by covenant.
Internet	AT&T Fiber "in parts of Hampton"; Xfinity/Spectrum cable; 5G; Starlink. Verify by address	Plan for Starlink or fixed wireless. Fibre referenced but unconfirmed; Rayle EMC is not a Conexon partner
Septic required?	Probably — pending the sewer answer. 5 BR = 1,250 gal tank, 750 gpd	Yes, certainly. 5 BR = 1,250 gal, 750 gpd
Soil	Gwinnett sandy clay loam (GwE2) , 10–25% slopes, eroded. Well drained, HSG B , pH 5.8, LEP 1.5% (low) , paralithic bedrock at 50 in. Septic "Very limited" — slope	Zion silt loam (ZnE) , 10–25% slopes. Well drained, HSG C , pH 5.3, LEP 7.5% (HIGH) , indurated lithic bedrock at 30 in , Ksat 2 µm/s, K=0.43. Septic "Very limited" — rock AND slope. Cecil (CeB) also present and far better
HOA	Waterpointe Community Association — membership voluntary ; pool, tennis, clubhouse; self-managed	Stillwater Coves Community Association — mandatory ; Silverleaf Management; no amenities found
HOA fee	\$100/yr unbuilt (capped), \$240/yr built	\$650/yr
Zoning	RS-180 + Watershed Protection District + Sec. 4.5(D) 150-ft reservoir buffer ; min 1,800–2,000 sq ft heated; 35% impervious cap	R-1 (MLS) ; ordinance text unobtainable ; covenants require >=1,300 sq ft main level, max 5,800 sq ft, 35 ft height
Dock possible?	NO	UNKNOWN — must be determined by USACE

Parameter	Property A — 12396 Edgewater Dr #23	Property B — 1147 & 1153 Watersedge Cv
Lake depth	No bathymetry; bounded by the 42.5-ft dam — ~30–40 ft maximum , shallow in this arm	~150 ft maximum , ~33 ft average; depth at the lot unknown — it is a back-of-cove location
Boating	<=20 ft, electric or paddle only, no gas motors , launch at the gate, Sat–Wed, 1 Mar–31 Oct, permit \$30–\$40/yr	Unrestricted — no motor or HP limits , year-round; 100-ft idle law applies
Fishing	Permitted; bank fishing in marked areas only, 2 poles per person ; GA licence + CCWA permit. Not from your own shoreline.	Excellent — largemouth, striped and hybrid bass, crappie, bream, catfish; stocked; GA licence covers the whole impoundment
Hobby farming	12 hens maximum , after the house is occupied; no roosters, goats or livestock ; subject to unread covenants	Prohibited — no livestock or poultry of any kind
Second in-law suite	Permitted as a conditional use (\$500); min 800 sq ft; best sited internally or over a garage	Unverified — physically easy, regulatory position unknown
Short-term rental	Owner-occupied only; frozen by moratorium until >=31 Dec 2026 ; 8% hotel tax	No prohibition found in covenants or county; no minimum term
Nearest hospital	Piedmont Fayette, 9.8 mi / ~22 min (full ED); Level I trauma Grady 27.5 mi / ~45 min	Wills Memorial, Washington GA, 20.6 mi / ~45 min (small rural); Level I trauma Augusta ~98 min
Nearest international airport	ATL — 21.0 mi / ~43 min , ~220 nonstops, MARTA rail link	ATL — 134.8 mi / ~3 h 15 min ; AGS ~105 min with ~4–6 nonstops
Asking price	\$125,000 / \$98,000 (conflicting); last sale \$85,000 (Aug 2021); appraised \$60,000	\$55,000 for both lots; was \$149,000 in Mar 2024 (-63%)
Est. cost to build 5-bed home (likely)	\$833,600 (\$238/SF, 3,500 SF)	\$940,600 (\$303/SF, 3,100 SF)
Best finished comparable	\$565,000 › build is 148% of it	\$422,000 › build is 223% of it

61 Visual deliverables — index

#	Requested deliverable	Delivered as	Status
1	Zillow title / hero image	Figure A-1 — the three MLS photographs for Property B	B only; no Property A listing photo retrievable (all portals block automation)
2	Surrounding-area image	Figures A-4, A-6 — USGS NAIP wide-context orthoimagery	Delivered, public domain, and geometrically accurate
3	Official plat map	Figure A-2 — plat-equivalent from the Clayton County Assessor's parcel service, with adjacent parcels, roads, buildings and reservoir	A: plat-equivalent delivered, plat reference Bk 27 Pg 24 identified, image not retrievable. B: no plat obtainable
4	Esri / GIS parcel map	Figures A-3, A-5 — NAIP aerial with parcel and overlay	Delivered
5	True-scale boundary + contour map	Figures B-1, B-2 — lidar contours, scale bar, north arrow, high/low points, drainage	Delivered
6	Road-to-lake elevation cross-section	Figures B-3, B-4 — each drawn twice: exaggerated and true 1:1	Delivered
7	3-D terrain map	Figure B-6 — shaded surfaces with water plane and lot outline	Delivered
8	FEMA flood map	\$9 — NFHL attribute determination at the exact coordinates, with panel IDs and effective dates	Determination delivered; the FIRM panel graphic is best obtained from msc.fema.gov
9	Lake / bathymetric map	\$27	None exists for A. For B, commercial charts and USACE ramp elevations exist; depth at the lot is unknown
10	Location / access map	\$\$49–55 — routed distances and times to 35+ destinations	Delivered as measured tables rather than a graphic
11	Building-envelope diagram	Figure K-1 — setbacks, 150-ft buffer, resulting envelope, indicative footprints and septic areas	Delivered

#	Requested deliverable	Delivered as	Status
+	Additional, not requested	Figure B-5 — dedicated true-scale slope diagram with lot length, lot height, shoreline rise angle and the worst 50-ft angle located and highlighted	Delivered

Closing statement of limitations

This report is a screening and decision-support document. It is not a survey, an appraisal, a legal opinion, an engineering certification, a floodplain determination, or a soil evaluation.

Every elevation, contour, slope, area and distance derived from the lidar DEM or from county GIS is marked **GIS-** **DERIVED** and is **model-based**. Parcel geometry for Property A comes from a county service that Clayton County itself disclaims as "not a true and exact representation of property boundaries." **Property B's boundary is our reconstruction from listing dimensions and road geometry, because no plat or parcel polygon is publicly obtainable.**

The following require a licensed professional or an agency determination and **must not be taken from this report:** boundary and topographic surveys; septic design, bedroom capacity and perc results; foundation and retaining-wall design; grading quantities; floodplain or elevation certification; dock eligibility; zoning verification; and the content of unread covenants.

Where we could not confirm something we have written **NOT FOUND** rather than estimating it. **There are 27 such items in §58 and they are the most important part of this document** — the next step is not more desk research, it is the four starred phone calls.